



Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Literature Committee

1951 It was recommended that:

In future years, A.A. textbook literature should have Conference approval. (Agenda Committee)

Prior to the vote on this subject, it was pointed out that adoption of the suggestion would not preclude the continued issuance of various printed documents by non-Foundation sources. No desire to review, edit or censor non-Foundation material is implied. The objective is to provide, in the future, a means of distinguishing Foundation literature from that issued locally or by non-A.A. interests.

1952 It was recommended that:

The report of the Foundation's Committee on Literature, together with Bill's report of his proposed program of activity be approved.

Note: Ten projects carried out by the Foundations Committee on Literature included production of the new pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman," the pictorial script for film strips on headquarters services, the 1951 Conference report, Interim reports from the Trustees to the delegates, preparation of the manuscript for a new pamphlet on "The Alcoholic Employee," material on the Traditions prepared by Bill, two recordings and two reproductions of the A.A. prayer.

The Foundation's Committee on Literature reported that the groups have expressed a need for the following major literature projects: (1) Sponsorship pamphlet, (2) Pamphlet on "slips," (3) a standard introduction to A.A. for use by groups which do not have access to booklets of this type now bearing the imprint of intergroup associations, (4) a brief history of A.A., (5) a revised folder on The Alcoholic Foundation, (6) revision of the Secretary's Handbook, (7) a new "Sedatives" pamphlet, (8) a new pamphlet on Medicine and A.A., (9) new visual material on services and (10) a full-scale writing project on which Bill is now working.

Bill's project involved the following:

1. Updating of the story section of the "Big Book" to provide a more truly representative cross-section of A.A. recovery stories. (Delegates were urged to send in wire and tape recordings of actual talks, for consideration during revision of the book).
2. A new series of anecdotal analyzes of the Twelve Traditions.
3. A series of orderly, point-by-point essays on the Twelve Steps.
4. A kind of popular history of A.A. and its ideas of recovery, tradition and service.
5. A book on the application of A.A. philosophy to the "total problem of living."
6. A reference manual stating our total experience with the whole idea of service functions.

The following be incorporated on all literature published by the Works Publishing, Inc.: "Issued by Works Publishing, Inc., sole publishing agency of the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous. Approved by the General Service Conference of A.A."

The Conference reaffirm the stand taken by the 1951 Conference as follows: "This Conference has no desire to review, edit, or censor non-Foundation material. Our object is to provide, in the future, a means of distinguishing Foundation literature from that issued locally or by non-A.A. interests."

The principle of retaining professional writers on a fee basis when their employment has been authorized, to ensure prompt, efficient handling of editorial responsibilities be approved.

The pamphlet "Sedatives" be given first priority in issuance of revisions of existing pamphlets.

All suggestions made by delegates with reference to A.A. literature in general be turned over to the Foundation Committee on Literature for consideration and action, since the element of time precludes any action by the Conference Committee.

Facsimile reproductions of the Lasker Award be made available to all A.A. Groups in suitable form for framing where desired.

1953 It was recommended that:

A new pamphlet for young alcoholics be prepared, including a few personal experience stories.

"Medicine Looks at A.A." be revised with up-to-date medical and psychiatric thinking, but retaining the references to Dr. Tiebout.

The title of the pamphlet "The Alcoholic Husband" be changed to cover the dual objective of both the alcoholic husband and alcoholic wife; for example, "The Alcoholic Husband or Wife"; change the contents to conform where necessary.

A new pamphlet, "Are Slips Necessary?" with the recommendation that, because of the seriousness of the subject, a draft of such proposed pamphlet be sent to all delegates for study, comment and suggestions, and for further deliberation at the 1954 Conference.

A series of stock newspaper stories be prepared that may be sent to any group for publication in local newspapers, including the following: (a) An introductory story for new groups, (b) An announcement story for open meetings, (c) A story of A.A. in serial form, with installments approximating not more than 1,000 words each.

All delegates send at once to Helen B. clippings of stories that have appeared in their areas, including installment stories.

A series of stock radio scripts be prepared for dispatch to local groups on request. All delegates are asked to send immediately to Helen B. any radio scripts used in their respective areas that may be available.



A supplement for the "Third Legacy" pamphlet be prepared, clarifying the suggested duties and responsibilities of group Third Legacy representatives, State or Panel Committee members and Conference Delegates.

Delegates, in their reports to their groups, stress the listing of all Foundation literature in the Handbook of Secretaries and Group Directory.

Delegates weigh this question for submission to the 1954 Conference: Does the Conference feel it should depart from its purely textbook program by printing non-textbook literature such as the "24 Hour Book of Meditation"?

Preparation by Headquarters of a simple guide in the form of a brief pamphlet describing the duties involved in Conference service be approved. (Floor Action)

1954 It was recommended that:

All new literature be in a format suitable for mailing in a # 10 envelope, insofar as is practicable.

All Conference-approved literature have on its face an identifying symbol.

The two pamphlets, the 2nd edition of "Your Third Legacy" and "Your Role in General Service Conference" be combined in reduced volume.

The two pamphlets "Structure and Services of A.A." and "Your General Service" be combined.

The Conference Literature Committee be kept advised and consulted on all new pieces of literature.

Groups be circularized with tentative quantity prices and pictures of the literature display racks, models of which were shown at this Conference, to determine whether or not the project is feasible.

All reprints such as those reproducing material from *Fortune*, *Saturday Evening Post* and *Good Housekeeping*, bear the credit line at the top of the cover and that the cover be in white to distinguish such reprints from Conference-approved literature.

The publication rights of *Twenty-Four Hours a Day* not be accepted. (Floor Action)

A proposal that A.A. Publishing, Inc., should produce a Conference-approved pamphlet on the general theme of the role and attitude of the older member of A.A., with specific reference to conditions and attitudes that lead to 'slips' not be approved. (Floor Action)

A pamphlet on the general subject "Religion and A.A." not be published at this time. (Floor Action)

1955 It was recommended that:

Consideration be given to expansion of Section IV or Third Legacy Manual in respect to duties of G.S.R. to which might be added final paragraph of Section VI of Third Legacy Manual.

The Literature Committee shall continue to be advised and consulted on any discontinuing of old literature or addition of new literature.

Wherever possible upward revision in price of literature be avoided. With inevitable increasing costs A.A. Publishing be requested to investigate economies in purchase of paper, binding, printing, etc.

Consideration be given to publication of an introductory A.A. pamphlet available to groups at not more than five cents, containing condensed extracts from "44 Questions" and "This Is A.A."

A.A. Publishing review literature sales for past year to determine if any unprofitable items should be discontinued.

The literature order blank be revised for ordering purposes.

The retail price of the new edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be set at \$4.50, the price to A.A. groups at \$4.00 and to earmark fifty cents for the Reserve Fund. (Floor Action)

Note: In presenting the updating of the first edition of the Big Book, Bill described the background of his long-range writing project and made the following points:

1. "Not an iota" of the first part of the text dealing with recovery principles had been changed.
2. The story section has been changed and enlarged to present a more accurate cross-section of A.A.'s membership today. When the first edition was prepared, the number of recovered alcoholics was about 100 and most of them were what we now describe as "low bottom" alcoholics. There was only one woman's story; no personal stories by young people or alcoholics who had not suffered heavily. The new edition contains 37 stories in three main categories.
3. Although the old foreword has been retained for sentimental reasons, a new foreword has been added to bridge the gap in the story of A.A.'s growth from 1939 to 1955. The new edition also includes material dealing with the Twelve Traditions for group survival, (unknown in 1939, of course), with religious and medical appraisals of A.A. and with the award of the Lasker Trophy in 1951.

The retail price of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* remain at \$2.75, with the price to A.A. groups at \$2.50, and that twenty-five cents be earmarked for the Reserve Fund. In addition, the Delegates voted that this action, to the extent that it relates to the subject of discounts, be regarded as an amendment to the 1954 Conference action. (Floor Action)

1956 It was recommended that:

Area delegates, through their committees, help groups to gain a better understanding of existing Conference-approved literature. And, in addition, that groups be made aware of the material contained in the Handbook section of the Handbook and Directory and that the Handbook and Directory is for the entire group's use.

The next Conference consider the possibility of publishing the new leather-bound edition of the Big Book; also that it be known as the "leather-bound gift Edition," rather than as the "deluxe" Edition.

Since the delegates at their meeting unanimously approved Bill's new book (*A.A. Comes of Age*) it be produced in a first-class manner, decisions as to pictures and price being left to the Board of Trustees, every effort be made to have it available for the 1956 Christmas Season.

Consideration be given to the possibility of material for the specific use of the older member.

Pamphlet literature for institutions continue to be made available in gift packages which represent a twenty-five percent price reduction, but, further, that the Staff member corresponding with institutional groups endeavor to incorporate in the gift packages those pamphlets most frequently requested by these groups.



The Literature Committee of the Conference continue to be advised and consulted on discontinuing, revising or the adding of literature.

The new "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" be made available in quantity to groups wishing to purchase additional copies and agreed that Bulletin distribution should be exclusively through local groups or service offices. (Floor Action)

1957 It was recommended that:

Since the area delegates at their meeting unanimously approved Bill's new book (*A.A. Comes of Age*), it be adequately priced, \$4.50 not being too high.

Since the area delegates at their meeting approved the suggested pamphlets for the "old-timer" and for the individual member's relationship to the structure of A.A., the title "What Kind of an Old-Timer Are You?" is preferred for the "old-timer" pamphlet and "You and Your 199,999 Partners in A.A." is approved for the other.

Consideration be given to the possibility of developing material for a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic, a pamphlet that might be available in jails. Furthermore, when an outline or treatment of such a pamphlet is ready, it be submitted to the members of the Conference Literature Committee for comment.

At least once a year, an announcement be made in the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" that specially priced gift packages of A.A. literature are available for Prison and Hospital Groups.

The Conference terminate discussion of a gift edition of the Big Book in the absence of relative unanimity. (Floor Action)

The General Service Board Literature Committee suggestion that pamphlets be developed on the subject of "old-timers" and the relationship of individual members to the movement and its service agencies be endorsed. (Delegates Only Meeting)

Bill's negotiations designed to make it possible to retail his forthcoming book, *A.A. Comes of Age*, at \$4.00, if practical, be endorsed. (Delegates Only Meeting)

1958 It was recommended that:

There is no need for a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic, which would be available in jails, at this time.

Since the use of tokens of sobriety is a matter of local taste and custom, there seems to be no expressed need at the present time for a standard token of sobriety and no need for A.A. Publishing to carry such an item.

A.A. Publishing, Inc., provide for a basic A.A. book in foreign languages as needed.

The Conference recognize the original use of the word "honest" before "desire to stop drinking" and its deletion from the Traditions as part of the evolution of the A.A. movement. Any change to be left to the discretion of A.A. Publishing, Inc.

The idea for a pamphlet to describe A.A. pamphlets be dropped. However, the committee suggested that an item about A.A. Publishing, Inc., pamphlet literature might be run in the A.A. Exchange Bulletin from time to time. The present distribution of order blanks in a general mailing twice a year, and with each order of literature, is sufficient.

The present announcement of subscription rate on the front page of the A.A. Exchange Bulletin is sufficient, and that a subscription blank would only take space from a news item.

The Brief History in the Third Legacy Manual be recommended to those who want a history of A.A. in pamphlet form.

There is not sufficient need for A.A. Publishing, Inc., to distribute a portable literature rack since local areas take care of their own needs and display their literature to suit their own needs.

A.A. Publishing, Inc., consider the suggestion that their two individual wallet cards be replaced when the present supply is exhausted by one fold-over card that would include the same material now on two cards.

The concept that A.A. Publishing, Inc., distribute for a year specially priced literature packages of books and pamphlets and report the results to next year's Conference be approved.

There is no need for a special pamphlet for the inmate member in prisons and jails. Recommended that the staff member handling Institutional Services encourage the exchange of prison group experiences and publications to meet any need expressed by an individual prison group.

An animated "comic book" type pamphlet is not appropriate for A.A. literature.

The "Oldtimer" pamphlet be tabled for the present time since after a year of exploration there is inadequate material to warrant publication.

The pamphlet literature distributed by A.A. Publishing is adequate at the present time and that before developing any new pamphlets the need for each one should be well defined.

The survey of armed forces groups be continued with the view to developing material that can be given to commanding officers of armed forces bases so that they may understand the role that A.A. plays in the recovery of alcoholics in the armed services.

A paperback edition of the "Big Book" not be published. (Floor Action)

1959 It was recommended that:

A new pamphlet for inmate alcoholics be approved as outlined in the memorandum from G.S.O. literature consultant.

The preparation of a pamphlet to inform clergymen of A.A.'s sole purpose and how they can help the alcoholic find sobriety in A.A. be approved.

The delegates to the 1960 Conference be surveyed for information about industrial and business programs in their areas, and suggested that information be obtained from outside sources as well, so that G.S.O. material can be brought up-to-date and the pamphlet "The Alcoholic Employee" can be revised.

The demand is not sufficient to justify republishing the old "A.A." pamphlet which went out of print a number of years ago.

The revised "Sedatives" pamphlet will be ready for distribution as soon as approved by the joint Literature Committees.

The committee considered a recommendation from the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies for a brief fold-over on "Cooperation but Not Affiliation" with outside agencies, and suggested that this be handled as a Grapevine article and reprinted and made available to A.A. members and outside agencies by G.S.O.

1960 It was recommended that:

In view of the importance of communicating the A.A. message to non-English-speaking alcoholics in many lands, A.A. World



Services undertake a thorough study of the immediate and long-range needs for A.A. literature in languages other than English.

Pending completion of this study and the submission of detailed recommendations at the 1961 Conference, the Committee recommends that A.A. World Services undertake such additional translations of Conference-approved literature as may be deemed immediately necessary and financially feasible.

A.A. World Services consider the offer of groups in Puerto Rico to make available to other Spanish-speaking members a pamphlet, now in preparation, which will contain Spanish translations of excerpts from existing Conference-approved literature.

Groups which undertake to translate Conference-approved literature, or to prepare special non-English literature for local use, would welcome an opportunity to have such material reviewed by A.A. World Services to assure accuracy in transmitting the message of the A.A. recovery program. The availability of this G.S.O. service be publicized in the *Exchange Bulletin* and that interested groups be encouraged to use this service.

The material compiled by the Study Committee on Outside Agencies be considered as incomplete, so that additional supplements may be added as the need for them is manifested.

The Conference reaffirm the need for the pamphlets approved by the 1959 Conference, namely: for the Clergy, the Inmate, a revision of "Young People and A.A." and "The Alcoholic Employee."

1961

The Committee urged the Board of Trustees to avail itself of the offer made by the delegate from Puerto Rico to provide Spanish translators for A.A. material as the need arises.

The Committee expressed its gratitude to the Board's Literature Committee for the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate."

The Committee considered the recommendation transmitted by two committeemen in South Florida to delete the words: "There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" from the A.A. "preamble." After voicing its opinion that these words are of vital importance to the newcomer and in describing the Fellowship to the non-alcoholic, the Committee referred the recommendation to the Policy Committee.

No action was taken regarding requests for copies of the last portion of Mr. Bernard Smith's talk since it will be included in the Final Conference Report.

The Committee noted with sympathy the recommendation that stories of a more personal nature be included when the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" is due for revision.

The Committee recommended that the study of long-range translation needs be continued as authorized by the 1960 Conference.

The Committee noted with approval the recent availability of seven additional Spanish pamphlets.

The Committee urged Delegates to request young A.A.s to forward their case histories to G.S.O. before June 1, 1961, to assist in the revision of the pamphlet "Young People in A.A."

The Committee recommended that G.S.O. explore the possibility of preparing a more adequate description of Conference-approved literature.

It was the sense of the meeting that no action be taken by the 1961 Conference on the proposal for a paperback edition of the "Big Book." (Floor Action)

The Conference recognized that the publication of cheap editions of A.A. books would probably reduce the income to World Services, and Bill's personal income. The Conference unanimously suggested the following to the Trustees: To add a rider to Bill's royalty contract to the effect that, if cheaper books are ever published, Bill's royalties be increased by an amount sufficient to keep the royalty income at the same average level it had been for the five years before cheaper books were published; (further, that) as time goes on, if inflation erodes the purchasing power of this income, the Trustees will adjust the royalties to produce the same approximate purchasing power; this to be effective during the lifetime of Bill and Lois and Bill's legatees. (Floor Action)

1962 It was recommended that:

Condensation of selected G.S.O. service material be prepared by G.S.O. in the near future for translation into appropriate languages, as suggested in the 1962 Overseas Conference Report.

G.S.O. give further study to the pamphlets submitted by the delegates from British Columbia-Yukon and Northern Quebec

The suggestion for an introductory comic-strip type of A.A. pamphlet be explored further by G.S.O.

The long-range Translation Program as authorized by the 1960 Conference and confirmed by the 1961 Conference be continued, subject to the approval of any definite plan by the G.S.B. Literature Committee.

G.S.O. give further study to the suggestion for preparation of a pamphlet designed to be helpful to social workers.

The Conference voted unanimously to accept Bill's manuscript on *Twelve Concepts for World Service* and recommended that it be distributed initially as a supplement to, and eventually as an integral part of, the *Third Legacy Manual*. (Now *The A.A. Service Manual*.) (Floor Action)

1963 It was recommended that:

A.A.W.S. continue to make available translated literature as needed.

"Partners" when revised be retitled "The Group Handbook" with subtitle, "How the A.A. Group Starts and Grows."

The need for a study guide to the Steps and Traditions or a condensed Twelve Step book be explored and a report brought back to the 1964 Conference.

The pamphlet "Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A." be discontinued and a new pamphlet be created outlining specific information about the formation and function of groups in institutions, including material pertaining to county jails, orientation programs, training programs for the young, open door groups, women's groups, etc. One page of Warden's comments was considered to be sufficient. The draft of the pamphlet to be reviewed by interested penologists as well as the Conference Literature Committee. The Committee further requested that information for the pamphlet be sought from Delegates and Institutions Committees.

A revised pamphlet on the relationship of A.A. and tranquilizers and sedatives be prepared, such pamphlet to emphasize that it is written by non-experts and the importance to A.A. of maintaining its amateur standing. It was felt that A.A. has a responsibility to share its information with alcoholics but



that we should do this in a way which will not antagonize the medical profession, and that we emphasize that our concern is with the unsupervised use of pills (medication). It was further suggested that the last page of the pamphlet as presently written be placed first; that more varied opinions of more doctors be included, and that the draft be submitted to the directors of N.A.A.A.P. as well as Conference Literature Committee for suggestions.

Pending this review, the present pamphlet continue to be used in order to share A.A. experience.

Consideration of a proposal to publish a "deluxe" edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be tabled for further consideration in 1964.

1964 It was recommended that:

The words "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature" be used under the seal on all Conference-approved literature, and that reprints carry the wording "This material has been reprinted with the approval of the A.A. General Service Conference."

In the current literature order form, the reference to foreign literature order blanks be printed in bold type and underlined. On the second page the "Note" referring to institutional packages, pamphlets, Braille editions of the Big Book and translations should be boxed in with a bold line. It was the sense of the meeting that the current literature order blank fills the present needs except for the above recommended changes.

A decision about a new pamphlet for newcomers, which would be more specific as to the first drink, the 24 Hour Plan, etc., be deferred until a review of all current literature can be made by members of the Committee.

A pamphlet for A.A. in hospitals, similar to the new "A.A. in Prisons" pamphlet, be prepared, and that such a pamphlet be suitable for tubercular hospitals.

All members of the Literature Committee be sent a copy of all pamphlets for review in terms of the following questions: "Do we have enough literature? Do we have too much literature? What should we do to promote sale of literature?" Comments are to be sent to the Secretary of the Literature Committee by June 15.

The Committee would be a "working committee" during the Conference year, April 1964 to April 1965. Members will share correspondence and ideas, and will hope to deliver a complete analysis of their functions and problems for the consideration of the 1965 General Service Conference Literature Committee. The Secretary of the Committee will receive copies of correspondence for sharing with the General Service Board Literature Committee. Our primary function is to assist the Literature Committee of the Board so as to provide the best possible literature for A.A. Thus we invite all comments, critical or complimentary, at all times.

Regarding pamphlets and literature other than that which is Conference-approved being displayed or sold at area and state conferences, it was the sense of the meeting that we have no authority in this area. It is to be noted that all Conference-approved literature should be made available at A.A. get-togethers.

Whether review of tapes and films available to G.S.O. should be the responsibility of the Literature Committee, it was the sense of the meeting that the possibility of a relationship between the Literature Committee and the Tape Committee be

referred to the General Service Board for its consideration. The Conference Literature Committee felt it would not be practical for members to participate in tape or film review.

Thought be given to the idea of having a two-day session of the combined Literature Committees at some future time.

Consideration be given to the need for a pamphlet directed specifically to the social worker.

A proposed edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* that would be smaller in size and generally more compact than the existing edition be approved. The proposed edition would presumably be used primarily for gifts and would be particularly useful to members who travel. (Floor Action)

The preparation of a small edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* to be introduced at the 30th Anniversary Convention in 1965, to be sold at \$3.00 or more be approved. (Policy)

1965 It was recommended that:

A new G.S.R. pamphlet be prepared following the suggestions outlined by the G.S.B. Literature Committee.

The pamphlet "A.A. and the Community" be prepared as outlined to date, with additional emphasis on what A.A. cannot do.

The suggested guideline for conducting newcomers' meetings be used as service material adding the preamble and slogans, and that at some future time a pamphlet might be considered.

In all future pamphlets and in revisions, an effort be made to avoid alphabetical abbreviations and to spell out such abbreviations as G.S.R. and A.A.W.S. "in the interest of clarity and education."

No glossary of A.A. terminology be prepared, since it would be difficult to have absolute uniformity in terminology, and perhaps not advisable.

The draft of "A.A. in Hospitals" be approved and Committee members agreed to have their suggestions in the mail to G.S.O. by May 15.

The draft of the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be approved with the specific recommendation that some emphasis on the value of our Tradition of placing principles before personalities in our Group life be incorporated. Additional suggestions and corrections to be incorporated in the final draft are to be received by G.S.O. by May 15.

The Policy Committee of the Conference consider the recommendation that "communications would be improved if the secretary of the Committee: (a) Acted as a focal point coordinating Committee correspondence, (b) 'Sifted' material received from Committee members in order to eliminate 'personal factors' in material relayed to other members, (c) distributed a newsletter to Committee members from time to time."

The Policy Committee consider the recommendation that "members of the Conference Committee be assured of their right and obligation to communicate directly with any General Service Board Literature Committee members."

1966 It was recommended that:

A.A.W.S. publish a new hard-cover book containing excerpts from Bill's letters, books, Grapevine articles and other writings with a title something like 'The A.A. Reader,' or 'Selected Writings by Bill.'

A new pamphlet, "Guide for Leading Newcomers' Meetings," be published.



A cartoon format for some A.A. Literature be developed in the hope it will reach alcoholics who are unable to read well or those who just don't read much at all.

When the "Third Legacy Manual" (now *The A.A. Service Manual*) is updated, it should carry a glossary of terms such as *area, district, assembly*, etc., so terms can become more uniform throughout the continent. (Agenda Committee)

The sentence "There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" be retained in the Preamble. (Floor action)

1967 The committee:

Reported that *The A.A. Way of Life* was anticipated with great interest in all areas.

Noted enthusiastic reception of the comic book pamphlet, "What Happened to Joe."

Voiced high hopes for Newcomers' Meetings Kit.

Expressed interest in upcoming revisions of "A.A. for the Woman," "Young People in A.A.," and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

Suggested that area committees interest groups in Conference-approved literature by using "Let literature carry the message, too" as an agenda item at area meetings and holding discussions on specific pamphlets at sharing sessions and workshops.

Recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee that the possibility of translating "What Happened to Joe" into Spanish be explored.

Recommended that the trustees' Literature Committee ask permission of the Grapevine to reprint Bill's article "Problems Other Than Alcohol" for use as a pamphlet.

1968 It was recommended that:

Conference-approved literature and G.S.O. Guidelines be displayed and distributed at assembly meetings.

Brief mimeograph service material (not Guideline format) be prepared to provide a listing of source material from Conference-approved literature as an aid to closed-meeting discussions.

The pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be brought to the attention of new group officers as they rotate.

A yearly questionnaire be sent to a sampling of A.A. groups to determine literature needs.

1969 It was recommended that:

The story of a young A.A. be added to the next reprint of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and that the present stories be edited, when necessary, in order that current readers will be able to identify.

No additions to present Conference-approved literature be made at this time.

Material illustrating the General Service Office and the history of A.A. in cartoon style be considered.

More effective ways of displaying Conference-approved literature be explored; that the delegates be polled for their suggestions and results be made available to A.A. groups.

Groups consider the suggestion that one group member be chosen to be solely responsible for the distribution of Conference-approved literature and its display.

1970 It was recommended that:

The Grapevine reprints of Bill's articles "Problems Other Than Alcohol" and "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous" be considered by A.A.W.S. for pricing and inclusion in the G.S.O. order blank.

The suggestion of the 1969 Conference Literature Committee that a cartoon-style booklet illustrative of the history of A.A. and service activities of G.S.O. be pursued, but that the history be confined to the early years at G.S.O. so that the project will have cohesion.

"A Clergyman Looks at A.A." be considered for revision if the response from a selected number of A.A. and non-A.A. clergymen to whom it will be mailed for comment warrants it.

Delegates continue to explore the possibility of placing the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* and other Conference-approved books in local libraries wherever this has not already been done.

Each group choose a member to be responsible for literature display at each meeting, as was recommended by the 1969 Conference.

Occasionally group discussions center around Conference-approved pamphlets such as "Sponsorship," "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," or any of the others that would be suitable for such discussions.

1971 It was recommended that:

The illustrated format used for the Traditions pamphlet be considered for use in future A.A. literature.

The "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet now in preparation be directed toward the alcoholic in the armed services rather than the higher echelon, and that A.A. stories of armed services experiences be forwarded to the committee secretary.

Box 4-5-9 be included on the price list of the regular literature order blank if G.S.O. finds this suggestion feasible.

The suggestion of placing the Big Book and pamphlets in public, school, university and church libraries has worked well in many areas and that all delegates consider this as a project for their area committees.

The delegates assume responsibility for informing A.A.s of all available Conference-approved literature, and that the updated spring and fall literature order blanks which are mailed with Box 4-5-9 be reviewed at district and assembly meetings.

The Literature Committee, following the general feeling of the Conference, reaffirm both the spirit and the wording of the "I Am Responsible" Declaration from the International Convention held in Toronto in 1965.

The short form of the Twelve Concepts be approved. (Floor Action)

1972 It was recommended that:

The Conference delegates continue to seek material of a spiritual nature for the proposed booklet, *Came to Believe*.

The delegates be asked to look for members willing to write their stories for the proposed pamphlet, "A.A. and the Armed Services."

G.S.O. be asked to submit suggestions for material and costs with reference to taped literature to the Conference Literature Committee for their recommendations. Deadline: June 1, 1972.

No deletions be made at this time on the G.S.O. Order Blank.



Suggestions for meeting discussion be included in the Group Handbook, using discussion subjects from the A.A. Grapevine if permission is granted.

The Group Inventory material submitted to the committee be recommended to G.S.O. as possible service material.

A cartoon leaflet on service responsibilities be considered by A.A.W.S.

The *Twenty-Four Hour Book* not be confirmed as Conference-approved literature.

It be suggested that when a local A.A. facility (central office, intergroup, group, etc.) sells non-Conference-approved literature, it be clearly designated as such.

G.S.O. review the content of *Box 4-5-9* with the idea of making the material in it more like the kind of information now included in the *Quarterly Report*.

1973 It was recommended that:

The words "sometimes heavily" be deleted from question 5 in the pamphlet "Is A.A. for You?"

Preparation of an illustrated or cartoon-style "Young People and A.A." pamphlet be explored.

A better way to communicate with doctors be explored by the Trustees' Professional Relations Committee.

The Unity Declaration be added to all A.A. Literature when feasible and economical, and be referred to A.A. World Services, Inc., for follow-through.

A.A.W.S., Inc., be asked to study the possibility of having a reproduction made of the original Big Book.

It be noted, as a matter of information, that the code appearing on all A.A. literature stands for number of pamphlets ordered, date ordered, and printer used.

The A.A.W.S. directors consider changing the name of the pamphlet "Bill on Alcoholism" to "Three Talks by Bill W. to Medical Societies," since the current title seems confusing and misleading to many readers. (Report and Charter Committee)

1974 It was recommended that:

The progress report of the Big Book subcommittee be approved with the added suggestion that a story regarding retired persons be particularly considered.

The pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be reviewed and rewritten to include Twelfth Step calls as well as sponsorship, with a new suggested title: "Twelfth Step Calls and Sponsorship."

In memory of A.A.'s co-founders, the last talk of each be prepared in pamphlet form and distributed.

The partial draft of the new booklet "Staying Sober" be reviewed by the committee and returned with comments and suggestions to G.S.O. by June 1, 1974.

The Grapevine reprints "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous," "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends," and "Problems Other Than Alcohol" be prepared in standard pamphlet form.

The trustees' Literature Committee explore the need for a pamphlet guide to taking the Fourth and Fifth Steps.

That the trustees' Public Information Committee continue trying to place articles about A.A. in publications for retired citizens.

1975 It was recommended that:

The original "Is A.A. for You?" pamphlet be dropped and the simplified version be used.

"The Alcoholic Husband" and "The Alcoholic Wife" be combined into one pamphlet called "The Alcoholic Mate" or another appropriate title.

The reprints "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous," "Our Critics Can Be Our Benefactors," and "A.A. as a Community Resource" be dropped.

"The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous" pamphlet be dropped.

A paragraph dealing with the problem of the use of mood-changing pills by A.A. members who hold group office should *not* be added to an appropriate A.A. pamphlet because it was felt that this decision is up to local autonomy.

An illustrated pamphlet like "What Happened to Joe" and "It Happened to Alice," directed to teenage and pre-teenage alcoholics, be prepared.

Two teenage stories be added to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A."

Previous Conference action to display non-Conference-approved literature and Conference-approved literature *separately* be reaffirmed.

A feasibility study regarding a paperback edition of the Big Book and alternatives be made and reported on at the 1976 Conference. (Floor Action)

1976 It was recommended that:

Delegates take back to their areas a statement to the effect that the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, third edition, is not being changed—that only the stories have been updated and some new ones added.

The pamphlet "So You Think You're Different" have a new title—"Do You Think You're Different?"—and that the agnostic story, "My Name Is Jan," be added, and the Spanish story, "My Name Is Maria," be deleted.

The new title for the combined pamphlets "The Alcoholic Wife" and "The Alcoholic Husband" be "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" with a subtitle, "A.A.'s Message of Hope." The third draft was accepted as is.

The title for the teenage cartoon pamphlet be "Teenagers and A.A." The manuscript was unanimously accepted.

Action on pamphlets directed to special groups of alcoholics be deferred until after the publication of "Do You Think You're Different?"

The present terminology used regarding the word "suggested" when referring to the Twelve Steps is consistent with that employed in the Big Book, Twelve and Twelve, and other A.A. literature, and should remain as is.

The trustees' Literature Committee look into reproducing "How It Works" in wallet-sized cards.

The trustees' Literature Committee study the Conference keynote address in 1972, about our Third Legacy, to be considered for a future service pamphlet.

We keep the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as it is at this time and not publish a paperback edition. (Floor Action)

A study be made of the feasibility of publishing a limited edition of the first edition of the Big Book, and report back at next year's Conference. (Floor Action)



G.S.O. discontinue distribution of the “Bill W.” book (the biography published by Harper & Row), dispose of the present supply in the most feasible manner, and notify the Fellowship through Box 4-5-9 when the “Bill W.” book is no longer available through G.S.O. Sense of the meeting was taken that the deletion of the listing in the catalog should be handled by overprinting or other method as G.S.O. sees fit. (Floor Action)

1977 It was recommended that:

A story be added to the pamphlet “Do You Think You’re Different?” under the title “My name is—and I am an alcoholic (with a language barrier),” and that the emphasis in the story should be on feeling the barrier rather than on the particular language, for example, Spanish, French, or whatever.

The Conference-approved seal on A.A. Literature remain as it is.

The proposal on “Living Sober Longer” not be pursued further as there is not sufficient need for such a pamphlet.

The Responsibility Declaration not be changed, as it was made at the 1965 International Convention in Toronto.

Literature survey results be mailed to all delegates within a few months.

A.A.W.S. proceed with the project of a joint biography of Dr. Bob and Bill.

The publication of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book should not be undertaken as it would destroy the sentimental value of the actual first edition. (Floor Action)

It was suggested that A.A. groups be discouraged from selling literature not distributed by the General Service Office and the Grapevine. (Floor Action)

1978 It was recommended that:

Neither a story about someone with a language barrier nor a story about a physician be added to the pamphlet “Do You Think You’re Different?” at this time.

In the next printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the foreword of the second edition be included as it was originally published in the second edition.

The delegates should be made aware of any changes under consideration in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* prior to publication.

No changes be made in the pamphlet “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” as there is no need for clarification.

The test film shown to the Conference Literature Committee be expanded to a film approximately 25 minutes in length for the purpose of carrying the A.A. message to the general public with the understanding that the film will be presented to the 1979 General Service Conference for approval prior to distribution.

A change be made in the scope of the committee to read: “To review new literature and audiovisual needs,” and that this proposal be forwarded to the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference for review at its quarterly meeting in July in order to avoid possible overlap or duplication of the various Conference committees’ functions.

1979 It was recommended that:

In response to a request to discuss amending the Scope to state that this committee deals with recovery literature only, the Composition, Scope, and Procedures of the Conference Literature Committee be retained as is.

The pamphlet “The A.A. Group” be expanded to include previous Conference Advisory Actions recommending that A.A. groups should not be named after institutions in which they meet or for persons either living or deceased, and that the word “family” should not be part of the name of the group.

Jo’s story be substituted for Lisa’s story in the pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” when it is next reprinted.

The Twelve Steps of A.A. be included in the pamphlet “Too Young?” when it is next reprinted.

A voice-over be added at the end of the film “Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View,” repeating that film techniques have been employed to protect the anonymity of A.A. members. With this addition, the committee recommended that the film be approved by the Conference. (The Conference also stipulated that sound-track audibility be improved.)

With regard to the distribution of the film “Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View”:

- a. A.A. World Services retain ownership of the film and control distribution of each copy.
- b. During its first year, the film be released only to those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, and that the area delegate be notified of all requests from his or her area for the film.
- c. Priority for distributing the film would be: (1) A.A. service entities, such as public information committees, institutions committees, etc.; (2) those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, such as treatment programs, professional groups, etc.; (3) schools, churches, service clubs, etc.
- d. Although the film is intended *primarily* for use outside A.A., prints be made available on a rental basis to any A.A. entities wishing to show it.
- e. With the exception of one or two selected test areas, the use of the film on television be delayed for one year to give the General Service Conference an opportunity to gain real experience with the reaction of the Fellowship and the public to the film.
- f. Anyone involved in showing the film during the coming year be asked to submit a brief evaluation on a prepared form to G.S.O.
- g. The results of the evaluation and the distribution policy be reviewed by the 1980 Conference Public Information Committee.

The pamphlet for the older alcoholic be approved by the Conference with the title “Now It’s Time to Start Living” and the subtitle “Stories of Those Who Came to A.A. in Their Later Years.”

No pamphlet or booklet concerning the Fourth Step be considered at this time because this information is provided in the books *Alcoholics Anonymous* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*.

The biographies of Dr. Bob and Bill W. be published as separate books rather than as a joint biography.

A study committee composed of delegates, trustees, and staff be appointed to study the advisability of, and procedures for, having Conference-approved literature and service material distributed by G.S.O. (Floor Action)



1980 It was recommended that:

The change in the title of the pamphlet for older people, from "Now It's Time to Start Living" to "Time to Start Living," be approved.

The unedited manuscript of *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers* be accepted.

The pamphlet from Great Britain entitled "A Newcomer Asks" be adopted and adapted.

The Responsibility Declaration not be changed.

The suggestion to add to the book *As Bill Sees It* a definition of the slogans not be accepted because it was felt that the slogans may be defined in many different ways.

The suggestion of adding to the book *As Bill Sees It* excerpts from the Grapevine and "The Best of Bill" not be accepted, since much of this material is already included.

The suggestion to produce a set of pamphlets on each Legacy not be accepted, since we have sufficient material at the present time.

The pictures of Bill W. and Dr. Bob remain in the film "A.A.—An Inside View." (Floor Action)

The following pamphlets, leaflets, and flyers be approved with their present content:

"Where Do I Go From Here?" "Your A.A. G.S.O." "G.S.R." "Self-Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan" "Inside A.A." "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" "Circles of Love and Service" "A.A. in Your Community" "A.A. at a Glance" "The A.A. Member" "If You Are a Professional. (Literature Task Force)

Any factual or statistical information may be updated whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference action, e.g., whenever inventory runs low, a new survey is completed, etc. In addition, minor copy cuts to make room for new material added to publications may be made when necessary. (Literature Task Force)

Since A.A. Guidelines are a reflection of collective experience that is shared through G.S.O., relating to specialized topics not necessarily relevant to all groups or A.A. members generally (e.g., armed forces, clubs, answering services, occupational programs), the A.A. Guidelines may be produced or revised when new information or other contingencies arise, at the discretion of the G.S.O. staff without Conference approval. (Literature Task Force)

The Conference-approved seal may be positioned or placed wherever practical on a piece of literature so approved. (Literature Task Force)

1981 It was recommended that:

The suggestion to publish a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be tabled until the 1982 Conference to allow time for all delegates to get the group conscience from the groups in their areas.

The suggestion to publish a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be placed on the 1982 Conference Literature Committee agenda.

The suggestion to include information about meeting newcomers from treatment centers "where they are" be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet when it is next reprinted. The suggested information to read as follows:

Welcoming newcomers from treatment centers keeping in mind that they usually have already gotten sober and have been given some introduction to the A.A. program.

The suggestion to put a two-year moratorium on any new literature not be accepted.

A subcommittee be formed, consisting of a member from each trustee committee involved in the preparation of literature, to review already existing pamphlets with an eye to which pamphlets could be combined or dropped; and their report be given to the 1982 Conference.

A footnote be added to Tradition Eight in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, page 169, to update the job description of present-day G.S.O. staff members; the suggested footnote to read as follows:

The work of present-day staff members has no counterpart among the job categories of commercial organizations. These A.A.s bring a wide range of business and professional experience to their service at G.S.O.

The suggestion to include the Twelve Traditions in all recovery pamphlets when feasible be accepted.

1982 It was recommended that:

A draft of a pamphlet be developed for the homosexual alcoholic to be considered by next year's Conference.

The suggestion that a filmstrip be produced on the functions of central and intergroup offices not be approved.

Since the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* is available on cassette tapes, there is no need to print the book in large type at this time.

The suggestion to seek Conference approval for "Problems Other Than Alcohol (Excerpts)" be approved.

The taping of our books and booklets be continued by A.A.W.S., Inc.

An index and illustrations be included in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

The following sentence be added in bold type on the cover of A.A. directories under the caveat "CONFIDENTIAL": "This directory is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture."

The suggestion to produce a filmstrip on the functions of the group inventory not be accepted at this time.

1983 It was recommended that:

The distribution of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" be continued at this time until it is revised for consideration by the 1984 Conference.

The revision of Chapter 21 of the booklet "Living Sober" be accepted.

The following changes be made in the pamphlets:

- a. "Is A.A. for You?"—Substitute the following words: "disease" for "sick," and "alcohol" for "booze." Question #4 should be changed to read "Have you had to have an eye-opener on awakening?"
- b. "This Is A.A."—Page 5; paragraph 1 should be changed to read: "There are a number of self-proclaimed atheists and agnostics among us."
- c. "It Happened to Alice"—Should be brought up to date visually. On page 19, the word "fun" should be put in quotes.



- d. "What Happened to Joe?"—Should be brought up to date visually.
- e. "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"—Consider changing the wording on page 15, paragraph 3; and page 13, paragraph 2. The wording should be clear in answering the question on page 13, paragraph 2: "Is a special approach needed for present-day newcomers?"
- f. The revised manuscript of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet not be approved at this time and be returned for further revision.

The word "suggested" in the title of the Twelve Steps not be reinstated.

The 1983 draft of the pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be approved for circulation to Conference members, so that the 1984 Conference may make an informed policy decision as to whether or not the Fellowship will publish and distribute a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic.

The suggestion that a filmstrip be produced on the functions of central and intergroup offices not be approved; and that the 1982 Conference Advisory Action regarding the suggestion for this filmstrip be reaffirmed.

1984 It was recommended that:

The Bill W. biography be approved with the title *Pass It On*.

"A.A.—The First Fifty Years" not be approved. [Following lengthy discussion, it was the sense of the meeting that a souvenir booklet for the 1985 International Convention be prepared under the auspices of the General Service Board. In keeping with the precedent set at past International Conventions, a souvenir booklet does not require Conference approval.]

The words "queers" (p. 140) in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* not be changed to "homosexuals and lesbians," recognizing Fellowship feeling that Bill W.'s textbook writings be retained as originally published.

"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved with some revision, to replace "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse."

The General Service Conference not develop a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic, as the need is currently addressed in "Do You Think You're Different?"

The draft of a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be dropped.

"The A.A. Group" pamphlet not be illustrated, as artwork is not necessary.

Adding an index to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet is not necessary.

"The A.A. Group" pamphlet continue to be distributed with its current content generally intact, as a major revision is not necessary.

The trustees' Literature Committee review "The A.A. Group" pamphlet with an eye toward underscoring the importance of an informed group conscience.

The text of the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" referring to "What's the difference between a 'meeting' and a 'group'?" (pp. 32-33) be retained, as the text reflects the spirit of local autonomy.

A "Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet suggested by the trustees' Literature Committee be developed for consideration by the 1985 General Service Conference.

A pamphlet or manual for A.A. central offices/ intergroups not be developed.

The updated illustrations for "What Happened to Joe" and "It Happened to Alice" be approved.

The updated version of "P.O. Box 459" filmstrip be approved.

1985 It was recommended that:

Preparation of a brochure or pamphlet of a condensed version of the Twelve Concepts be tabled until the 1986 General Service Conference, pending development of the "Twelve Concepts Illustrated."

As a condensed version of the Twelve Concepts would be especially valuable to service workers, the manuscript be reproduced and distributed by the General Service Office as service material.

A.A.W.S., Inc., produce cassette tapes of *A.A. Comes of Age*.

A.A.W.S., Inc., explore the financial feasibility of reproducing the photographs from *A.A. Comes of Age* in a brochure to accompany the cassette album of the same title.

There is no need to add reference to the Big Book as our basic recovery source in all pamphlets and other literature.

There is no need to develop a pamphlet offering guidelines for A.A. meeting discussions.

The previous Conference actions regarding the Fourth and Fifth Step study guides be reaffirmed—i.e., there is no need for Fourth and Fifth Step study guides, as existing literature adequately covers these matters.

Suggested editorial revisions in "Your A.A. G.S.O." pamphlet be approved:

- a. ARCHIVES—replace the question "When did our group start?" with "When did A.A. start in our area?" (The question "When did our A.A. group start?" is now handled in our Records Department.)
- b. WHAT CAN YOU DO FOR G.S.O.?—Under "share your experience"—line three—rewrite "A.A.s help more alcoholics" to read "A.A.s carry our message."

1986 It was recommended that:

The manuscript and illustrations for the pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" be approved.

A definitive book on A.A. history from 1955-1985 be prepared and brought to the 1987 Conference for consideration.

In an effort to strengthen our network of "literature representatives" to ensure that A.A. Literature is available at meetings, as well as catalog order forms for books and cassettes that individuals are likely to want, it is suggested that groups appoint literature coordinators.

The trustees' Committee on Literature complete the updating of the pamphlet "Too Young?" for presentation at the 1987 Conference for approval.

The following pamphlets be updated, if possible, in time for presentation at the 1987 Conference for approval:

- a. "Young People and A.A."
- b. "A.A. and the Armed Forces"

As the preface to the Big Book clearly states that the text was written in 1939 and that it has not been changed, no further explanation regarding out-of-date phrases and/or gender-oriented pronouns or chapter titles is necessary.



The italicized footnote regarding Al-Anon at the end of the chapter "To Wives" in the Big Book be retained, as it provides information rather than implying affiliation, but that it be printed in small type as appropriate to a footnote and placed at the bottom of the page.

A story of a gay alcoholic not be included in the Big Book.

There was no need to publish a separate and complete volume of all stories taken from the three editions of the Big Book.

The A.A.W.S. editorial staff continue to degenderize A.A. literature, with the exception of Bill W.'s writings, as the items are reprinted, e.g., "staffing the booth" rather than "manning the booth," etc.

In order to determine the need to put more literature in large print, Conference members seek the experience of A.A. members and agencies for the visually impaired and report the findings to the G.S.O. literature coordinator within the year.

A service item for use at A.A. meetings regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be developed by the appropriate trustees' committee and proposed to the appropriate Conference committee at the 1987 Conference.

In "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, in the section "What Do Treasurers Do?," the text relating to the 60-30-10 Plan be reworded to reflect that this suggested plan for groups to divide contributions to A.A. service entities is only applicable in some areas, and reference be made to the finance pamphlet "Supporting the A.A. Support System."

The updated draft for "A.A. for the Woman" be accepted with the exception of the story "I Hated Monday Mornings. . .," and that production proceed under the direction of the trustees' Literature Committee.

In order to determine the need for a daily reflections book, the Conference members ask A.A. members in their areas and report the findings to the G.S.O. literature coordinator by January 1, 1987, for consideration by the 1987 Conference.

The Conference reaffirm the spirit of the 1977 Conference action regarding group literature displays, and recommended the suggestion that A.A. groups be encouraged to display or sell only literature published and distributed by the General Service Office, the A.A. Grapevine and other A.A. entities.

Because the story section is still up to date, there is no need to develop a fourth edition of the Big Book at this time.

To establish the need for additional formats of the Big Book, an explicit questionnaire (describing the preferred Lexitone—soft-cover—samples of (1) the pocket size and (2) first eleven chapters, plus Dr. Bob's story) be developed for use by the delegates in surveying A.A. groups in their areas. It is further recommended that area delegates be responsible for distributing the questionnaires and returning them to G.S.O. by July 15, 1986, and that the results be reported to all Conference members by August 1, 1986. Should the survey results indicate, in the judgment of the General Service Board, substantial requests for additional format(s), A.A.W.S. may act as necessary.

Regarding the suggestion to change the seal designating General Service-Conference approved literature to the Three Legacies seal, no action be taken since the Conference has reserved that seal for Conference-approved literature; however, the committee commends the idea of making the Fellowship more aware of our Three Legacies. (Policy)

1987 It was recommended that:

The following statement regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be available as an A.A. service piece.

THIS IS A CLOSED MEETING OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

This is a closed meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. In support of A.A.'s singleness of purpose, attendance at closed meetings is limited to persons who have a desire to stop drinking. If you think you have a problem with alcohol, you are welcome to attend this meeting. We ask that when discussing our problems, we confine ourselves to those problems, as they relate to alcoholism.

The following statement regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be available as an A.A. service piece.

THIS IS AN OPEN MEETING OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here—especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking," we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol.

The updated manuscript for "Too Young?" be approved.

Because of insufficient expressed need, no large-print literature for the visually impaired be prepared at this time.

Although there is some desire to publish the first 181 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in soft-cover, there is not sufficient need at this time.

The trustees' Literature Committee undertake development of a daily reflections book based on individual A.A.'s (including Bill W.'s) sharing based on the Traditions and Steps, and that a progress report be submitted to the 1988 Conference Literature Committee.

A pamphlet for the Native North American be prepared by the trustees' Literature Committee and brought back to the 1988 General Service Conference.

The Grapevine Corporate Board consider publishing a special issue written by Native North Americans and devoted to their recovery stories.

The following editorial changes be made in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet:

Since a number of groups send their inventories to G.S.O. that are mainly helpful only to themselves, the parenthetical sentence on page 34, "(If your group tries an inventory, please let G.S.O. know the results.)" be changed to read: "(Please share with G.S.O. those benefits of your group's inventory which might be of help to other groups.)"

To reaffirm A.A.'s purpose as stated by our co-founder, Bill W.'s writings on "Single Purpose" as they appear on page 304 in *As Bill Sees It* be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

The phrase on page 25 that reads: "...the stigma attached by ignorant people to our illness..." be changed to read "the stigma attached by people ignorant of our illness..."

The phrase on page 30 that reads: "Most of us do not want to cater to the cruel stigma unjustly attached by ignorant people..." be changed to "Most of us do not want to cater to the cruel stigma unjustly attached by people ignorant of our illness..."



The phrase on page 33 that reads: "On the other hand, specialized *groups*—men's, women's, gays'..." be changed to read "On the other hand, specialized *gatherings*—men's, women's, gays'..." because, although the intent was to use the word "group" in a generic sense, its use confuses the issue about the difference between a meeting and a group.

In the pamphlet "44 Questions," page 19, the language be changed to read "Most members arrange to attend meetings as frequently as possible," rather than "Most members arrange to attend at least one meeting a week."

The trustees' Literature Committee further explore the need for simplified material for those with limited vocabularies and report its findings to the 1988 Conference.

A report on the progress of The History of A.A.: 1955-1985 book be made to the 1988 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

1988 It was recommended that:

Work continue on the A.A. history book, and that this be subject to further editing through the coordinating efforts of each regional trustee with each delegate for further updating, corrections, and additional information.

The revision of the manuscript of "A.A. and the Armed Services" be accepted with the following changes:

The Marine story from the current pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services" be included in the revised pamphlet.

The manuscript be returned for editing of Charles' story, to include consideration of references to "drug addiction."

The copy on the A.A. Group Structure be approved with the following additions:

- That "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Public Information Representatives" be added to the diagram entitled "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group."
- That the term "institutions representative" be changed to "treatment facilities/correctional facilities representative."
- That the six-point definition of an A.A. group found on page 32 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to the copy of the second paragraph.

The copy on the structure of an A.A. group be added as a chapter to *The A.A. Service Manual*, pending approval by the Conference Report and Charter Committee.

The copy on the structure of an A.A. group be:

- Produced as a flyer suitable for insertion in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and also as a continuing piece of literature.
- Included in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet at the next revision.

The copy "The Home Group" be accepted for inclusion in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet with the following stipulations:

- That the third paragraph, page two be underlined, "Obviously, as with all group conscience matters, each A.A. member has one vote, and this, ideally, would be through their 'Home Group.'"
- That on page three, paragraph three, line two, "...and greeting newcomers at the door" be added.
- That where repetition of information occurs in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, it be deleted.

"Specialized *gatherings*" found on page 33 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be changed to "specialized *meetings*."

The article in the April/May issue of Box 4-5-9 entitled "Service Sponsorship: A Vital Stepping-Stone to Service and Sobriety" be prepared as a service piece with "Kiwanis Club types" on page four, paragraph two, line three, changed to "Club types."

The manuscript for the Native North American not be approved as presented, but that this manuscript be returned for editing to include consideration of the references to drug addiction, chemical dependency, "junkie" and "clean" and then upon completion of editing be approved for publication.

A more simplified draft of an easy-to-read, illustrated pamphlet of "Is A.A. for You?" be prepared for consideration by the 1989 Conference.

"This is A.A." and "44 Questions" as illustrated flyers not be published at this time.

A simplified, easy-to-read, illustrated "Twelve Steps" pamphlet be prepared for consideration by the 1989 Conference.

Work continue on the Daily Reflections Book and that a request be made for additional manuscripts to be submitted from the Fellowship on any Step, Tradition, or writings by Bill W. coordinated through each delegate with a progress report to be presented at the 1989 Conference.

The Primary Purpose Card continue as a service piece.

The 1980 Task Force recommendation and Conference Action be reaffirmed.

"Any factual or statistical information may be updated whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference Action, i.e., whenever inventory runs low, a new survey is completed, etc. In addition, minor copy cuts to make room for new material added to publications may be made when necessary."

And further recommended:

"That any other changes made in the substance of the Conference-approved literature shall be through the Conference process."

The revised pamphlet "Young People in A.A." be approved for publication with one following revision, that all personal reference be removed from page 51, line 3.

The Self-support flyer "Your DCM" be Conference approved.

A draft of a pamphlet for the gay/lesbian alcoholic be prepared and reviewed by the 1989 Conference.

A proposal from the Northern Minnesota area regarding the use of surveys to determine the need for Conference-approved literature be referred to the appropriate committee for consideration at the 1989 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

1989 It was recommended that:

Work continue on a definitive book on A.A. History from 1955, as recommended by the 1986 General Service Conference, along the lines of a proposal recently submitted to the trustees' Literature Committee, which focuses on major events and developments since the co-founder turned s.A.A. over to the Fellowship, rather than focusing on the beginning of A.A. and the history of the 91 areas of the U.S. and Canada.

A complete manuscript of Daily Reflections be prepared for review by the 1990 Conference Literature Committee because of the good response to the appeals for additional material from the Fellowship.

Work continue on an easy-to-read, illustrated Twelve Steps pamphlet suitable for people with very limited reading skills.



An illustrated, easy-to-read manuscript entitled “Is A.A. for Me?” be approved to help carry the message to people with limited reading skills.

The pamphlet “The A.A. Group” be thoroughly revised to address the many issues and concerns related to A.A. groups which come before the committee year after year such as:

- a. The difference between a group and a meeting;
- b. Meeting formats;
- c. How to obtain a group conscience;
- d. The duties of trusted servants and their alternates;

and others, as described in an outline of contents submitted by the trustees’ Literature Committee.

The manuscript for a pamphlet for gay and lesbian alcoholics be approved with specific editorial changes which will be reviewed by the Conference Literature Committee before publication, and that the title be “A.A. and the Gay/ Lesbian Alcoholic.”

The book *Alcoholics Anonymous* be made available in large print because of an indicated need over the years.

The 16mm film entitled “A.A.—An Inside View” be made available for sale in lieu of long-term lease with the understanding that the film’s copyright is sufficient protection against misuse by outside entities. This recommendation is consistent with our distribution policy for our more recent films which are available to the general public.

All Conference-approved literature shall be developed within the Conference structure, but that identification of need may be established by use of questionnaires developed in cooperation with the appropriate standing Conference committees. (Policy/ Admissions)

1990 It was recommended that:

The revised manuscript for “The A.A. Group” pamphlet be approved with the following change:

The first sentence in the section on Group Inventory, manuscript page 47, be changed to read: “Many groups periodically hold a ‘group inventory’ meeting to evaluate how well they are fulfilling their primary purpose: to help alcoholics recover through A.A.’s suggested Twelve Steps of recovery.”

The A.A. History book project continue to completion, and that the time frame covered be expanded to include 1955 to the present.

The manuscript of the daily reflections book be approved with the following specific changes:

- a. All references to “we” be changed to “I.”
- b. The page for June 17 delete the words “(Psalm 130)” from line 1 of the reflection.
- c. There be an addition of a page for February 29; that page to be the “alternate” for March entitled “True Tolerance.”
- d. That these words be imprinted on the cover of the book: “This is a book of reflections by A.A. members for A.A. members.”

The text and illustrations for the proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet be referred to the trustees’ Literature Committee for rewriting of the easy-to-read text, with the recommendation that this language be further simplified and shortened into simple statements that would direct attention to the illustrations, without attempting to rewrite the Steps; and

bring the text back to the 1991 General Service Conference for approval.

The proposal for a pamphlet on the spiritual aspects of A.A. not be approved, because there is not sufficient need at this time.

The trustees’ Literature Committee study the feasibility of updating the “Circles of Love and Service” filmstrip and video, because of the need to include current information and conditions, and report their findings to the 1991 Conference Literature Committee.

The trustees’ Literature Committee and the Conference Literature Committee consider the paragraph containing the six-point definition in “The A.A. Group” pamphlet, and bring a report and recommendation regarding this back to the 1991 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

1991 It was recommended that:

The A.A. History Book project continue to completion, and that a manuscript be forwarded to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for consideration and approval.

The eleven minor changes suggested by the trustees’ Literature Committee and revised by this committee be included at the next printing of “The A.A. Group” pamphlet, with the exception of insert #2 containing the six-point definition of an A.A. group, which will be deleted.

The “Circles of Love and Service” filmstrip, slides and video not be updated, and that these visual formats be discontinued once the present inventory is depleted. Thereafter, should there be requests for a copy of the video format, it will be provided at cost.

The proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet be published, in response to an expressed need for simplified literature. Estimated cost: \$7,000.

A story of a young person who entered A.A. while in prison be added to the “Young People and A.A.” pamphlet.

- a. The trustees’ Correctional Facilities Committee obtain appropriate stories of several young people who entered A.A. while in juvenile correctional facilities, and forward these to the trustees’ Literature Committee for consideration.
- b. The trustees’ Literature Committee forward one such story to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for consideration and addition to the “Young People and A.A.” pamphlet.

The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be added to *Daily Reflections* at the time of the next printing.

The text of the proposed reflection titled “One A.A. Miracle” be substituted for the present February 29th entry in *Daily Reflections* at the next printing, because of the duplication of entries in the current printing.

The trustees’ Literature Committee study the best possible ways to carry our message to minorities through illustrations and text in A.A. literature, including existing publications and audio and visual formats, and report their findings to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee.

At the next printing of “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” pamphlet, the line “It is significant that the ‘Twelve Concepts for World Service’ is the only piece of Conference-approved literature that carries a personal by-line: ‘by Bill W.’” be deleted, as that statement is no longer accurate.



Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be published in large print, in response to an expressed need. Estimated cost of proofreading: \$500.

The questionnaires in seven Conference-approved pamphlets not be standardized, as the questions in each are targeted to specific populations.

The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be included in all recovery literature, wherever possible.

1992 It was recommended that:

The story of "John" (a young person who entered A.A. while in prison) be added to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." as per the 1991 Conference Action.

The 1986 Advisory Actions (listed below) pertaining to sexist language in the Big Book and other Bill W. writings adequately address the issue:

"As the preface to the Big Book clearly states that the text was written in 1939 and that it has not been changed, no further explanation regarding out-of-date phrases and/or gender-oriented pronouns or chapter titles is necessary." (Advisory Action #31)

"The A.A.W.S. editorial staff continue to degenderize A.A. literature, with the exception of Bill W.'s writings, as the items are reprinted, e.g., 'staffing the booth' rather than 'manning the booth,' etc." (Advisory Action #35)

In lieu of a moratorium on new literature, the ongoing Literature Advisory Subcommittee composed of trustees, delegates and G.S.O. staff continue to review in depth all current and proposed Conference-approved material and service pieces to assure that:

- a. we discourage unnecessary duplication;
- b. we encourage that our singleness of purpose is foremost;
- c. we encourage simplification wherever possible; and report back to the 1993 General Service Conference.

The Twelve Concepts for World Service (short form) be included in all service pamphlets, wherever feasible.

The six-point definition of an A.A. group be removed from all literature and replaced by the long form of Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, Concept XII (listed below):

Tradition Three:

"Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation."

Warranty Six:

". . . much attention has been drawn to the extraordinary liberties which the A.A. Traditions accord to the individual member and to his group: no penalties to be inflicted for nonconformity to A.A. principles; no fees or dues to be levied—voluntary contributions only; no member to be expelled from A.A.—membership always to be the choice of the individual; each A.A. group to conduct its internal affairs as it wishes—it being merely requested to abstain from acts that might injure A.A. as a whole; and finally that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, as a group, they have no other purpose or affiliation."

The trustees' Literature Committee review the terminology of "minorities" and consider that our singleness of purpose is carrying the message to *alcoholics*.

The new A.A. History Book manuscript be returned to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for further review, and then forwarded to the 1993 Conference Literature Committee.

The trustees' Committee on Literature develop material on Service Sponsorship to be forwarded to the 43rd General Service Conference Committee on Report and Charter for possible inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*. (Floor Action)

1993 It was recommended that:

A.A.W.S. produce an anonymity display card with the following verbiage:

"Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. Please respect this and treat in confidence who you see and what you hear."

Because of strong sentiment against any changes in the first 164 pages of the Big Book, the request to rewrite the first three chapters of the Big Book not be implemented.

The 1977 Advisory Action pertaining to the production of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book be reaffirmed:

"The publication of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book should not be undertaken as it would destroy the sentimental value of the actual first edition."

The committee further felt no need exists for such a book.

A.A.W.S. produce a pocket-sized version of the Big Book with all front matter (Preface and various forewords, Doctor's Opinion), basic text, Dr. Bob's Story and Appendices.

The A.A. History Book project be deferred for two years so that a new team of A.A. servants can look at the History Book with fresh ideas.

1994 It was recommended that:

"District Meetings" be added to the inverted triangle in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet after the current inventory is depleted.

The following changes be made in the "G.S.R." pamphlet:

- a. Panel 2, #3
 - Delete the word "also" from the second to last sentence.
 - Delete the last sentence "You might like to suggest that your group buy its own copy" and replace it with: "Copies of the report are available to groups upon request."
- b. Panel 2, #3
 - Delete the word "feeling" in the third sentence and replace it with the word "conscience" so that the sentence now reads "Via your D.C.M. and your delegate, you can see to it that your group's conscience on matters of importance. . ."
- c. Panel 3, #4
 - Insert the words "or your district or area registrar" in the first paragraph after the words "your area committee" so that the sentence now reads, ". . . to the secretary of your area committee, or your district or area registrar and to G.S.O. . ."
- d. Panel 3, #5
 - Delete the words "the directory" in the first sentence. The sentence now reads "In return, G.S.O. sends you the G.S.R. kit. . ."



e. Panel 3, #7

Delete “60-30-10 plan for” and insert the words “importance of.” In the same sentence after “. . . G.S.O.,” add the word “district.” The sentence now reads, “You explain the importance of financial support of your intergroup/central office, G.S.O, district and area committee . . .”

f. Panel 4, #11

Delete the numeral 15 from the first sentence. Because the A.A. guidelines are in constant flux, the numeral 15 is no longer applicable in this sentence.

g. Panel 5, #4

Insert the words “district or” in the sentence. The sentence now reads: “If your district or area committee . . .”

h. Panel 5, #8

At the end of the paragraph, delete the words “public information, institutions, etc.” The paragraph now ends with the words “. . . on special committees.”

i. Panel 6

Delete the entire first paragraph and replace it with “Hence, an A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.’s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service.” (*A.A. Service Manual*, page 7)

j. Panel 6

Fourth paragraph, change the numeral “90” to “91.” The sentence now reads “. . . a body of about 91 delegates . . .”

The entire sentence “Mood-changing medications—including uppers, sedatives, and antidepressants are usually a threat to sobriety and you may want to learn more about this” be deleted from page 18 in the pamphlet “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” and that the next sentence in the paragraph, “The pamphlet ‘The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs’ discusses the problem in detail.” be moved to the end of the same paragraph on page 19.

The sentence now reads, “. . . and either course may lead a sober alcoholic back to the first drink. The pamphlet ‘The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs’ discusses the problem in detail.”

The text of material on “Service Sponsorship” submitted by the trustees’ Literature Committee be included in the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” when current inventory is depleted.

The circle and triangle logo be discontinued on all Conference-approved literature.

The words “This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature” be displayed on the front cover of all A.A. Conference-approved literature wherever possible.

On page S129 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* the portion of the following sentence—which is no longer applicable—in bold, stricken, through type be deleted and the italicized print be substituted as follows: (Report and Charter)

“This process takes time—months—but the results are worth the effort. When the pamphlet or book is finally completed, it is entitled to (carry the “Conference-approved” seal, having

fully earned it) bear the designation, “This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature.”

[Circle/Triangle Design With Words
“General Service Conference” is Deleted]

1995 It was recommended that:

Minor changes in the text of Tradition Three in the “Twelve Traditions Illustrated” pamphlet be implemented after the current inventory is depleted.

Changes in “The A.A. Group” pamphlet be implemented after the current inventory is depleted.

The following paragraph referring to Concept One that was deleted from “The A.A. Group” pamphlet be reinstated:

“The A.A. Group—the final voice of the Fellowship. Alcoholics Anonymous has been called an upside-down organization because ‘The ultimate responsibility and final authority for World Services resides with the groups—rather than with the trustees of the General Service Board or the General Service Office in New York.’” (“The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” pamphlet)

The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, “The Doctor’s Opinion,” “Doctor Bob’s Nightmare” and the Appendices remain as is.

A pocket edition of the Twelve Steps and *Twelve Traditions* be published.

A video on ways that G.S.O. serves the Fellowship be developed, with accompanying service pamphlet.

Note: The committee strongly encouraged the video to include the service structure in some way, similar to the video “Circles of Love and Service,” which has been discontinued. The cost: Current estimates for a 14-minute live action video with voice-over would cost between \$30,000-\$60,000. The accompanying pamphlet would cost about \$6,000.

1997 It was recommended that:

Some video taping of a facsimile of the 47th General Service Conference, as well as of a Conference committee, be permitted, keeping in mind the preservation of our Traditions of anonymity. (For possible inclusion in the video on G.S.O., the Grapevine and the service structure).

After reviewing with appreciation the rough cut of the video on G.S.O., the Grapevine and the service structure, that a final cut of the video be prepared by the trustees’ Literature Committee and forwarded to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee for approval, accompanied by its service piece and including modifications provided to the trustees’ Literature Committee.

A draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be developed and a progress report be brought to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind the 1995 Advisory Action that:

“The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, ‘The Doctor’s Opinion,’ ‘Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,’ and the Appendices remain as is.”

A publication of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be developed, and a progress report be brought to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee.

The following material from the Sixth Warranty be added to the section “What is An A.A. Group?” on page 15 of “The A.A. Group” pamphlet so that section could now include:



A section from Warranty Six found in the Twelfth Concept on page 73 of *The A.A. Service Manual*:

“no penalties to be inflicted for nonconformity to A.A. principles;
no fees or dues to be levied—voluntary contributions only.
no members to be expelled from A.A.—membership always
to be the choice of the individual;
each A.A. group to conduct its internal affairs as it wishes—
it being merely requested to abstain from acts that might
injure A.A. as a whole; and finally
that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety
may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, as a
group, they have no other purpose or affiliation.”

1998 It was recommended that:

The video, “Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure,” be approved for distribution.

A draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, continue to be developed and a progress report brought to the 1999 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that, if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: “The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, ‘The Doctor’s Opinion,’ ‘Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,’ and the Appendices remain as is.”

The following sections from the pamphlet “The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs” be added as an appendix to the booklet *Living Sober* at its next printing:

The lead-in and 9 points on pages 5 & 6 in the section entitled “A report from a group of physicians in A.A.”

Page 13 entitled “However, some alcoholics require medication...” (Floor Action)

1999 It was recommended that:

A progress report and/or a draft copy of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be brought to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind, that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: “The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, ‘The Doctor’s Opinion,’ ‘Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,’ and the Appendices remain as is.”

The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project:

- Editorial “fine tuning” such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.
- Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.
- In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as:

New Material	Changes
Cover and jacket design	Title Page
Jacket copy	Contents Page
Preface	Factual material that appears in footnotes
Foreword to the Fourth Edition	Introductions to personal stories

Based on precedent in regard to previous editions of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a “for-their-eyes-only” basis adhering to the principle of the “right of decision,” and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication.

A draft copy of a pamphlet directed to the Black/African American alcoholic be developed and brought back to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee for review.

The pamphlet “Time to Start Living” be replaced with a new pamphlet to include fewer stories, stories more reflective of the current older population and stories focused more on the recovery experience of the older member, as well as having a new title and published in large print only.

2000 It was recommended that:

Following serious consideration of the comments and suggestions expressed at a joint meeting of the trustees’ and Conference Literature Committees about the proposed new stories and the list of stories from the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* to be included in the Fourth Edition, a draft copy of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, or a progress report be brought to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: “The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, ‘The Doctor’s Opinion,’ ‘Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,’ and the Appendices remain as is.”

2001 It was recommended that:

The Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be approved keeping in mind the 1995 Conference Advisory Action which reads, “The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, ‘The Doctor’s Opinion,’ ‘Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,’ and the Appendices remain as is” and keeping in mind the 1999 Conference Action which reads, “The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project:

- Editorial ‘fine tuning’ such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.
- Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.
- In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as:

New Material	Changes
Cover and jacket design	Title Page
Jacket copy	Contents Page
Preface	Factual material that appears in footnotes
Foreword to the Fourth Edition	Introductions to personal stories

Note: In keeping with the 1997 Conference Action which requested the development of a publication of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the committee asked that the trustees’



Literature Committee bring a draft manuscript of these stories to the 2002 Conference Literature Committee.

Keeping in mind the 1995 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is," the current Preface be updated for the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

The Publications Department of the General Service Office be responsible for the order of stories in the Fourth Edition of the Big Book following page 164 and "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" which will remain as the first story in the "Pioneers of A.A." section.

Note: The committee suggested that the Personal Stories Section Titles in the Fourth Edition of the Big Book remain "Pioneers of A.A.," "They Stopped in Time," and "They Lost Nearly All."

The Twelve Concepts (short form), with a brief introduction, be added to the Appendices Section in future printings of the Big Book.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site address be added to the Appendix "How to Get in Touch with A.A." in future printings of the Big Book.

The pamphlet "Can A.A. Help Me Too?—Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" be approved.

A pamphlet titled "A.A. For the Older Alcoholic—Never Too Late" to replace the pamphlet "Time to Start Living" be approved for publication after the current pamphlet inventory is depleted.

The pamphlet "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic—Never Too Late" be published in 14 point type, large-print format only, as this format would fit our current literature racks.

2002 It was recommended that:

In keeping with the 1997 Conference Action which requested the development of a publication of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, the publication of an Anthology of the last published version of the 56 stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book be approved with the title "Experience, Strength and Hope."

Recognizing the historical nature of the book "Experience, Strength and Hope" and recognizing the fact that editorial changes have been made to various personal stories in later printings of the Big Book, the versions to be printed in "Experience, Strength and Hope" will be the last published version of each story, and those versions remain as is.

The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Big Book Dropped Stories Anthology Project with the title "Experience, Strength and Hope":

- Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.
- The G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material such as:

New Material	Changes
Cover and jacket design	Contents page
Jacket copy	Factual material that appears
Jacket materials	in footnotes
Preface/Foreword	Introductions to personal stories.

All new text material in "Experience, Strength and Hope" is to be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee prior to publication.

The second sentence in the third question in the "A.A. Group Inventory" section, page 35 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, be changed to add the phrase "including those with special needs," so the question reads "Are we seeing a good cross section of our community, including those with special needs?"

The word "accessible" be added to question ten in the "A.A. Group Inventory" section, page 36 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, so the question reads "Are we doing all we can to provide an attractive and accessible meeting place?"

The text in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill W., remain as is, recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writings be retained as originally published.

The second sentence in the second paragraph on page 8 in the pamphlet "This Is A.A." be changed from "There are even a few self-proclaimed atheists and agnostics among us," to "There are also atheists and agnostics among us."

The first sentence, first paragraph on page 36 in the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" be changed from "Yes, A.A. is a spiritual program, providing no material aid, but it is not a religious program in any sectarian sense," to "Yes, A.A. is a spiritual program, not a religious program."

The sentence "Some areas, however, rotate half their committee members each year," appearing in 2001-2002 *The A.A. Service Manual* be added to the "When is the D.C.M. elected?" section of the "Your D.C.M." flyer.

Updated text, reflecting changes in the G.S.O. Group Services assignment, information about the A.A. G.S.O. Web site, and minor editorial changes, be added to the "Your A.A. General Service Office" pamphlet.

An updated draft copy of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet be developed to include current experience of A.A. members in the armed services to be brought back to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee for review.

Although the committee acknowledged the importance of electronic meetings to some A.A. members, the sentence "Fundamentally, though, the difference between an electronic meeting and the home group around the corner is only one of format," in the last paragraph of the Foreword to the Fourth Edition, be deleted in future printings of the Big Book, *Alcoholic Anonymous*.

2003 It was recommended that:

A draft Introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be developed by the General Service Office's Publications Department and reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee and brought back to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration.

Note: The purpose of adding an Introduction would be to explain the language in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and would include the following information:

- Time and era of publication
- Language as a reflection of the time period

Reference to the 2002 Conference Advisory Action:

"It was unanimously recommended that the text in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill W.



remain as is recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writings be retained as originally published."

This Introduction is to create a unified response to questions regarding specific language, idioms, and historical figures or events from A.A. members, newcomers and non alcoholics.

The updated draft manuscript of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet be approved.

Note: This draft manuscript was not distributed to all Conference members based on the 1993 Additional Committee Consideration of the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee:

"The committee reviewed Conference policy as it relates to restricted or confidential matters, and agreed that restrictions apply only to legal matters that are pending, and to literature/audiovisual projects that are works in progress."

The following changes to "The A.A. Grapevine" section of "Your A.A. General Service Office" pamphlet be approved:

- a. Replace the second sentence "Members of the editorial staff are A.A.s; the controller, circulation supervisor, and clerical workers are nonalcoholics" with the sentence "Some of the editorial staff are A.A. members."
- b. Add a third sentence "Since 1995 the Grapevine has also published La Viña for Spanish-speaking A.A.s."
- c. Replace the last sentence "All stories submitted are acknowledged with personal letters" with the sentence "All stories submitted are acknowledged by the Grapevine staff."

The phrase, "not even your parents," be deleted from the second sentence in the sixth panel of the story "Vinnie" in the pamphlet "Too Young."

The trustees' Literature Committee initiate a comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and that the trustees' Literature Committee bring a draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration. The committee requests that the secretary of the trustees' Literature Committee send a letter to all General Service Conference members requesting suggestions for updates or revisions to this pamphlet.

The following text changes to add La Viña information to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved:

- a. Change "Grapevine Representative" to "Grapevine/ La Viña Representative" on the chart on page 24.
- b. Change fourth paragraph title on page 27 from "Grapevine Representative (GvR)" to "Grapevine/ La Viña Representative (GvR/RLV)."
- c. Add new third paragraph as follows to the "Grapevine Representative (GvR)" section on page 27:
"La Viña representatives (RLVs) perform the same functions as the GvRs in Spanish-speaking groups and districts where La Viña, the Grapevine's magazine in Spanish, is 'our meeting in print.' Some districts or groups may also combine GvR and RLV functions."
- d. Change address and Grapevine material information on pages 27 and 28 to read:
 - "New GvRs and RLVs should send their name, address, group name and group service number to: the Grapevine, 475 Riverside Drive, Room 1040, New York, NY 10115.
 - . . . and for books, tape cassettes, CDs and other Grapevine items available."

The updated illustrations and text revisions suggested by the trustees' Literature Committee to reflect contemporary language, clothing and hair styles and to add ethnic and age diversity to the pamphlet "What Happened to Joe..." be approved. All text and illustration changes in the revised pamphlet "What Happened to Joe" are to be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee prior to publication.

Based on a suggestion from the trustees' Literature Committee, a draft manuscript of a new comic book format pamphlet which would have current language and updated illustrations to replace the pamphlet 'It Happened to Alice!' be developed and brought back to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for review. The concept for this pamphlet would be based on a single working mother who is involved in a drunk-driving incident followed by introduction to A.A.

The development of a Third Edition of the Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, by the trustees' Literature Committee be approved and that a report from the trustees' Literature Committee be brought to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee specifying suggestions for contents, process and story solicitation for the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book.

2004 It was recommended that:

The Publications Department rewrite the pamphlet "Too Young?" with changes to layout and style as determined by Publications, targeting the ages of 11-17, and present the revised draft pamphlet to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.

The Publications Department update and shorten existing stories, wherever appropriate, in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," and that the trustees' Literature Committee add new younger age stories solicited from the Fellowship to reflect current experience, and present the revised draft pamphlet or a progress report to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

A draft Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be developed by the trustees' Literature Committee and that a progress report be brought back to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee, in keeping with the trustees' recommendations on contents, process and story solicitation, as follows:

I Contents

- a. The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.
- b. The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference approval.
- c. Personal Stories:
 - Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
 - Select stories from A.A.'s La Viña magazine.
 - Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
 - Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.



II Story Solicitation

- a. Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

III Story Selection Process

- a. To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- b. Story selection subcommittee:
 - All bilingual — Spanish and English
 - Spanish editors
 - Spanish-speaking staff members
 - Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship
- c. Basic Selection Criteria:
 - To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations.
 - Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
 - Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

The text on page 11 under the heading "May a newcomer have more than one sponsor?" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be removed and replaced with the following text:

"Many feel it is best for a newcomer to have only one sponsor. Choosing one sponsor helps to avoid the precarious practice of a newcomer going from sponsor to sponsor seeking the advice he or she wants to hear.

"However, some newcomers benefit from more than one sponsor. Here the newcomer shares in a wide range of experience and hears a great variety of ways to use the A.A. program. In addition, this is a means of averting the crisis mentioned in the preceding question—it is unlikely that two or more sponsors would be unavailable at the same time."

and, the sentence "Again, the answer is yes." be removed from the paragraph under the heading "May a newcomer change sponsors?" on page 11.

The trustees' Literature Committee broaden the section titled "service sponsorship" on page 28 in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to reflect current shared experience and present a revised draft to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

The punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare" in the Fourth Edition be restored as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. (Floor Action)

2005 It was recommended that:

The following introduction be added to the front matter of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*:

Introduction

Alcoholics Anonymous first published this book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, in 1953. Bill W., who, along with Dr. Bob S., founded Alcoholics Anonymous in 1935, wrote the book to share 18 years of collective experience within the Fellowship on how A.A. members recover, and how our society functions.

In recent years some members and friends of A.A. have asked if it would be wise to update the language, idioms,

and historical references to present a more contemporary image for the Fellowship. However, because the book has helped so many alcoholics find recovery, there exists strong sentiment within the Fellowship against any change to it. In fact, the 2002 General Service Conference discussed this issue and "it was unanimously recommended that the text in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill W., remain as is, recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writing be retained as originally published."

We hope that the collective spiritual experience of the A.A. pioneers captured in these pages continues to help alcoholics and friends of A.A. understand the principles of our program.

The pamphlet "Young People and A.A." be revised to include eleven current, and eight new stories, and that the Publications Department forward the revised draft pamphlet or a progress report to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.

The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action regarding the trustees' recommendations on contents, process and story solicitation and that a progress report and/or draft copy be brought to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee.

The addition of the following four paragraphs to the current section titled "Service Sponsorship" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be approved with minor revisions to the current pamphlet text suggested by the committee:

- a. ...A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer —ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service. — The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service, page S1.
- b. A service sponsor is usually someone who is knowledgeable in A.A. history and has a strong background in the service structure. The A.A. member is introduced to a new language: G.S.R., D.C.M., area assembly, minority opinion. They will become familiar with the Traditions, Concepts and General Warranties, as well as the A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, A.A. Comes of Age and other A.A. literature.
- c. Co-founder Dr. Bob said, "I spend a great deal of time passing on what I learned to others who want and need it badly. I do it for four reasons:
 1. Sense of duty.
 2. It is a pleasure.
 3. Because in doing so I am paying my debt to the man who took time to pass it on to me.
 4. Because every time I do it I take out a little more insurance for myself against a possible slip."
- d. The basis of all sponsorship is to lead by example. Service sponsors can impart to their sponsees the pleasure of involvement in the work of Alcoholics Anonymous. This is best done by stressing the spiritual nature of service work and by pointing out the usefulness of simple footwork and faith.



The manuscript of the revised pamphlet “The A.A. Group” that includes revisions suggested by the committee be approved.

The text under the heading “The A.A. Grapevine” in the pamphlet “Your A.A. General Service Office” be replaced with the following:

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

As it has since 1944, the A.A. Grapevine serves as the monthly magazine of Alcoholics Anonymous. Articles, drawings and photographs, which reflect the growth of A.A. over the years, are not paid for, but contributed by members in free sharing of experience and thought, as at an A.A. meeting. You do not have to be a professional writer or artist to contribute to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña, A.A.’s Spanish-language magazine. All submissions are welcomed and acknowledged. Manuscripts are always read by A.A. members on the editorial staff. Published material is protected by copyright, held by the A.A. Grapevine Inc. — a corporation entirely separate from A.A. World Services, Inc. For editorial submissions, or to subscribe to the magazines, please contact the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., 475 Riverside Drive, New York, NY 10115; or visit the Web site at www.aagrapevine.org.

The term “sexual preference” be replaced with “sexual orientation” on page 10 in the pamphlet “A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic.”

2006 It was recommended that:

The revised draft pamphlet “Too Young?” be approved.

The revised draft pamphlet “It Happened To Alice!” be approved.

The pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American” be revised.

The word “largely” be added to the second sentence in the second paragraph of the preface to the Fourth Edition on page xi, as it originally appeared in the preface of the Second Edition, so that the sentence reads:

“Therefore, the first portion of this volume, describing the A.A. recovery program, has been left largely untouched in the course of revisions made for the second, third, and fourth editions.”

Note: Keeping in mind the note that was included with the 1955 General Service Conference Advisory Actions, “In presenting the updating of the first edition of the Big Book, Bill described the background of his long-range writing project and made the following point(s): 1. ‘Not an iota’ of the first part of the text dealing with recovery principles had been changed,” the committee agreed that the addition of the word “largely” accurately reflects revisions made to the first 164 pages of the Big Book and is consistent with the original language in the preface to the Second Edition.

The word “largely” be added to the second sentence in the first paragraph in the Introduction to the book, *Experience, Strength, and Hope* on page ix, so that the sentence reads:

“In all four editions, the first 164 pages have remained largely unchanged, preserving A.A.’s message just as it was originally recorded by the founding members.”

The draft manuscript of the pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” be approved.

The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed and that a report be

brought back to the 2007 Conference Literature Committee, in keeping with a 2004 Conference Advisory Action on contents, story solicitation, and process, as follows:

I Contents

- a. The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.
- b. The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, “The Doctor’s Opinion,” “Dr. Bob’s Nightmare,” and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.’s writings and does not require Conference approval.
- c. Personal Stories:
 - Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
 - Select stories from A.A.’s La Viña magazine.
 - Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
 - Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

II Story Solicitation

- a. Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

III Story Selection Process

- a. To be under the direction of the trustees’ Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- b. Story selection subcommittee:
 - All bilingual — Spanish and English.
 - Spanish editors.
 - Spanish-speaking staff members.
 - Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship.
- c. Basic Selection Criteria:
 - To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.’s recommendations.
 - Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
 - Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

The pamphlet “Letter to A Woman Alcoholic” be discontinued.

2007 It was recommended that:

The following text from *The A.A. Service Manual* be added to “The A.A. Group” and the “G.S.R.” pamphlets:

“Financial Support: Current experience indicates that many groups provide financial support for their general service representatives to attend service functions.”

The title of the pamphlet “Can A.A. Help Me Too?” subtitled “Black/African Americans Share Their Stories” be changed to “A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic.”

The pamphlet, “The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs” be revised to include current experience of A.A. mem-



bers and that a revised draft pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature.

The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be produced, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action on contents, story selection, and process, as follows:

I Contents

- a. The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book
- b. The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference-approval.
- c. Personal Stories:
 - Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
 - Select stories from A.A.'s La Vina magazine.
 - Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
 - Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

II Story Solicitation

- a. Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

III Story Selection Process

- a. To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- b. Story selection subcommittee:
 - All bilingual—Spanish and English:
 - Spanish editors.
 - Spanish-speaking staff members.
 - Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship.
- c. Basic Selection Criteria:
 - To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations.
 - Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
 - Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

and, that the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book include:

- *Updated translations* of Bill's Own Story, Dr. Bob's Nightmare, the stories "Alcoholics Anonymous #3" and "Women Suffer Too."
- The existing twelve original stories from the Second Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- Up to 32 new selected Spanish-language stories.
- Translations of the Forewords to the English Edition and the Foreword to the existing edition.
- A new Foreword to be developed by the Publications

Department explaining the process and development of the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book.

The committee acknowledged that the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and recognized that translations of Bill W.'s writings do not require Conference-approval.

2009 It was recommended that:

The revised draft pamphlet, "A.A. for the Native North American," be approved.

The trustees' Literature Committee undertake a through review of the pamphlet, "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and eliminate or revise outmoded ethnic, cultural and vocational references.

A Special Needs recovery pamphlet for newcomers or prospective members be developed and that stories be solicited from members with various special needs, for example, members who are deaf, blind, wheel-chair bound, etc. [Note: The approximate cost is \$6,850.]

A sentence encouraging newcomers to obtain and study the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be added to the pamphlet, "A Newcomer Asks."

The title of the pamphlet, "44 Questions," be changed to "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A."

The revised 59th Conference pamphlet, "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," be returned to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and report back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature. (Floor Action)

Note: This Floor Action refers to the *draft* pamphlet reviewed by the 2009 Conference Literature Committee.

2010 It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be approved.

The trustees' Committee on Literature develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous, and bring a draft or progress report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.

The paragraph regarding closed meetings on page 22 of the pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions about A.A.," which reads:

"A closed meeting is limited to members of the local A.A. group or visiting members from other groups. The purpose of the closed meetings is to give members an opportunity to discuss particular phases of their alcoholic problem that can be understood best only by other alcoholics."

Be replaced with:

"A closed meeting is for A.A. members only, or for those who have a drinking problem and have a desire to stop drinking. Closed meetings give members an opportunity to discuss particular phases of their alcoholic problem that can be understood best only by other alcoholics."

The trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services" to include recent experiences from members on active duty and a section which focuses on veterans of the armed services, and that the range of experiences be reflected in the title of the pamphlet. The committee requested that a draft or progress report be brought to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.



The trustees' Committee on Literature review the booklet *Living Sober* and present a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.

The revised 60th Conference draft pamphlet, "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," be returned to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature. (Floor Action)

2011 It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved.

The trustees' Literature Committee continue to develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee expressed support for the trustees' efforts to develop a pamphlet which reflects the wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members and asked that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration.

The following text under "When you're a G.S.R.," in the pamphlet "G.S.R. General Service Representative" which currently reads:

You are linking your home group with the whole of A.A. Back in 1953, when the "group contact" was suggested as a new type of trusted servant, the job was seen simply as a good means of exchanging up-to-date information..."

Be replaced with:

"You are linking your home group with the whole of A.A. In 1950, a new type of trusted servant, "group representative," was suggested to help in the selection of delegates to the newly-formed General Service Conference. By 1953, the job of 'group representative' was also seen as a good means of exchanging up-to-date information..."

2012 It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services" be approved.

The short form of the Twelve Concepts for World Service be added to the book *As Bill Sees It*.

The final revision of the *Living Sober* booklet, with changes to outdated language or practices, be approved with minor editorial changes.

The pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" be revised, and requested that the trustees' Committee on Literature prepare a draft pamphlet or progress report for the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature.

2013 It was recommended that:

The draft pamphlet "A.A.—Spiritual not Religious" be recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and brought back to the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature.

2014 It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" be approved.

The pamphlet on spirituality with the title "Many Paths to Spirituality" be approved.

A correction to inaccurate text related to the addition of appendices on page xi in the Preface of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, which currently reads:

"The second edition added the appendices, the Twelve Traditions, and the directions for getting in touch with A.A."

Be replaced with:

"The second printing of the first edition added the appendix 'Spiritual Experience'; in the second edition, the appendices on A.A. Tradition, the 'medical view' and 'religious view' of A.A., the Lasker Award and information on how to contact A.A. were added, and the appendix on the Alcoholic Foundation was discontinued."

The Conference recommended that the following recommendation be returned to the A.A.W.S. Board for review and brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on Literature with full background:

The committee recommended that "The A.A.W.S., Inc. Policy on Publication of Literature" be further clarified regarding "...needed editorial changes" as noted below by asterisk and bolded text:

"Unless otherwise specified in the Advisory Action of the Conference approving a new or amended piece of literature, A.A. World Services, Inc. will have the full authority, without need of further Conference action to (a) select the format or formats in which the approved literature will be produced, (b) make, from time to time, needed editorial changes*; provided, however, that no editorial change will be made to the Big Book's Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' the first 164 pages (Chapters 1-11), 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' or the Appendices without prior Conference approval of such change, and (c) translate the approved literature into any language, and in connection therewith to modify or replace illustrations, photos, and other visual art in a manner reasonably designed to conform them to the culture of the expected readership."

"Editorial changes to be limited to factual, statistical, capitalization, punctuation and spelling; that any other changes made to the substance of the Conference-approved literature shall be through the Conference process."

2015 It was recommended that:

The revised draft pamphlet "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Service Agencies," with the revised title "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services," be approved with minor corrections.

A comprehensive revision to the retitled pamphlet "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services," be undertaken by the trustees' Literature Committee, to better reflect the full range of A.A. services, and that a fully revised draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2016 General Service Conference.

The revised pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" be approved with minor corrections.

The trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic" to include a wider range of A.A. recovery experience from members who are gay, lesbian, bisexual, transgendered and gender nonconforming, especially regarding being a newcomer and sponsorship. The committee requested that the title of the pamphlet be revised to reflect this broader scope and that a draft revised pamphlet or



progress report be brought to the 2016 Conference Committee on Literature.

The trustees' Literature Committee develop literature for the alcoholic with mental health issues. The committee requested that a wide range of A.A. recovery experience be gathered from members with mental health issues, and from those who sponsor such members for inclusion in literature on this topic. The committee requested that a progress report be brought to the 2016 Conference Committee on Literature.

The pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" be revised by gathering current sharing from women in A.A., and suggested inclusion of stories from women in the military, single mothers, and women of diverse backgrounds. The committee requested that a draft revised pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2016 Conference Committee on Literature.

2016 It was recommended that:

The trustees' Literature Committee develop a plan that includes a systematic schedule for the annual review of recovery literature items, taking into consideration the following: content, relevance, and usefulness; and prioritized by time span since last review. The committee requested that the plan also include an annual report, to be forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee, reflecting the results of their review and any other items for proposed updates or revisions.

The trustees' Literature Committee revise the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." to include information about young people's conferences and that the proposed text be brought to the 2017 Conference Literature Committee for review.

The trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." to better reflect the experiences of young people in A.A. today. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought to the 2017 Conference Literature Committee.

The trustees' Literature Committee undertake a comprehensive revision of the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" with a modernized presentation of both text and illustrations to reflect contemporary A.A. experience. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought to the 2017 Conference Literature Committee.

2017 It was recommended that:

The following two bullet points in the section "What procedures can a group set up to sponsor new members?" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be removed:

- A file of names, addresses, and phone numbers of newcomers (who wish to volunteer the information), with notations showing sponsor or sponsors for each one.
- Review of newcomers list by steering committee (or Twelfth Step or sponsorship committee) — with follow-up activity where it seems needed.

The revised plan for the annual review of recovery literature be implemented, with the first report to be delivered to the 2018 Conference Committee on Literature.

The following text about young people's conferences be added to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." in the section "Where do I find A.A.?"

Young people's conferences are held in the United States and Canada and around the world. For information, consult your local A.A. area, intergroup office, or search online for YPAA.

Question 10 in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" in the section "A.A. Group Inventory" that currently reads, "Are we doing all we can to provide an attractive and accessible meeting place?" be revised to read:

Are we doing all we can to provide a safe, attractive and accessible meeting place?

The pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be revised to add the following text from "Safety and A.A.: Our Common Welfare" to the section "Principles Before Personalities":

Safety and A.A.: Suggestions to Consider

"Safety is an important issue within A.A. — one that all groups and members can address to develop workable solutions and help keep our meetings safe based on the fundamental principles of the Fellowship.

"Each member of Alcoholics Anonymous is but a small part of a great whole. A.A. must continue to live or most of us will surely die. Hence our common welfare comes first. But individual welfare follows close afterward." (Tradition One, Long Form)

"A.A. groups are spiritual entities made up of alcoholics who gather for the sole purpose of staying sober and helping other alcoholics to achieve sobriety. Yet, we are not immune to the difficulties that affect the rest of humanity.

"Alcoholics Anonymous is a microcosm of the larger society within which we exist. Problems found in the outside world can also make their way into the rooms of A.A. As we strive to share in a spirit of trust, both at meetings and individually with sponsors and friends, it is reasonable for each member to expect a meaningful level of safety. Those attending A.A. meetings derive a benefit by providing a safe environment in which alcoholics can focus on gaining and maintaining sobriety. The group can then fulfill its primary purpose — to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers. For this reason, groups and members discuss the topic of safety."

For more information see "Safety and A.A.: Our Common Welfare" (SMF-209) www.aa.org.

The trustees' Literature Committee develop language regarding safety to be incorporated in current and new recovery literature, where appropriate, along with a plan for implementation. The committee requested that the draft language and proposed plan or progress report be brought back to the 2018 General Service Conference.

The pamphlet "Too Young?" be revised to reflect more current collective experiences of young alcoholics and their welcome to A.A. (Floor Action)

2018 It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman," retitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: Women in A.A.," be approved.

The revised pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic," retitled "Experience, Strength and Hope: LGBTQ Alcoholics in A.A.," be approved with minor edits provided by Publishing regarding use of gender-specific language.

The revised pamphlet "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and its Services" be approved.

The draft pamphlet "Experience, Strength and Hope: A.A. for Alcoholics with Mental Health Issues — and their sponsors" be approved.



The trustees' Literature Committee revise the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to include a section on anonymity, and bring back a progress report or draft text to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.

The title of the pamphlet "G.S.R. General Service Representative: May Be the Most Important Job in A.A." be changed to "G.S.R. General Service Representative: Your Group's Link to A.A. as a Whole."

The following text (originally included in the 1998 edition of *Living Sober*) be added to *Living Sober* following the section titled "Note to Medical Professionals":

We recognize that alcoholics are not immune to other diseases. Some of us have had to cope with depressions that can be suicidal; schizophrenia that sometimes requires hospitalization; bipolar disorder, and other mental and biological illnesses. Also among us are diabetics, epileptics, members with heart trouble, cancer, allergies, hypertension, and many other serious physical conditions.

Because of the difficulties that many alcoholics have with drugs, some members have taken the position that no one in A.A. should take any medication. While this position has undoubtedly prevented relapses for some, it has meant disaster for others.

A.A. members and many of their physicians have described situations in which depressed patients have been told by A.A.s to throw away the pills, only to have depression return with all its difficulties, sometimes resulting in suicide. We have heard, too, from members with other conditions, including schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, epilepsy and others requiring medication, that well-meaning A.A. friends discourage them from taking any prescribed medication. Unfortunately, by following a layperson's advice, the sufferers find that their conditions can return with all their previous intensity. On top of that, they feel guilty because they are convinced that "A.A. is against pills."

It becomes clear that just as it is wrong to enable or support any alcoholic to become readdicted to any drug, it's equally wrong to deprive any alcoholic of medication, which can alleviate or control other disabling physical and/or emotional problems.

The trustees' Literature Committee undertake a comprehensive update to the video "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure" to reflect a contemporary presentation of the General Service and AA Grapevine offices as well as a current portrayal of the General Service Structure, and bring back a progress report or draft updated video to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.

The pamphlet "The God Word" (currently published by the General Service Board of A.A., Great Britain) be adopted by A.A. World Services, Inc. with minor editorial changes.

The trustees' Literature Committee develop a pamphlet based on A.A.'s Three Legacies, with emphasis on the history of the Three Legacies, how they work together and including personal stories of members' experiences with the Three Legacies, and bring back a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.

The trustees' Literature Committee develop a pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women alcoholics by gathering sharing from Spanish-speaking women in A.A., and bring back a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.

2019 It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be revised to add the following text regarding anonymity:

1. Under the section, "What does a sponsor do and not do?" (p. 13), after the current bullet "Impresses upon the newcomer the importance of all our Traditions," add a new bullet with the following language:

Emphasizes the relevance and spiritual value of anonymity, both on a person to person basis, as well as at the public level including social media. (For more information see the pamphlet, "Understanding Anonymity").

2. Under the section, "How can a sponsor explain the A.A. program?" (p. 15), add a 6th paragraph:

Many sponsors discuss the significance of anonymity at a personal level and public level early on. Anonymity at a personal level provides protection for all members from the identification as alcoholics, a safeguard often of special importance to newcomers. At the public level of press, radio, films, and other media technologies, such as the internet, anonymity stresses the equality in the Fellowship of all members by putting the brake on those who might otherwise exploit their A.A. affiliation to achieve recognition, power, or personal gain. The sponsor is quick to point out the benefit of anonymity at this public level. Sponsors may provide examples from their own experience of maintaining public anonymity.

The trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" and bring back a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2020 General Service Conference.

The trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" and bring back a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2020 General Service Conference.

The proposed floor action that "A draft Fourth Edition of the Spanish Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be developed and a progress report be brought to the 2020 General Service Conference" be committed to the trustees' Literature Committee. (Floor Action)

The proposed floor action that "The pamphlet 'A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic' be updated and a progress report and/or a draft be presented to the 2020 General Service Conference" be committed to the trustees' Literature Committee. (Floor Action)

The "A.A.W.S. Policy on Publication of Literature: Updating Pamphlets and Other A.A. Materials" be recommitted to the trustees' Literature Committee with an updated proposed policy to be brought back to the 70th General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

2020 It was recommended that:

The updated draft video of "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure" be approved.

The "A.A.W.S. Policy on Publication of Literature: Updating Pamphlets and Other A.A. Materials," approved by the A.A. World Services, Inc. Board of Directors in January 2020, be acknowledged and accepted by the General Service Conference.

2021 It was recommended that:

The "A.A.W.S. Policy on Conversion of Written Conference-approved Literature and Service Material into Video Format,"



approved by the A.A. World Services, Inc. Board of Directors in January 2020, be acknowledged and accepted by the General Service Conference.

A Fifth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be developed, including an update of stories to better reflect current membership, keeping in mind the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is," and that a progress report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

Pending its development, the draft Fifth Edition of the Big Book would include a new foreword, an updated preface and updates to expand on existing ideas in Appendices III and V.

A revision be made to page 117 in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, replacing the phrase "opposite sex" with the word "partner" as follows, and that a footnote be added to provide context to the change as it relates to inclusivity:

The text on page 117 which currently reads:

"Nearly every sound human being, experiences at some time in life, a compelling desire to find a mate of the opposite sex with whom the fullest possible union can be made — spiritual, mental, emotional, and physical. This mighty urge is the root of great human accomplishments, a creative energy that deeply influences our lives. God fashioned us that way...."

Be revised to read:

"Nearly every sound human being, experiences at some time in life, a compelling desire to find a partner with whom the fullest possible union can be made — spiritual, mental, emotional, and physical. This mighty urge is the root of great human accomplishments, a creative energy that deeply influences our lives. God fashioned us that way...."

The sentence which includes the phrase "lustful enough to rape" in paragraph one on page 66 in the chapter "Step Six" of the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, be revised to refer to the Seven Deadly Sins without specific mention of examples that are severe in nature as follows, and that a footnote be added to provide context as to the basis for the change:

The text on page 66 which currently reads:

"No one wants to be angry enough to murder, lustful enough to rape, gluttonous enough to ruin his health."

Be revised to read:

"No one wants to commit the deadly sins of anger, lust or gluttony."

The pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic" be updated to include fresh stories and a new title that is respectful and inclusive and that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

The existing version of the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" not be retired.

The draft update of the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" be approved with the working title, "Experience Has Taught Us: Our Twelve Traditions Illustrated."

The Long Form of each Tradition be included at the end of each essay for that Tradition in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and that the complete set of Traditions at the back of the book be retained as is.

A Fourth Edition of the book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be developed, including an update of stories to better reflect current membership, and that a progress report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

The pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A." be revised by omitting the text on page 17 "...including coffee, sandwiches, cakes or whatever else may be served," as follows:

The line on page 17 that currently reads:

"...to defray the cost of renting a meeting place and other meeting expenses, including coffee, sandwiches, cakes or whatever else may be served."

Be revised to read:

"...to defray the cost of renting a meeting place and other meeting expenses."

The paragraph containing the suggestion that sponsor and newcomer be of the same sex on page 12 in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be revised as follows:

The paragraph on page 12 currently reads:

In most instances, A.A. custom does suggest one limitation, already noted on page 10: If the group is large enough to allow a choice, sponsor and newcomer be of the same sex. The reasons are the same from both viewpoints; we A.A. members, no matter how long we have been sober, remain thoroughly human, subject to emotions that might divert us from "our primary purpose."

Be revised to read:

A.A. custom does suggest one limitation: sponsorship should be avoided whenever a romantic entanglement might arise between sponsor and sponsee. We A.A. members, no matter how long we have been sober, remain thoroughly human, subject to emotions that might divert us from "our primary purpose."

The draft pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women in A.A. be approved.

A draft version of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* (Fourth Edition), be translated into plain and simple language and be developed in a way that is accessible and relatable to as wide of an audience as possible and that a progress report or draft be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

The pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American" be updated to include language that is both respectful and inclusive of all Indigenous peoples as well as add fresh stories and updating inaccuracies contained in the current pamphlet and that a draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature. (Floor Action)

2022 It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be revised to add the following text regarding safety and A.A.:

1. In the section "For the person wanting to be a sponsor" (p. 14) under the heading "What does a sponsor do and not do?":
Stresses the importance of A.A. being a safe place for all members and encourages members to become familiar with service material available from the General Service Office such as "Safety in A.A. — Our Common Welfare."
2. In the section "for groups planning sponsorship activity" (p. 23), under the heading "How does sponsorship help a group?" add a fourth paragraph:



Sponsorship can also help a group to create a welcoming and secure environment. Safety is an issue affecting all members and it is important for groups to remain accessible to all who are seeking recovery. Sponsorship can help keep the group focused on the common welfare.

The booklet *Living Sober* be revised to add the following paragraph regarding safety and A.A. in chapter 29, page 76:

Of course, A.A. is a reflection of the larger society around us and problems found in the outside world can also make their way into the rooms of A.A. But by keeping the focus on our common welfare and primary purpose, groups can help provide a safe and secure environment for all their members.

The video animation of the pamphlet “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” (currently published by the General Service Board of A.A. Great Britain) be adapted and produced by the Publishing Department. The committee requested a progress report or rough cut be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.

The draft of the pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” be approved.

The pamphlet “Twelve Traditions Illustrated” be updated with non-offensive, contemporary text and illustrations and that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.

The updated pamphlet “Is A.A. for You?” be approved.

The updated pamphlet “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” be approved.

The updated pamphlet “Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.” be approved.

The updated pamphlet “This Is A.A.” be approved.

The trustees’ Committee on Literature continue to make edits to the draft pamphlet “The Twelve Steps Illustrated” with a new draft or progress report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature, keeping in mind: color, diverse expressions of spirituality and accessible interpretation of meaning in the illustrations. (Floor Action)

2023 It was recommended that:

- The revised draft of the existing version of the pamphlet “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated” be approved.
- The print version of the pamphlet “Too Young” be retired and the content be repurposed as an animation video at an estimated cost no higher than \$70,000. The committee requested that a progress report or a rough cut of the video be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The work on the draft pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies be ceased. The committee noted that the material gathered would be most useful as service material.

2024 It was recommended that:

- The pamphlets “It Happened to Alice” (P-39) and “What Happened to Joe” (P-38) be retired.
- The draft of the revised pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic” (retitled “Black in A.A.: Experience, Strength and Hope”) be approved with the following minor editorial changes:
 - » Generalize terminology surrounding drug and addiction references.

» Removal of one story.

» The removal of the political commentary within two stories.

- The draft manuscript *Plain Language Big Book: A Tool for Reading Alcoholics Anonymous* be approved with minor editorial changes to include:
 - » Relocation of the “A.A. Steps Table” to constitute an Appendix (on the Twelve Steps) at the back of the new publication.
 - » Replace the references to “addiction” and “addicted” with language related to alcoholism.
- The “Too Young?” video adaptation project be permanently suspended.
- The word “donation” be utilized to state that A.A. does not accept donations from outside entities; and that the word “contributions” be utilized when referring to Seventh Tradition contributions from A.A. members, in AAWS literature as it comes up for reprint.
- A pamphlet on the Asian and Asian-American alcoholic in A.A. be developed and that a draft or progress report be brought to the 2025 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

2025 It was recommended that:

- The trustees’ Literature Committee update the language and content of the book *Living Sober* with a progress report or draft manuscript to be delivered to the 2026 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The proposals to rescind or revise the *Plain Language Big Book* be collected and deferred until the 77th General Service Conference to allow for a wider Fellowship experience.
- The development of a process within the trustees’ Literature Committee for receiving, assessing and forwarding proposed changes to the *Plain Language Big Book* to the Conference Committee on Literature.
- The developed video animation of the pamphlet “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” be approved with minor edits.
- The revised pamphlet “The Twelve Steps Illustrated” be approved.
- The revised pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American” (Retitled “Indigenous People in A.A.”) be approved.
- The revisions to the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” be approved with minor editorial changes and formatting standards.
- Begin a study to explore the needs of Spanish-speaking members for tools to access the Big Book. This study will include identifying specific needs within the Spanish-speaking community to determine whether a plain language translation of the Big Book is an appropriate tool or if other accessible materials would be more effective to support Spanish-speaking members who face barriers related to literacy or comprehension. (Floor Action)



Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee on Conference Policy And Admissions

1952 It was recommended that:

The Conference limit and define this Committee's responsibilities to cover only matters pertaining to the Conference itself.

The Conference authorize this Committee to act for it in deciding questions of delegate representation, as well as such other matters as may properly be placed before it.

Terms of office for members of Conference Committees who are on the second panel should be extended to two years, in order to ensure a carry-over on each committee of the previous year's experience. Also, that in the future, all new Conference Committee members should be elected for a term of two years.

Conference Committee Chairmen should be elected from the new members of the Conference.

Conference Committee Secretaries should serve in an advisory capacity only, and should not be entitled to a Committee vote.

Third panel members should assemble next year one day prior to assemblage of the full Conference.

The Third Legacy Pamphlet should be followed next year in determining delegate representation.

The Policy Committee to be elected in 1954 consider the advisability of recommending an enlarged Panel for 1955.

No action be taken that would alter present provisions of two-year terms for Conference delegates. (Floor Action)

The principle of rotation at all levels of A.A. affairs should be preserved and strengthened. (Floor Action)

1953 It was recommended that:

Committeemen elected during the year be put on the General Service Conference Mailing list in February. And that the delegate be put on the mailing list as soon as Headquarters is notified of his election.

Delegate representation should not be changed during the first five-year period.

The Third Legacy pamphlet should continue to be followed in determining delegate representation.

During the five-year period, all ex-delegates remain on The General Conference mailing list.

Groups who have not corresponded with Headquarters for two years or more be taken off the mailing list; and that the names of such groups be referred to state delegates for follow-up purposes.

Any group with a regular secretary, registered with Headquarters, shall be entitled to one vote in a state assembly meeting.

Delegates remain in office for a full two-year term, expiring in April.

No policy should be declared or action taken on matters liable to gravely affect A.A. as a whole unless by consent of at least

three-quarters of the members present. A mere majority should not authorize action. (Floor Action)

The Chairman and President of the Board of Trustees, the Chairman of the General Service Committee, and the Conference Secretary should act as Conference Officers. The Chairman of the Board of Trustees automatically becomes the Conference Chairman; the Chairman of the General Service Committee automatically becomes Vice Chairman, and the Conference Secretary is selected from Foundation personnel. (Floor Action)

In areas with more than one delegate, the General Service Headquarters will be advised of the name and location of groups served by each delegate. (Floor Action)

1954 It was recommended that:

Committeemen elected during the year be put on the General Service Conference mailing list in February. That the delegate be put on the mailing list as soon as Headquarters is notified of his election by the outgoing delegate.

Delegate representation should not be changed during the five year period.

The Third Legacy pamphlet should continue to be followed in determining delegate representation.

During the five-year period, all ex-delegates remain on The General Conference mailing list.

Any group with a regular secretary, registered with Headquarters, shall be entitled to one vote in a state assembly meeting.

Delegates remain in office for a full two-year term, expiring in April.

Delegates come to the Conference being only tentatively instructed for the following reasons: a) that each delegate bring to the Conference the thinking of his area; and b) that the maximum wisdom of the Conference be achieved and voted through the exchange of these ideas at the Conference.

The policy adopted by the 1953 Conference in reference to the three-quarter majority rule be continued. That policy stated as follows:

No policy should be declared or action taken on matters liable to gravely affect A.A. as a whole unless by consent of at least three-quarters of the members present. A mere majority should not authorize action.

1955 It was recommended that:

The Conference abide by the specific recommendations in Section 7 of the "Third Legacy Manual" (currently, Chapter VI of *The A.A. Service Manual*), whereby no delegate succeed himself. However, it is further provided in Section 7 that in rare cases, when a fully qualified person is not available, a delegate may be reelected at a future date. Your Policy Committee felt that the responsibility for this decision lies entirely with the local area.



The display board “A.A. Growth” be photographed and a copy be distributed to each delegate as soon after the Conference adjourns as possible.

Delegates who are receiving duplications of Conference mailings from General Service Headquarters, notify the Conference Secretary if they want this changed.

Only incoming and retiring delegates remain on the General Conference mailing list, thus enabling a delegate to receive Conference mailings for a period of four years.

The proposed permanent “Charter of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous—North American Section” be adopted subject to approval of the 20th Anniversary Convention of A.A. (Floor Action)

1956 It was recommended that:

There be an announcement in a future Headquarters bulletin reminding group general service representatives that it is their duty to pass the bulletins on to the group secretary, and also suggesting that wherever practical and feasible, the general service representative use a group post office box as a mailing address.

Area delegates receive copies of letters from the General Service staff to Intergroups and Institutional Committees that pertain to services and public relations in each delegate’s own area.

Foreign representatives who have attended the General Service Conference as observers should receive all Conference mailings for a ten-year period.

Each year all Conference Committee Chairmen should be elected from second-year delegates on the Conference Committees, since their previous experience will give continuity of service.

The proposal that meetings of the General Service Conference be “rotated” from New York City in even years to a different geographical section in odd years be tabled for consideration at some future date.

Ex-delegates should be kept on the Conference mailing list for a period of ten years following completion of service. (Floor Action)

Qualified “observers” from overseas areas be admitted to the 1957 Conference. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

Since a second delegate from Ontario was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, it is recommended that the request from the Ontario Delegate for additional representation be approved. It is further recommended that the Province be divided into Eastern and Western assembly areas with the assembly points to be determined by the Provincial Committeemen.

Since a second delegate from Missouri was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, it is recommended that the request from the Missouri Delegate for additional representation be approved. It is further recommended that the state be divided into Eastern and Western assembly areas with the assembly points to be determined by the state committeemen.

The request to add a second delegate to the Los Angeles assembly area be held in abeyance until the next Conference.

Note: The additional delegates from Ontario and Missouri will be elected in odd years and the delegates to the 1957 Conference shall serve for only one year.

The Committee reaffirms the Assembly Plan for election of delegates as outlined in the Third Legacy Manual.

1957 It was recommended that:

General Service Headquarters continue to suggest to groups that they write to individuals and companies involved in the misuse of the Directory, requesting that they be removed from the mailing list and that a story be carried in the “Exchange Bulletin” about misuse of the Directory, phrased in such a way that it will help to define the A.A. purpose for which the Directory is intended.

An explanation of what is entailed in serving on specific Conference Committees be made before each Committee is selected.

The Policy Committee of the General Service Board should continue to review proposals referred to it by delegates, with the understanding that if the Committee felt that a proposal should not, for one reason or another, be distributed to delegates, said proposal should then be referred to the Agenda Committee of the Conference for further review; and, further, that if the Agenda Committee concurred in withholding the proposal from distribution, the delegate responsible for the proposal should then be advised of his freedom to introduce the proposal on the floor of the Conference itself. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

Since a delegate to the Cincinnati, Ohio, Area was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, and since the Ohio State Assembly has voted its approval, it is recommended that the request for a delegate to represent the Cincinnati Area be approved. It is further recommended that the state be divided into four assembly areas and that a map be furnished Headquarters showing which groups are being represented by each delegate.

The complaint from some groups in Illinois that they were not represented in the election of a delegate be referred back to the Illinois delegates with the suggestion that the Third Legacy Plan be employed in the election of all delegates.

After reviewing the request from a California delegate for an additional delegate from that state (tabled from the 1956 Conference) the committee recommended:

That the Conference recognize the need for a fifth delegate on the basis of A.A. population.

That California district assemblies determine the five area divisions.

That after such determinations, California make a specific request to the next Conference, accompanied by a map showing groups represented in each area, and assurances that an attempt has been made to cover the state with present delegates and additional area committeemen.

The committee recommended—as a guide for future Admissions Committees—that a fact file be set up for committee use only, incorporating some of the basic considerations affecting the number of delegates from a state, province, or territory:

- a. The fact that a greater number of delegates means less opportunity for each delegate to take part in the deliberations of the Conference.
- b. The fact that each request for an additional delegate from a state opens the way for requests from other states.
- c. These guides taken from the “Third Legacy Manual” (now *The A.A. Service Manual*):

1. That no state or province should request an additional delegate unless its A.A. population exceeds these



limits: Two delegates serving up to 7,000; three delegates serving up to 12,000; four delegates serving 14,000; five delegates serving 19,000.

2. That the factor of mileage in a state be taken into consideration in determining the number of delegates representing a state.
- d. Requests for admission to come from state, provincial, or territorial committees as a whole—rather than from an area—and that such requests provide this information:
 1. A map of the state, province, or territory showing proposed divisions, A.A. population of each, and groups involved.
 2. Assurances that an attempt has been made to cover present areas with present delegates plus an additional number of area committee members.

The Committee reaffirmed the fact that it cannot in any measure decide how state divisions shall be made or how delegates shall be elected—while it does recommend the Third Legacy Plan of elections.

1958 It was recommended that:

The matter of a correct membership census be left up to the discretion of local groups with the added suggestion that the local group endeavor to obtain an inclusive count as far as is possible that would indicate not only those members now participating, but also those presently sober in A.A. who are not known to have affiliated with other groups. Further, that each delegate incorporate in his report to his area the need for an accurate census and stress the importance of this matter.

The delegate incorporate in his report to his area the importance of a permanent group mailing address with the added suggestion that this be a P.O. box whenever practicable.

The suggestion of the name change from General Service Headquarters to General Service Office be adopted.

The participation of institutional groups in the Conference structure be left to the discretion of local Conference assemblies.

A poll of panel 7 Delegates be taken to determine their reactions concerning the length of term of delegates.

Accredited delegates from U.S. Territories, possessions and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico should receive the same financial considerations as the delegates from the United States and Canada; as these delegates have been accepted by the Conference as a part of the present Conference structure.

Admissions Committee

In reference to a resolution presented to the committee by a delegate from Michigan, we submit the following:

- a. Area committees within each state or province shall have the authority to remove any delegate, alternate delegate, or committee member for any interruption of sobriety occurring during his term of service to the General Service Conference.
- b. In the event that such action is taken, the Conference Admissions Committee shall be notified so that his replacement may be recognized and seated at the Conference.

In reference to an application for an additional delegate from some groups in Illinois:

- a. The Admissions Committee comprised of members of Panels 7 and 8 (1958 Conference) feels obliged to honor the “Guide for Future Admissions Committees” as expressed in the *Final Report* of the Panels 6 and 7 (1957 Conference).
- b. We find that the delegates from the state of Illinois have not complied with those requests and, neither by virtue of the factors of population nor mileage, can be granted an additional delegate at this time.
- c. We reaffirm the recommendations contained in the report of Panels 6 and 7 (1957 Conference) that the committee cannot in any measure decide how state divisions shall be made or how delegates shall be elected—while we do recommend that the Third Legacy Plan of election be used to “avoid conflict between local and world service” (“Third Legacy Manual,” Section 6) [now *The A.A. Service Manual*, pages 38-39].

In reference to an application from all present delegates from California:

- a. Resolved, that since the various California district assemblies have complied with all requests of the Admissions Committee in their application for an additional delegate, that request is granted, thus allotting the state of California five delegates to the General Service Conference.
- b. It is suggested, however, that since this additional delegate will serve an area contiguous with Los Angeles, he and the Los Angeles delegate be elected in alternate years.
- c. This leaves to the discretion of the California assemblies the alternative of electing the fifth delegate to be seated for one year in Panel 9, or for two years in Panels 10 and 11. A report of their decision shall be forwarded to the Conference secretary at the earliest possible date.

1959 It was recommended that:

\$3.00 per member replace the \$2.00 suggested as annual contribution to G.S.O.

Meeting nights be listed in the 1960 Directory.

The Exchange Bulletin continue in its present format for the next year.

Material for new Loners be compiled from current Loner questionnaires.

Traditional A.A. policy of declining bequests in any form, from A.A.’s or non-A.A.’s be reaffirmed, and that all delegates receive a copy of current letter used in declining such bequests.

In regard to A.A. misuse of the Directory, the attention of groups again be directed to its purpose, as listed on the inside cover of the Directory: that this be used as a guide and not a rule, as it is not intended to interfere with free communication among A.A.’s in sharing experiences and activities. That non-A.A. misuse be handled as in the past.

Delegates receive a thumbnail sketch of fifteen current Trustees of General Service Board for communicating information to their areas.

Consideration and study be made by all delegates during the coming year on the possibility of all G.S.O. group mailings going to the G.S.R.s and that this subject be placed on the 1960 agenda as a discussion subject.



To retain the present two-year term of office for delegates. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

Reaffirmed the recommendation of the 1958 Admissions Committee that all future Committees earnestly study the Admissions Committee Fact File, always being cognizant of the fact that the Conference, by virtue of an increased number of delegates, is in danger of becoming unwieldy and unfair to all A.A. members.

1960 It was recommended that:

The Conference commend to the Board of Trustees the pursuance of the plan of making a documentary A.A. film for sale to A.A. groups and for use by other interested people at a cost to the General Service Board not to exceed \$7,500; and that the plan include provisions for control of the script and for exclusive sale to the groups and others approved by the General Service Board.

Admissions Committee

Reviewed the request of the Ontario General Service Conference Committee for a third delegate to serve the North and North-West Section of the Province of Ontario and neither approving nor disapproving, referred it to the Board of Trustees and its Policy Committee to study, with particular regard to the geographic needs in all states and provinces, and to report back to the 1961 Conference. The Committee requested that the General Service Board keep it advised of the study's progress during the year.

1961 It was recommended that:

A form be filled in and signed by G.S.R.s who wish to receive duplicate mailings from G.S.O.

The Public Information Committee's procedure of considering financial obligations when G.S.O. is approached by film producers with a proposal for a motion picture on A.A. services be approved.

The Public Information Committee's plan for an anonymity mailing to communications media in June 1961 be approved.

The recommendation that a simplified procedure of mailing one card for Directory information be followed for next year's World Directory.

The 1959 Conference recommendation that in reference to the misuse of the Directory by A.A. members, their attention again be directed to its purpose as listed on the inside cover of the Directory: that it is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture be reaffirmed. That this be used as a guide and not a rule, as it is not intended to interfere with free communication among A.A.s in sharing experience and activities.

The Conference Literature Committee's recommendation that the sentence, "There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" be retained in the description of A.A. in Conference-approved literature be approved.

The General Service Office prepare a fact file covering movement-wide experience with several types of clubhouses and their relation to A.A. and the community. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

In view of the large geographical area and increasing population that can be covered only with difficulty by the present

two delegates from the Eastern and Western Ontario areas, the committee recommends that the request for a third delegate to serve the north and northwest section of the province be approved. That the additional delegate be elected on Panel 11 to attend the 1962 Conference.

1962 It was recommended that:

The recommendation given in the Group Records & Directory report that in the future G.S.O. use the term "reported" rather than "active" membership when requesting membership figures on the Group directory cards be affirmed.

Next year's group information card include a request for information as to the Conference area in which the group is included.

The present \$100 paid by Conference areas toward delegate travel expenses be retained.

The \$5,000 subsidy, approved by the 1961 Conference to assist overseas groups in the preparation of Conference-approved literature be renewed.

The report on Long Range translation needs be adopted as follows:

The criteria for determining in what languages A.A. material should be translated should be based on the prevalence of alcoholism amongst persons speaking the language.

G.S.O. exercise a tighter control over translations of approved material.

Data on A.A. population and its location should be an important factor in allocating loans for local preparation of A.A. literature. It should also be correlated with data on the major languages of the world.

G.S.O. assume the initiative in preparation of literature.

G.S.O. assume the responsibility for free distribution of foreign language literature to doctors, lawyers, etc., if possible through local A.A. contacts, providing that the Budget and Finance Committee feels that it is feasible.

Financing for foreign language literature be based on need rather than in terms of actual available dollars.

Our services to overseas groups be substantial so that we may count on the financial support of the groups in the more developed countries.

The suggestion that a review of the preparation of native literature be adopted as outlined.

The recommendation given in the Overseas report, that a basic pamphlet be prepared and translated in appropriate languages to meet the needs of newly emergent A.A. areas overseas be adopted.

That a proposal to permit an Internationalist (man or woman in naval service or in the merchant marine) to attend future Conferences as a non-voting observer be approved. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

Approval be granted to the request for an additional delegate from the Province of Quebec to represent their French-speaking groups, subject to presentation by Quebec of a complete statistical report supporting their request at the 1963 General Service Conference.

Favors the opinion of the 1962 Conference that an Internationalist be selected by their group to attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference as an observer without vote, starting in 1963.



Public Information Committee and Grapevine Editorial Board members who are not Conference members be permitted to attend the Conference as observers without vote, total number limited to four from the P.I. Committee and four from the Grapevine Editorial Board.

1963 It was recommended that:

G.S.O. continue to refer local matters back to the area involved, with the suggestion that they contact the local delegate; and that copies of all correspondence referring to such local matters be sent to the delegate.

Notices of newly listed and delisted groups be sent only to the areas concerned.

G.S.O. provide a suggested standard letterhead style for those areas desiring to print their own stationery.

Notices be sent with the Exchange Bulletin (now Box 4-5-9) clarifying that the bulletins are for the use of the groups and not exclusively for group secretaries or G.S.R.s.

The current and proposed editorial and subscription practices of the Grapevine be continued.

Wherever the words "Alternate Delegate" appear in the text of the Third Legacy Manual, the phrase be changed to read "Alternate or Assistant Delegate."

G.S.O. continue its current policy of cooperation but not affiliation with Al-Anon.

A joint meeting of the G.S.B. and Conference Finance Committee be held in October or November. Also that this be extended to other Committees as deemed necessary.

Admissions Committee

An additional delegate be approved for the Province of Quebec to serve French-speaking groups and that the delegate be admitted to the 1964 General Service Conference.

1964 It was recommended that:

The idea that Conference committees be enlarged from six to eight members be approved.

The proposal that Conference committees select a co-chairman from first-year delegates, to become chairman the second year, be approved.

The proposal that all outgoing Conference committee members serve in an ex-officio capacity for a full year after their terms are concluded be approved.

The proposal that Areas which volunteered on an experimental basis will have their G.S.R.s receive G.S.O. mailings exclusively be approved.

The preparation of a small edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* to be introduced at the 30th Anniversary Convention in 1965, to be sold at \$3.00 or more be approved.

Procedures for selecting Conference committees be studied during the forthcoming year.

Communications between Conference committee members be increased when feasible and desirable, to enhance the work of the standing committees.

The pattern of G.S.O. employee compensation endorsed by the Conference, following the discussion of Staff salaries, be approved.

The 1965 Conference be programmed for the same number of days as the 1964 meeting. (Floor Action.)

Admissions Committee

A second delegate be added from the Atlantic Provinces of Canada.

1965 It was recommended that:

Committee members continue to be chosen by lot, geographically, and that this drawing be conducted by the chairman of the Policy Committee of the General Service Board at the January Policy Committee meeting. Any delegates' names not received by that date will be added to Committees as received.

Delegates assigned to Committees before the Conference then be advised of their Committee assignments by the Conference Secretary and given the opportunity to refuse assignment. Delegates will also receive at this time "Composition, Scope and Procedures" for all Conference Committees and names of Chairman and other members of their Committees.

Committees include all delegates as active voting members and that advisers be discontinued.

This year's "advisers" become full-fledged Committee members immediately.

Co-Chairmen be elected at the final meeting of each Conference Committee.

Co-Chairmen be elected by written ballot by all members of a Committee.

Co-Chairmen become Chairmen of their Committees immediately following each Conference.

Committee members can communicate with each other through requesting the secretary to duplicate letters from members and mail to all Committee members.

Committees be as uniform in size as possible.

Committee workshops be continued.

All G.S.R.s receive the group mailings from G.S.O.

That the Committee's "Scope" be redefined as follows: "That the Conference limit and define this Committee's responsibilities to cover only matters of policy pertaining to the Conference itself and such other matters as may properly be placed before it."

The present two-year term for delegates be retained. (Floor Action)

Admissions Committee

After reviewing the request for an additional delegate from Indiana, such request be granted, effective with the 1966 Conference, on the basis of population, growth, and communications needs in the area.

1966 It was recommended that:

When A.A. Groups or service boards overseas wish to have an observer present at the Conference, they be requested to send someone who is an A.A. member and also a legal resident of the country wishing representation.

The name of the "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies" be changed to the "Conference Committee on Public Information."

The work of the Conference Admissions Committee be given to the old Agenda (now called Agenda-Admissions) Committee.

The practice of naming *ex officio* Committee members and the tenure of Committee chairmen be retained, that is, each new Chairman takes office immediately at the close of the Conference during which he is elected.



The summary of all previous Conference "Advisory Actions," now mimeographed and sent yearly to all Conference members, should include only the actions of the first fifteen Conferences (1951-65) and should be a chapter in the new Third Legacy Manual when it is written. Then only the most recent actions will have to be compiled and distributed annually, and all readers of the Manual can see what actions the Conference took in its first formative years. (Policy, and Report and Charter)

Admissions Committee

The province of Ontario be given a fourth delegate to be elected for the 17th Conference.

1967 It was recommended that:

Ex officio committee members be continued, but only after being queried following the January Policy Committee meeting, as to whether they would like to continue as ex-officio. Only if they answer in the affirmative will they be kept on the committee list as ex officio for one year.

A letter again be sent from G.S.O. to the F.B.I. advising them of the confidential nature of the *Directory*.

Even though Assemblies may be held every year with half of the Committee elected each year, it be qualified in the "Third Legacy Manual" that the term of office is for two years.

There be no change in the delegate expense allowance.

The two-year term for delegates be continued. (Floor Action)

1968 It was recommended that:

We maintain the present procedure for selection of Conference committees on a geographic basis at the January Policy meeting of the board.

Since the language of the General Service Conference is English, and since the Conference is not equipped to provide translators, it is desirable that delegates elected to the Conference have a knowledge of English for their own benefit and for the benefit of their areas.

Consideration be given either to the preparation of Guidelines or a presentation at the Conference as to how a Conference Report should be given.

When questions of importance for the Conference cannot be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussion and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference.

Agenda/Admissions Committee

A study of admissions procedures be conducted and that the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee meet in the fall of 1968 in New York.

Quebec be granted a third bilingual delegate to be elected as a member of Panel 19. The third delegate is to be elected from a newly designated Conference area to be called the Northeast Area of Quebec.

1969 It was recommended that:

The name of the Conference Policy Committee be changed to Committee on Conference Policy.

The biographical sketches of the delegates, compiled by G.S.O. and placed in delegates' manuals, would serve no useful purpose to the delegates or G.S.O.

The "Electoral procedure for the election of Class B regional trustee nominee" be used in all Third Legacy elections and further, that this suggestion be incorporated in the "Third Legacy Manual," now under revision.

Looking with favor on the proposal "that each Conference area contribute \$150 every year to the support of the General Service Conference," delegates take this proposal back to their areas for consideration. It was further suggested that this item be placed on the 1970 General Service Conference agenda.

Inasmuch as G.S.O. is now giving consideration to relocation of the office in New York, consideration might also be given to the relocation of the site of this annual meeting, with a view to returning to single-room accommodations, so that the advantages of private meditation, study, thought and rest might be restored. It was further suggested that the rising costs of the annual meeting might be controlled, or at least reduced, by a study of possible alternative hotel accommodations. (Delegates Only Meeting)

Agenda/Admissions Committee

When an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined in the "Third Legacy Manual") [now *The A.A. Service Manual*] that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties.

A two-year moratorium be declared on applications by the areas for additional delegate representation so that a thorough study can be made of the whole subject.

Non-Conference members from all trustees' committees have permission to attend as observers, two at a time from each committee, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference.

That where there is more than one delegate in a state or province, a two-thirds majority approval, rather than unanimous approval, be sufficient for future applications for additional representation.

1970 It was recommended that:

The procedure for selecting Conference committee members continue to be from the hat; that no area be represented on any standing committee for more than two consecutive years; that when any state or province has more than one area, no standing committee have more than one member from each state or province.

In keeping with our Traditions, no cameras be allowed at any G.S.O. Conference session. (It was agreed to send questions about using cameras and tape recorders at Conference sessions to the delegates in advance of the Conference meeting.)

It would be in the best interests of the Conference to have a special task force appointed to review the procedures and mechanics of the General Service Conference. (A special task force, appointed by Dr. John Norris, to review procedures and mechanics of the General Service Conference as it is presently constituted, was approved.)

The delegates having accepted the Area Support Proposal, G.S.O. bill the 90 Conference areas for \$150, with a March 1 deadline for sending it to G.S.O. (Floor Action)

That the General Service Office have the right to choose the hotel for the 1971 General Service Conference without conferring further with the delegates to the Conference. (Delegates Only Meeting)



Agenda/Admissions Committee

Delegates should go back to their areas and determine if any obstacle exists which might create the illusion that an additional delegate is needed.

The following motion made and carried:

Let it be moved that this committee recommends to the assembled General Service Conference of 1970 that the moratorium be continued until such time as the Long-Range Planning Committee of the General Service Board, in conjunction with the Agenda/Admissions Committee, presents a set of guidelines to a future Conference for its approval.

This is to be done by communication between the members of the two committees, either by mail or by a meeting in the fall if necessary.

It was also recommended:

In view of the fact that we are asking for basic guidelines from this committee and the Long-Range Planning Committee, the six proposals pertaining to the size of the Conference should be held in abeyance until we have an opportunity to consider any other ideas, and that each member of the Agenda/Admissions Committee be requested to accept the responsibility of forwarding some suggestions to the secretary of the committee.

1971 It was recommended that:

Ask-It Basket be continued in its present form and, to avoid confusion, none of the answer sessions be held during meal-time.

The Committee on Conference Policy take over the function of the Conference evaluation handled last year by the task force; that a questionnaire be mailed by the committee members to Panel 20 and 21 delegates within six weeks from the conclusion of this Conference; that this questionnaire be returned to the committee members who will summarize the replies and send this summarization with the originals to the chairman for tabulation. These recommendations will be forwarded by the chairman to the committee secretary.

There is no need for a Conference Committee on Traditions at this time.

It is not necessary to write to new delegates asking them if they are willing to serve on the committee for which they have been chosen, but rather in the interest of expediency, they will be informed of their committee assignments.

Rather than accept the Oklahoma Plan (a plan for restructuring the General Service Conference) as written, the Conference adopt unstructured open workshops, with no specific subjects, on the agenda and that these unstructured workshops be summarized and reported to the Conference.

The Conference accept the task force decisions, as written in Dr. Jack's letter of December 1970, with our appreciation and thanks for the time, effort, and energy expended by this task force.

We accept the recommendation from the Conference Committee on Public Information for the formation of a Conference Committee on Professional Relations to correspond with the trustees' Committee on Professional Relations; that five delegates from Panel 22 be drawn by lot for the Conference Committee on Professional Relations, that four members from Panel 23 will be added to the committee to bring it up to its full complement of nine. The Conference will then have ten

Conference Committees comprised of nine members each at the present Conference size.

Agendas for all Conference committees be mailed to all delegates before the Conference.

Agenda/Admissions Committee

Limiting the size of the Conference was referred to the Long-Range Planning Committee by the Agenda/Admissions Committee in 1970 for their consideration. That committee recommended that:

The Conference should not be much larger than it is now; that its makeup should remain proportionately similar to its present structure; that the number of non-delegate members should not exceed one-third of the total Conference membership.

Therefore, the two-year moratorium on applications by areas for additional delegate representation which was approved by the 19th Conference be terminated, and detailed questionnaires be prepared for areas seeking additional representation and sent to each area every two years for a reevaluation of the Conference area structure.

Where a delegate does not have his own assembly, he look forward to establishing one.

1972 It was recommended that:

A deadline be specified on the return of all questionnaires sent to delegates.

Because G.S.O. has given each delegate a questionnaire at this year's Conference, the Committee on Conference Policy not make a Conference evaluation this year, but next year review the success or failure of this year's method and determine the method to be used in future Conferences.

All Conference committee agendas continue to be sent to all delegates.

The Conference reaffirm the 1969 Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee recommendation:

"That when an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered a delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined by The A.A. Service Manual) that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties."

The agenda of the Conference be structured so that all Conference committee reports be in the hands of the delegates by Friday morning.

Agenda/Admissions Committee

In an area submitting an application for an additional delegate, such application should be received by G.S.O. not later than January 1 preceding the Conference.

The following be added to the application for additional delegate:

- a. What could another delegate do that more committee members could not do?
- b. A map showing areas as they will exist if a new delegate is allowed.

The request from the British Columbia/Yukon Area for an additional delegate be held in abeyance for another year pending further information and reconsideration during the year.



The matter of the application for an additional delegate from the Province of Quebec be tabled for a period of one year and be returned to the Agenda/Admissions Committee with the following information:

- a. A new map showing areas as they now exist.
- b. A map showing areas as they will exist if a new delegate is allowed.
- c. Show where area meetings are being held in 1972, how each delegate is elected, and how he reports to his area, bearing in mind the suggestions in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- d. Suggest that they also redistrict their areas using more committee members from smaller districts, as suggested in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

1973 It was recommended that:

Conference committees elect an alternate chairman in case the elected chairman is unable to attend the next year's Conference. Since the chairman is elected by a plurality, the person with the second largest number of votes could be alternate chairman.

An alternate area delegate chairman should be elected; the runner-up could be alternate chairman.

Past delegates should not be elected to serve again, with the exception of the conditions outlined by the Agenda/Admissions Committee, 1973.

The Conference questionnaire and evaluation be continued each year; more space should be given for the answer to question 5—"How do you feel the Conference could be improved?"—and a line added for general comments on accommodations.

Since the action of the 1969 Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee that "when an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined by *The A.A. Service Manual*) that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties" is already incorporated in *The A.A. Service Manual*, there is no further need for reaffirmation.

Agenda/Admissions Committee

When an elected delegate is unable to attend the Conference meeting for any reason, a past delegate can be seated in his place if no one else is available, with the proviso that *The A.A. Service Manual*, page 59 (Chapter V, "Delegate Term"), be reworded as follows:

A delegate serves one term for two years. The Conference is on record in its attitude toward delegate rotation. However, the question has arisen: Can a delegate be reelected at some future date? The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of a delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after filling one year of the delegate's term, may be elected to serve his own term.

And in the last paragraph, page 59, the following change be made: "The Conference recommends that all areas have alternate delegates."

When an area is unable to replace the elected delegate, except with a past delegate, the secretary of the Agenda/Admissions Committee shall be provided with information concerning the extent of the efforts made to replace the delegate with someone who has not previously served in that capacity. She will inform the members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee, who will promptly advise her of their disapproval, if any.

Quebec be allowed a fourth delegate. (Floor Action)

1974 It was recommended that:

Results of the 1974 evaluation questionnaire be forwarded to the delegates when compiled, and that we follow the 1973 Committee on Conference Policy's recommendation that the Conference questionnaire and evaluation be continued each year.

The Committee on Conference Policy accept the recommendation of the Agenda/Admissions Committee that the admissions function of that committee be transferred to the Committee on Conference Policy.

1975 It was recommended that:

Each delegate receive only the agenda pertinent to his/her committee, but may receive any others on request.

Ex officio members not be restored.

A committee on Traditions not be established, but that it be further recommended that individual delegates assume the responsibility for familiarizing their area groups and members with the Traditions.

The timing of the 1975 Conference agenda mailing be retained for the 1976 Conference.

It is the responsibility of the area committee to see that the contribution of \$200 toward Conference expenses be paid by March 1, and if not received by March 1, that a letter be sent to the delegate reminding him of this omission.

Having reviewed the 1975 Conference questionnaire, the trustees' Conference Committee consider specific suggestions made by the Conference Policy Committee.

Note: It was the opinion of the trustees, when reviewing the Conference Advisory Actions, that there was great positive value in having delegates participate in the same workshop sections throughout the Conference, and it was their recommendation that this practice be continued for at least another year. They agreed that consideration might be given to rotating staff and trustee participants.

1976 It was recommended that:

The current agenda format be approved for 1977.

The 1976 Conference questionnaire be approved with the following questions added for 1977:

- a. "Do you feel there is enough time for discussion of committee and trustee reports?"
- b. "Do you feel Area Service Highlights are valuable to the Conference as a whole?"

Question 9 of the questionnaire to read as follows: "Please list suggestions for improving or changing the Conference."

Since the committee feels that there is insufficient time allotted at the Conference for adequate discussion of committee reports before the vote is called for and also feels that committee meetings should be concluded earlier in the week so that the reports, with discussion thereon, could be had on Thursday, with the final discussion and vote on Friday, a study be made by the appropriate trustees' committee of the feasibility of accomplishing this result by eliminating or shortening the following sessions:

Area Service Highlights
Presentations/Discussions
Workshops



and that a feasibility report be made at the 1977 General Service Conference for further action by the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions.

1977 It was recommended that:

Current general service board and staff members from foreign countries be granted admission as observers, upon request, to the annual General Service Conference of U.S. and Canada, not to exceed one representative per country, at their own expense; and that the request be made through the General Service Office in New York.

The recommendations of the Conference Report and Charter and Agenda Committees to retain the Conference Report and Charter Committee, as is, be approved with the additional recommendation that all Conference committees reevaluate their purpose and function during 1978 and report back to the 1979 Conference.

When a situation arises which prevents the trustee committee chairperson from chairing the joint meeting, a Conference committee chairperson be delegated to chair the joint committee meeting at the Conference until a new trustee chairperson can be appointed.

The current Conference Institutions Committee be replaced by two committees to be called Committee on Correctional Facilities and Committee on Treatment Facilities.

1978 It was recommended that:

The Conference Report and Charter Committee add a section to Chapter V of *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding applications for additional areas and delegates, and that excerpts from Bill's 1961 memo on the size of the Conference be included as well as the information that application forms are available from G.S.O.

The questionnaire for the 28th General Service Conference was satisfactory, and no changes were suggested.

The committee felt that the description in Chapter VII of *The A.A. Service Manual* on why the Conference has committees is adequate, and suggested that reports of the trustees' quarterly meetings continue to be sent to members of the corresponding Conference committees. Communication between committee members and G.S.O. between Conferences should be encouraged.

Selections from Conference talks made by Bill and Bern Smith, beginning with the First General Service Conference in 1951, be circulated to the Conference and trustees' Literature Committees so that consideration could be given to making this material available to the Fellowship in printed form.

The opening date for the 1979 General Service Conference be delayed until April 22 in order to permit delegates to avoid travel complications.

1979 It was recommended that

Item 7 of the 1979 Conference questionnaire include a choice of free night or nights.

Directors-elect not attend the Conference as observers prior to their election, as they will attend as Conference members for four years after taking office.

No arbitrary ceiling be set on the number of G.S.O./G.V. staff eligible to vote, but that the delegates never have less than 66 2/3% of the total Conference votes. If more staff members are added, some method of rotation of staff eligible to vote may be necessary. In response to a request that delegates represent

not less than 75% of voting Conference members, this was considered an unrealistic figure. The committee pointed out that office personnel (exclusive of staff) assisting at the Conference are not participants in Conference sessions. Observers have no voice and no vote; they do not participate in Conference deliberations.

Previous action that two non-trustee members of each trustees' committee may attend as observers for one-half of one day with no voice and no vote be reaffirmed.

The Conference Committee on Trustees always have at least nine members so that there will always be enough to constitute one-half of the committee votes in regional elections.

When delegates are polled prior to the Conference, they be asked to give their number of years in general service work as well as age and length of sobriety.

1980 It was recommended that:

There be no changes in the 1981 Conference questionnaire.

The Conference reaffirm the importance of the committee system for accomplishing business charged to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, as defined in Chapter 7 of *The A.A. Service Manual*. The importance of clearly stated committee reports and recommendations was also stressed.

The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, as follows: "In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees' committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distributed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting.

Since neither the Panel 29 delegate from Northeastern Quebec (Area 89) nor his alternate is able to attend this 30th Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions recommends to this Conference that the area chairperson, Gabriel La P., be allowed to be seated. (Floor Action)

1981 It was recommended that:

There be no change to the 1982 Conference questionnaire.

The request for an additional delegate from Area 81 (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island, Canada) be denied.

The printing of the Ask-It-Basket questions and answers in their present form be discontinued.

The section on Ask-It-Basket questions and answers in the *Final Conference Report* be continued.

Some criteria should be set by the Conference on what constitutes an Advisory Action, and that members of the Policy/Admissions Committee study the matter and present some sort of guidelines for consideration by members of the 1982 General Service Conference.

1982 It was recommended that:

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings and Monday sessions of the Conference, and as observers at one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Each Conference committee carefully consider their agenda items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the policy level.



The alternate delegate for Southern New Jersey, Ruth N., be seated to replace delegate Madge M., who had to leave the Conference on Tuesday, April 20. (Floor Action)

1983 It was recommended that:

The 1982 Conference Action be amended to read:

"All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings.

"All nontrustee, nondirector members be encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve."

The dates for the 1984 Conference be Monday, April 16, through Saturday, April 21, even though this would include certain religious holidays.

The Conference Committees on Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter consider, at their 1984 committee meetings, the possibility of combining the function of these two committees.

1984 It was recommended that:

The area treasurer from Central and Southeast Ohio be seated as a Conference member, since neither the delegate nor the alternate delegate from that area was able to attend.

After reviewing the 1983 Conference questionnaire, no change be made on the form at this time.

Tapes of Conference presentations not be made available, affirming the 1979 General Service Board recommendation which prohibits making tapes of any Conference session for distribution outside of the A.A. archives, except for the opening dinner and the closing brunch.

To encourage Spanish-speaking groups and committees to participate in the general service structure:

- a. Areas be encouraged to provide room within their structure for Hispanic districts with a bilingual liaison or D.C.M.
- b. Assemblies be encouraged to provide G.S.R. schools, seminars, or workshops in Spanish.
- c. Successful experience with area structure participation by Hispanic groups be shared in Spanish Box 4-5-9.
- d. Spanish-speaking A.A.'s active in service be encouraged to sponsor new members into service.
- e. G.S.O. increase its efforts to provide Spanish service literature.
- f. The trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums consider holding a Forum in Puerto Rico.

The functions of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and Conference Report and Charter Committee should not be combined at this time.

We reaffirm the 1980 Policy/Admissions Committee recommendation which reads:

"The Conference reaffirm the importance of the committee system for accomplishing business charged to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, as defined in Chapter 7 of The A.A. Service Manual. The importance of clearly stated committee reports and recommendations was also stressed."

with particular emphasis on clarity and background information when writing committee recommendations.

The 1985 Conference be held April 14-20, 1985, and that the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions routinely review the dates for the succeeding year's Conference.

1985 It was recommended that:

No change be made in the Conference questionnaire at this time.

The General Service Conference for 1986 be held from April 20 through April 26.

The Conference Policy Committee routinely review the dates for the General Service Conference to be held two years hence.

The 1987 General Service Conference be held from April 26 through May 2.

The decision regarding the South Florida Area invitation to the groups in the Virgin Islands be made by area assemblies involved.

The 1986 Policy/Admissions Committee study the need for a procedure to include into the service structure new states or provinces, U.S./Canadian territories and islands, etc.

1986 It was recommended that:

The revised Conference questionnaire be approved to evaluate the 1987 General Service Conference.

The 38th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 17-23, 1988.

With regard to proposing Floor Actions in the final hours of the Conference, the 1968 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed:

"That when questions of importance for the Conference could not be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussion and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference."

When matters of great significance having a long-term effect on the Fellowship or of substantial expense are presented to the floor in the waning hours of the Conference, such matters be referred to the appropriate committee at the next Conference in order for the group conscience to be as informed as possible.

Since some misunderstandings have occurred because of seeming breakdowns in communication, the 1963 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed:

"Recommended that G.S.O. continue to refer local matters back to the area involved, with the suggestion that they contact the local delegate; and that copies of all correspondence referring to such local matters be sent to the delegate."

Trustees' committees and General Service Office staff continue to inform the area delegates of any significant activities in their areas, whenever possible, in order that the area may offer assistance concerning these activities and that all might be better informed.

At this time there is no need to establish a procedure to include into the service structure, as part of an existing area assembly, new states or provinces, U.S./Canada territories and islands. It was suggested that past experiences be considered. When the General Service Office receives an inquiry about joining the service structure, the staff should encourage local members to develop a district structure and contact an area assembly for inclusion as part of that service structure.

Delegates assume more responsibility in encouraging G.S.R.s and local A.A. members to take their suggestions and concerns



to district meetings and area assemblies for consideration in order to accommodate the growing number of topics being submitted for consideration by Conference committees. The committee also suggested sending items for the Conference agenda to the Conference coordinator as early as possible.

Regarding the suggestion to change the seal designating General Service Conference-approved literature to the Three Legacies seal, no action be taken since the Conference has reserved that seal for Conference-approved literature; however, the committee commends the idea of making the Fellowship more aware of our Three Legacies.

The 1987 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider the formation of a Conference Archives Committee. (Floor Action)

1987 It was recommended that:

The area chairperson from Eastern Massachusetts be seated as a Conference member, since neither the delegate nor the alternate delegate from that area is able to attend.

The 39th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 23-29, 1989. These dates will not conflict with Easter or Passover.

While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area archives and archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office archivist.

The 1982 Policy Committee Advisory Action:

"Each Conference Committee carefully consider their Agenda items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the policy level,"

be reaffirmed; and this Advisory Action of 1982 be read by each Conference Committee chairperson at the opening of the Conference Committee meetings.

To be more financially responsible, when a Conference Committee recommendation involves a substantial expenditure of money, an estimate of costs be part of that recommendation.

1988 It was recommended that:

Ron C., General Service trustee, Australia, be admitted to the 38th General Service Conference, as an observer.

The 40th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 22-28, 1990.

The comments under questions one and two in the 38th General Service Conference Questionnaire be used in planning the next Conference, but not included in the final results of the 1988 Conference Evaluation.

The Policy/Admissions Committee continue to study geographical representation and distribution of General Service delegates.

Ample time for Conference Committees to meet and conduct their business be provided for on the Conference Agenda.

1989 It was recommended that:

The 41st General Service Conference be held April 14-20, 1991, with an alternative date of April 21-27, 1991, based on hotel accommodations and availability.

The 1979 Conference Action be reaffirmed: "Conference Committee selection continue to be by lot with the widest possible geographical distribution." It was the sense of the meeting that any other method could erode the confidence of the Conference in the committee system.

That all Conference-approved literature shall be developed within the Conference structure, but that identification of need may be established by use of questionnaires developed in cooperation with the appropriate standing Conference committees.

The 1987 Conference Action from the Policy/Admissions Committee be modified to read:

"Each Conference Committee carefully consider their agenda items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the policy level. To be more financially responsible, when a Conference committee recommendation involves a substantial expenditure of money, an estimate of cost and its impact on the budget be part of that recommendation."

That the words "and timely" be added to the end of Question #6 on the 1990 Conference questionnaire, and that space be allowed for comments. (The Question would read: "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely?")

1990 It was recommended that:

The alternate delegate from Colorado be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate who is ill and unable to attend.

The 42nd General Service Conference be held April 26-May 2, 1992, since this week will not conflict with Easter or Passover.

The 43rd General Service Conference be held April 18-April 24, 1993, with an alternate date of April 25-May 1, 1993, based on hotel accommodations and availability, realizing the need for reserving hotel space well in advance.

A standing committee for central and intergroup offices not be formed at this time. The committee felt that many of the problems expressed by central offices and intergroups are "home issues," and that the doors of communication need to be opened at the area level. The committee would like to stress the importance of delegates establishing contact with offices in their areas and assuring them they do have a voice in the Fellowship through their existing area service structure. The committee suggests that the sharing received by this committee from areas and central/intergroup offices, regarding their experiences of cooperation and communication, be reviewed by the G.S.O. staff with the idea of incorporation into the Guidelines on central/intergroup offices.

There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site, selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed in 1995 by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

1991 It was recommended that:

The 44th General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 1994, with an alternative date of April 10-16, 1994, if needed for hotel availability, since these dates do not conflict with certain religious holidays.



The policy for establishing new delegate areas in place at this time, as described concisely in *The A.A. Service Manual*, is adequate to allow for the gradual growth of the Conference, and provides for a representative cross-section of A.A.

The trustees' Conference Committee consider a presentation/ discussion topic on New Delegate Areas for the 1992 Conference, focusing on existing delegate areas, procedures for new delegate areas and future A.A. growth.

The 1992 General Service Conference annual meeting be held in the city of New York. (Floor Action)

1992 It was recommended that:

The alternate delegate from Area 30, Eastern Massachusetts, Bob McE., be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ronald G., who is unable to attend.

The Annual Conference Questionnaire be reviewed in the future by the Conference Committee on Agenda, instead of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

The 45th General Service Conference be held April 30-May 6, 1995, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

A revised, amplified form "Application for Additional Delegate Area" be approved.

The Conference review in April of the same year any request for a new Delegate Area submitted to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee by January 1st of that year.

Final Conference Committee agendas be automatically sent to all Conference members no later than March 15 each year.

1993 It was recommended that:

The alternate delegate from Area 62, South Carolina, George R., be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Joe McG., who is unable to attend.

The 46th General Service Conference be held April 21-27, 1996, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The area delegate term not be extended to three years, since the current two-year term offers a wider opportunity for service, and helps maintain continuity throughout the A.A. structure.

In response to the proposal to create a standing Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, the 1990 General Service Conference Action #3 be reaffirmed, as follows:

"There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site-Selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed in 1995 by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions."

In response to the proposal to create a Conference Committee on Archives, the 1987 General Service Conference Action #45 be reaffirmed as follows:

"While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area archives and archives committees, with the resulting benefit to the General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local

archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office archivist."

In order for groups/districts/areas to fully participate in the Conference process, the following steps be taken:

- a. Conference agenda items be submitted as early as possible but no later than January 15 each year.
- b. Final Conference committee agendas be automatically sent to all Conference members by February 15 each year.
- c. Background material for each specific committee be sent to its members by February 15 each year, with other committees' background material available upon request.

1994 It was recommended that:

The alternate delegate from Area 45, Southern New Jersey, Sally A. L., be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ike T., who is unable to attend.

The 47th General Service Conference be held April 13-19, 1997, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The request from the Washington Area (72) for a new delegate area be denied.

The request from the Southern California Area (05) for a new delegate area be denied.

No moratorium be placed on topics to be considered by the General Service Conference.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend the opening sessions and participate at the joint committee meetings and be invited to attend the Opening Dinner of the General Service Conference.

1995 It was recommended that:

The alternate delegate from Area 81, New Brunswick/PEI, Rikki S., be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ray S., who is unable to attend.

The alternate delegate from Area 82, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, Charles (Sonny) S., be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Bert G., who is unable to attend.

Trevor H., General Service Trustee from Australia, be granted permission to attend the 1995 General Service Conference as an observer.

The 48th General Service Conference be held April 19-25, 1998, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The Conference Committee on International Conventions continue to meet on an annual basis, discussing Regional Forums when there are no International Convention items; and that the committee be renamed Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

Simultaneous translation be made available at future General Service Conferences. The Conference member requiring translation will submit a request as soon as possible, but no later than January 1st of the Conference year. Estimated costs: \$16,000 per language.

Since the Washington Area (Area 72) has met the conditions for admission, a second delegate be admitted from Washington Area (Area 72). Further, the committee will continue to accept



applications for seating new delegates; however, it will not act on those applications until after the Conference has considered how it will handle future growth and its effect on A.A. as a whole, or until January 1, 1999.

Since no Conference is binding on the next, each Conference will determine by a sense of the meeting as part of its "house-keeping" chores whether or not that annual meeting of the Conference will be smoking or non-smoking.

1996 It was recommended that:

The delegate from Area 73, West Virginia, Larry C., Panel 45, be seated as a Conference member in place of Martha (Marty) W., Panel 45, who has resigned.

The 49th General Service Conference be held April 18-24, 1999, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

Any sitting delegate on the Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee whose area is presenting at the General Service Conference as a possible international Convention site city withdraw from that committee and a replacement be selected.

"Washington State East Area 92" and "Western Washington State Area 72" be approved as the new names for these areas.

1997 It was recommended that:

The delegate from Area 09, Mid-Southern California, Nick M., Panel 46, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Lona W.-P., Panel 46, who resigned.

Michaela K. T., from Slovakia, be granted permission to attend the 47th General Service Conference as an observer.

The 50th General Service Conference be held April 30-May 6, 2000, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The name of Area 72 be changed from Western Washington State Area to Western Washington Area.

1998 It was recommended that:

Martha van den A., chairperson of the General Service Board in the Netherlands and a World Service Meeting delegate, be invited to attend the 48th General Service Conference as an observer.

The 51st General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2001, since those dates do not conflict with any significant religious holidays.

When calculating the number of votes to determine substantial unanimity or a 2/3 majority on the Conference floor, when the number is a fraction, the next higher whole number will be used.

The timetable for the election of delegates from the West Central Region be revised to allow for a more even distribution of new delegates on each panel as suggested in the proposal submitted by that region.

The revised timetable for the election of delegates from the West Central Region be accomplished for the election of Panel 50 delegates by having two areas in the West Central Region elect two delegates for one-year terms with the understanding that those two delegates would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following election as suggested in the proposal submitted by that region.

A Conference Archives Committee, composed of nine delegates (five from Panel 48 and four from Panel 49), meet at the 49th General Service Conference as a secondary committee assignment and that the committee meet jointly with the trustees' Archives Committee.

The following statement under Delegate Term on page S73 of the 1997-1998 Edition of The A.A. Service Manual which reads:

The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after filling one year of the delegate's term, may be elected to serve his or her own term.

be revised to read:

The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after attending one Conference in place of the delegate, may be elected to serve his or her own term.

1999 It was recommended that:

The 52nd General Service Conference be held April 21-27, 2002, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

2000 It was recommended that:

The 53rd General Service Conference be held April 27-May 3, 2003, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The Southern California Area 05 be granted an additional delegate area. (Floor Action)

2001 It was recommended that:

Maureen M., Panel 51 alternate delegate, British Columbia/Yukon Area 79, be admitted to the Conference because Bob A., Panel 51 area delegate, is unable to attend.

Günther H., general manager of the G.S.O. for Germany, be admitted to the Conference as an observer; and that Maxi K., staff member in the German G.S.O., also be admitted to the Conference as an observer and translator for Günther.

An observer's attendance at Conference Committee meetings and Delegates Only Meetings would need individual committee approval.

The 54th General Service Conference be held April 18-24, 2004, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

2002 It was recommended that:

The 55th General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 2005, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

Wanda H., Panel 51 alternate delegate, Area 82, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador be admitted to the Conference because Walter H., Panel 51 delegate for Area 82, is unable to attend.

Jonathan (Buck) R., Panel 51 alternate delegate, Area 13, District of Columbia, be admitted to the Conference because Dorothy (Dottie) P., Panel 51 delegate for Area 13, is unable to attend.

The "Application for Additional Delegate Area," as amplified and revised by the committee, be approved and made available through the General Service Office.



2003 It was recommended that:

Jim K., general secretary, G.S.O. Great Britain, and Ann N., general secretary elect, G.S.O. Great Britain, be granted permission to attend the 53rd General Service Conference as observers.

Torvin (Torv) T., alternate delegate, Area 74, No. WI/Upper Peninsula Michigan be seated as a Conference member at the 53rd General Service Conference because Ted L., the Panel 52 delegate for Area 74, is unable to attend.

The 56th General Service Conference be held April 23-29, 2006 since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

2004 It was recommended that:

The 57th General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2007, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

The use of personal computers at General Service Conferences be approved in keeping with the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference" as contained in a report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

Note: The Conference Coordinator will continue to notify Conference members annually of the availability of up to 24 spaces complete with power outlets for the use of personal computers at the General Service Conference. If the number of requests for the use of personal computers exceeds 24, the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions will review the Guidelines.

The request for an additional delegate area from Area 15, South Florida, Bahamas, U.S. Virgin Islands, British Virgin Islands and Antigua, be denied. The committee suggested that the area reconsider this request and explore alternatives at the area level to address the challenges of the general service structure in Area 15.

The current practice for viewing or examining all materials other than service material submitted for Conference approval be continued adhering to the principle of the "right of decision" throughout the Conference process.

2005 It was recommended that:

Rick H., alternate delegate, Area 2, Alaska be seated as a Conference member at the 55th General Service Conference because David M., the Panel 54 delegate for Area 2 is unable to attend.

Glenn H., alternate delegate, Area 37, Mississippi be seated as a Conference member at the 55th General Service Conference because Elizabeth K., the Panel 54 delegate for Area 37 is unable to attend.

The 58th General Service Conference be held April 27-May 3, 2008, having considered significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

The timetable for the election of delegates from the Western Canada Region be revised to allow for an even distribution of new delegates on each panel.

The revised timetable for the election of delegates from the Western Canada Region be accomplished with the election of Panel 56 delegates by having one area in the Western Canada Region elect a delegate for a one-year term with the understanding that this delegate would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following Panel 57 election.

2006 It was recommended that:

Valerie M., general manager of the G.S.O. for Australia, and Noriaki N., general manager of the G.S.O. for Japan, be admitted to the 56th General Service Conference as observers.

Current General Service Board members and G.S.O. staff members from other countries be granted admission as observers upon their request to the annual General Service Conference of the U.S. and Canada; that admission is not to exceed two countries and two representatives per country, one being a board member and/or one G.S.O. staff member at each General Service Conference; that the request for admission be made through the General Service Office in New York; and that decisions regarding responsibility for guest observer expenses be at the discretion of the General Service Board.

The 59th General Service Conference be held April 26 – May 2, 2009, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

2007 It was recommended that:

Hari B., alternate delegate, Area 81, New Brunswick/PEI, be seated as a Conference member at the 57th General Service Conference because Adrien G., the Panel 56 delegate for Area 81 is unable to attend.

The 60th General Service Conference be held April 18-24, 2010, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

2008 It was recommended that:

Scott A., alternate delegate, Area 36, Southern Minnesota, be seated as a Conference member at the 58th General Service Conference because Samira A., the Panel 57 delegate for Area 36 is unable to attend.

José T. R. L. and Elfidio Q. O. from the General Service Board of Central Mexicana; Louise Foxcroft from the General Service Board of Great Britain and Ann N., general secretary G.S.O. Great Britain, be admitted to the 58th General Service Conference as observers.

The 61st General Service Conference be held May 1-7, 2011, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

Representatives from other national A.A. service entities be granted admission as observers upon their request to the annual General Service Conference of the United States and Canada; that admission is not to exceed three countries and two representatives per country; that the request for admission be made through the General Service Office in New York; and that decisions regarding responsibility for guest observer expenses be at the discretion of the General Service Board.

The responsibility for General Service Conference site selection be delegated to General Service Office management, subject to approval of the General Service Board; and that a report be forwarded to the 2009 General Service Conference.

2009 It was recommended that:

Frank Z., alternate delegate, Area 12, Delaware, be seated as a Conference member at the 59th General Service Conference because Joe S., the Panel 58 delegate for Area 12, passed away.

Claudio M. T. da S. from the General Service Board of Brazil, Mario V. C. from the General Service Board of Colombia and



Plinio B. P., manager, G.S.O. Colombia, be admitted to the 59th General Service Conference as observers.

The 62nd General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2012 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

The General Service Board develop a procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference and bring a draft to the 2010 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for their review.

The committee asked that the following questions from the report, "Trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference Subcommittee on Forwarding Minority Reports and Presentations to the General Service Conference" be addressed in the proposed procedure:

- a. To whom does the minority announce that it intends to present a minority report to the Conference?
- b. What is the deadline for making such a decision?
- c. What Conference members, if any, are given advance notice of the decision?
- d. Who is responsible for seeing that the minority report and its documentation are in fact physically made available to the Conference?
- e. What is the deadline for distributing the minority report and its documentation?
- f. To whom are the minority report and its documentation given?

The General Service Board develop a plan for the General Service Conference to conduct an inventory of itself that includes a planning committee consisting of representatives of delegates, trustees, directors, nontrustee directors, and staff, and that a progress report be presented to the 2010 Policy/Admissions Committee.

2010 It was recommended that:

Donna G., alternate delegate, Area 33, Southeast Michigan, be seated as a Conference member at the 60th General Service Conference because Derek D., the Panel 59 delegate for Area 33, resigned.

Angel A. C. and Carlos J. H. from the General Service Board of Venezuela be admitted to the 60th General Service Conference as observers.

The 63rd General Service Conference be held April 21-27, 2013 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself and that a Conference Inventory Planning Committee be established to develop a comprehensive inventory plan to bring forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for consideration, along with an estimated cost for conducting the inventory.

Composition of the Conference Inventory Planning Committee

The composition of the Conference Inventory Planning Committee (CIPC) will have a proportional representation similar to the General Service Conference including delegates, trustees, a nontrustee director, a G.S.O. staff member and a Grapevine staff member.

Selection of eligible delegates shall include those not elected

as chair of a Conference committee who are willing and able to serve. The Conference Inventory Planning Committee will consist of 17 individuals with representation as follows:

11 Panel 60 Delegates

Alternate Conference delegate chair

Alternate chair—Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions

Alternate chair—Conference Committee on Agenda

One delegate from each region for a total of 8 to be chosen by lot by the chair of the General Service Board, the G.S.O. Conference coordinator and the Conference delegate chair.

Trustees, Directors and Staff

One Class B regional trustee

One Class B general service trustee who will serve as chair of the committee

One Class A trustee

One Nontrustee director

One G.S.O. staff person

One Grapevine staff person

The trustees, nontrustee director and G.S.O./Grapevine staff will be appointed by the chair of the General Service Board. A G.S.O. staff member, appointed by the G.S.O. general manager, will serve as the nonvoting secretary to the Conference Inventory Planning Committee and coordinate committee meeting schedules and correspondence.

As a resource for the development of an inventory plan, the Conference Inventory Planning Committee will use the background, recommendations, questions and summary of suggestions contained in the report of the February 2, 2009 trustees' subcommittee on "Discussion of the Proposal for a General Service Conference Inventory" and the January 6, 2010 report of the trustees' subcommittee on "Developing a Plan for the General Service Conference to Conduct an Inventory of Itself," along with any additional, related background material the committee may deem appropriate.

The request for development of procedures for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference, be recommitted to the General Service Board, taking into account considerations expressed during the 2010 General Service Conference, and forward a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. (Floor Action)

2011 It was recommended that:

Oscar C. B. and Jesús C. P. S. from the General Service Structure of Peru be admitted to the 61st General Service Conference as observers.

Sheila D. and Martin B. from the General Service Structure of Great Britain be admitted to the 61st General Service Conference as observers.

Mike D., alternate delegate, Area 50, Western New York, be seated as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference because John C., the Panel 60 delegate for Area 50 resigned.

Mel C., alternate delegate, Area 83, Eastern Ontario International, be seated as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference because Robb W., the Panel 61 delegate for Area 83 is unable to attend.

The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself in accordance with the Comprehensive Plan formu-



lated by the Conference Inventory Planning Committee. (See page 11)

The 64th General Service Conference be held April 27-May 3, 2014 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.

The Conference Committee on Archives meet separately at the General Service Conference following a joint meeting with the trustees' Committee on Archives.

The following procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference be established:

1. The minority, expressing a feeling or opinion in light of the right of appeal to the General Service Conference, has been very rare. It is hoped that an individual entitled under Concept V to appeal would exhaust every avenue offered within the General Service Conference structure prior to making an appeal to the General Service Conference.
2. Those entitled to appeal to the General Service Conference are members who, on the inverted triangle of the A.A. service structure, fall *below* the General Service Conference level — members of staffs, committees, corporate boards or trustees, as referenced in the first paragraph of Concept V of *The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service*.
3. The minority should announce, in writing, to the chair of the General Service Board, the General Service Conference delegate chair and to the General Service Office Conference coordinator that it intends to appeal under Concept V to the General Service Conference.
4. All Conference members will be given notice through the General Service Office of the minority's decision to file an appeal.
5. Appeals under Concept V, including any minority report and background, must be received in writing 30 days prior to the General Service Conference in order for these materials to be distributed to Conference members. The G.S.O. Conference coordinator will be responsible for seeing that this material is made available to all Conference members within 10 business days after its receipt.
6. The minority's appeal will be presented before the start of deliberation on Committee Reports:
 - The minority will be given a maximum of ten minutes to present their appeal.
 - The majority will then be given a maximum of ten minutes to present their position.
7. The discretion to debate a minority's appeal rests with the Conference body.

The chair will ask if there is a motion to decline to consider the minority's appeal. A motion to decline to consider a minority's appeal:

- Must be made without comment.
 - Needs a second.
 - Is not debatable.
 - Requires a *two thirds majority*.
8. If the Conference decides to debate the appeal, it then takes the form of a motion which does not require a second. If passed by substantial unanimity, it becomes an Advisory Action.

9. Whether or not an appeal is debated, a summary of the minority's report and the disposition of the appeal will be published in the *Final Conference Report*.

2012 It was recommended that:

Satander B. and Daler M. from the General Service Board of India be admitted to the 62nd General Service Conference as observers.

Roger B., alternate delegate, Area 89, Northeast Quebec Canada, be seated as a Conference member at the 62nd General Service Conference because Estelle F., Panel 61 delegate for Area 89, is unable to attend.

The 65th General Service Conference be held April 19-25, 2015 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.

The use of electronic devices at the General Service Conference be approved in keeping with the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the Conference" as presented to the 2012 General Service Conference, superseding the 2004 Advisory Action regarding the use of personal computers at the Conference.

2013 It was recommended that:

The 66th General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 2016, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.

The user responsibilities in the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the General Service Conference," which currently read:

"Users are responsible for insuring adequate battery strength prior to the start of sessions. No technical assistance will be provided by the organizers of the General Service Conference or Conference technical assistants."

be revised to read:

"Users are responsible for insuring adequate battery strength prior to the start of sessions. For safety reasons, extension cords will not be permitted between any seating rows or walking areas. Power outlets will be available in designated seating areas during General Sessions. No technical assistance will be provided by the organizers of the General Service Conference or Conference technical assistants."

The deadline for the submission of Conference Agenda Items be changed from January 15 to December 15, beginning in December 2014 for the 65th General Service Conference.

The timetable for the election of the delegate from Area 84, Northeastern Ontario, be revised to allow for two odd and two even panels in that province. The revised timetable for the election of the delegate from Area 84, Northeastern Ontario is to be accomplished by having the Panel 63 delegate elected for a one-year term with the understanding that this delegate would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following Panel 64 election.

2014 It was recommended that:

Jennie H., alternate delegate, Area 85, Northwest Ontario, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Ken B., Panel 63 delegate for Area 85 is unable to attend.

Jim S., delegate, Area 1, Alabama/Northwest Florida, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Craig M., Panel 63 delegate for Area 1 is unable to attend.



Joyce S., alternate delegate, Area 83, Eastern Ontario, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Mel C., Panel 63 delegate for Area 83 is unable to attend.

The 67th General Service Conference be held April 23-29, 2017, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.

During a two-year trial period the General Service Conference include one day of electronic voting on all nonelection votes, on the Thursday of the 2015 General Service Conference and on the Friday of the 2016 General Service Conference, and that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference provide a report from data gathered from the 2015 and 2016 General Service Conferences, evaluating electronic voting to the 2017 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for consideration.

2015 It was recommended that:

The 68th General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2018, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.

The policy regarding General Service Conference audio recordings, which reads:

Tapes of Conference presentations not be made available, affirming the 1979 General Service Board recommendation which prohibits making tapes of any Conference session for distribution outside of the A.A. Archives, except for the opening and the closing brunch.

Be revised as follows:

Audio recordings of General Service Conference presentations published in the General Service Conference *Final Report* and audio recordings of the trustees' farewell talks given at the closing brunch be made available in accordance with Archives' Policies. Access to all other General Service Conference sessions will continue to be prohibited.

2016 It was recommended that:

Mykhailo A., past World Service Meeting delegate, and Yury T. from Ukraine be admitted to the 66th General Service Conference as observers.

Implementation of Phase 1 of the Conference Translation Project to translate pre- Conference and Conference material into Spanish and French, as described in the 2015 Advisory Action, continue with an estimated cost of \$50,000 – \$100,000.

The 69th General Service Conference be held April 28-May 4, 2019 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holiday or hotel availability.

The trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference create a plan to translate Conference background material, considering all possible methods, with a progress report to be forwarded to the 2017 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions that describes the process and costs. (Floor Action)

2017 It was recommended that:

The 2018 General Service Conference move ahead with electronic voting to be used for all Conference voting, with the exception of elections for regional trustees and trustees-at-large, which are conducted by ballot.

The trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference develop a plan for the equitable distribution of the workload of Conference committees by combining and/or creating commit-

tees for review by the 2018 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

Starting with the 67th General Service Conference, an anonymity-protected, digital Final Conference Report be published in addition to the current print version.

The 70th General Service Conference be held April 19-25, 2020 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holiday or hotel availability.

Starting at the 2018 General Service Conference, the proposed dates of future General Service Conferences be considered as an Additional Committee Consideration rather than requiring an Advisory Action.

General Service Office management submit a report on the process, implementation and status on the site selection of the General Service Conference for review by the 2018 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

2018 It was recommended that:

Valley K., general secretary of the General Service Board of A.A. India, be admitted to the 68th General Service Conference as an observer.

The "Process for Polling the General Service Conference between Annual Meetings" be approved.

Two consultants, Andréa Pellegrino and Chris DeSantis, from the firm Impact Collaborative, be admitted to the 68th General Service Conference on Thursday, April 26, and Friday, April 27, 2018, as observers. [Note: This was a special request from the chair of the General Service Board for approval of two representatives from the firm contracted to conduct a communications audit initiated by the General Service Board.]

2019 It was recommended that:

To allow time for discussion, the "Process for Polling the General Service Conference between Annual Meetings" which currently reads:

Timing

In keeping with the G.S.B. Bylaws, Conference members will be given two weeks from the time the poll is emailed to respond with their vote. Dates for all votes and motions will be included with the poll, using a form similar to the "Timeline for Polling Conference Between Meetings." All times listed are Eastern Time.

The original poll will be emailed by 2 p.m., and voting will open that day and remain open for two weeks.

Voting will close at 2 p.m. two weeks after the poll was emailed. By 5 p.m. on the day the poll results are due, Conference members will be notified of the results by email. A request for any minority opinion will be included with the poll results.

Be replaced with:

Timing

In keeping with the G.S.B. Bylaws, Conference members will be given two weeks from the time the poll is emailed to respond with their vote. Dates for all votes and motions will be included with the poll, using a form similar to the "Timeline for Polling Conference Between Meetings." All times listed are Eastern Time.

The original poll will be emailed by 2 p.m., and discussion will open that day and remain open for one week. Voting will commence on day seven at 2 p.m. after discussion closes.



Voting will close at 2 p.m. two weeks after the poll was emailed. By 5 p.m. on the day the poll results are due, Conference members will be notified of the results by email. A request for any minority opinion will be included with the poll results.

2020 It was recommended that:

The “Process for Approving Observers to the Conference” be approved.

The General Service Conference implement electronic voting for trustee elections starting in 2021.

The review of Conference dates be changed to consider dates for the General Service Conference with timing and year(s) to review as requested by the general manager.

2021 It was recommended that:

Krishna M.V., chairperson of the General Service Board of A.A. India, be admitted to the 71st General Service Conference as an observer. (**Note:** This agenda item was approved using the Conference Polling process.)

The trustees’ General Service Conference Committee develop a process for polling the General Service Conference between annual meetings that makes use of virtual meeting technologies, in order to enable real-time discussion and debate, broad participation, and greater efficiency than the current process.

The Equitable Distribution of Workload Process, as detailed in the Report from the 2020 trustees’ General Service Conference Committee, be implemented for the 72nd General Service Conference on a three-year trial basis, with a progress report to be brought to the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions after each year of the trial.

The U.S./Canada General Service Structure recognize online groups and encourage their participation, listing those groups who ask to be listed within the group’s preferred district and area, with the default option being the location of the group’s primary contact. This supersedes the 1997 Advisory Action that designated online groups as “International Correspondence Meetings.”

The General Service Board form a committee to explore future possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada General Service structure.

2022 It was recommended that:

Rio D., alternate delegate, Area 79 British Columbia/Yukon Territory, be seated as a Conference member at the 72nd General Service Conference because Bob K., Panel 71 delegate for Area 79 is unable to attend.

Christopher M., alternate delegate, Area 47 Central New York, be seated as a Conference member at the 72nd General Service Conference because Todd D., Panel 71 delegate for Area 47 is unable to attend.

The “Process for Approving Observers to the Conference” be changed. The revised process would allow the Policy/Admissions committee to approve routine admissions from structures outside the U.S. and Canada without having to poll the full Conference. As with the current process, the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee and then the General Service Board would first need to approve the request prior to forwarding it to the Policy/Admissions Committee for their action.

The Scope of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions which currently reads:

Admissions function: Is responsible for reviewing all requests for admissions to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

Be revised to read:

Admissions function: Is responsible for reviewing all requests for admissions to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference; and for approving routine requests for admissions from A.A. service structures outside of the U.S./Canada service structure to observe the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

And that the following be added to the Procedure of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions:

Procedure

1. To approve routine requests from qualified representatives of other A.A. service structures to observe the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

The compilation of all Conference committee background be made available simultaneously in English, French and Spanish.

The committee recommended that two persons from A.A. in Brazil, Maria Z. and Ana Elisa L., Board of Trustees “Class B,” and one person from A.A. in Argentina, a trustee, be admitted to the 72nd General Service Conference as observers. (**Note:** This item was passed pre-Conference using the Conference Polling process.)

2023 It was recommended that:

- The “Process for Polling the General Service Conference Between Annual Meetings Using Virtual Technology” be approved as amended below:

Process for Polling the General Service Conference Between Annual Meetings Using Virtual Technology

Videoconference Meeting

Meeting Time and Date: With as much notice as possible, and the fewest possible conflicts, the Conference Coordinator sets up a videoconference call in Eastern Time, keeping in mind that circumstances involving great emergencies may have their own deadlines.

Quorum and Abstentions: The Current Conference Charter states that for Conference business, “A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of all the Conference members registered.” For the purpose of determining a quorum for polling between Conferences, abstentions will be counted. Abstentions will not be counted in the vote totals. The responsibility to vote is incumbent on each Conference member. Alternate delegates should be invited by the sitting delegate if the delegate cannot attend. The Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions will plan to meet virtually, prior to the GSC meeting, to accept admissions.

Notifications about the Poll: Notice of the poll determination will be emailed to all Conference members. To help guarantee the availability of each Conference member to participate, anyone whose email bounces back will be contacted by telephone.

- To foster unity, trust, and transparency in the Fellowship, the members of the General Service Conference meet outside of the annual meeting for general sharing sessions at least two times per year utilizing virtual meeting technology. The



General Service Board Chair and Delegate Chair will set the date and time as well as determine what issues currently facing the Fellowship would be chosen as topics.

Committee recommendations made Pre-Conference:

- That Daniel G., trustee member of the Peru General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, or their substitute, be admitted to the 2023 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as an observer. (The substitute who attended the Conference was Luis Pastor N. S., General Manager, GSO Peru.)
- That Gonzalo T. M., Trustee-at-Large of the Southern Territory of the general service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous, Mexico, or their substitute, be admitted to the 2023 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as an observer. (The substitute who attended the Conference was Fernando Enrique L. R., Southeast Regional Trustee, GSB Mexico.)
- That an International Delegate, on behalf of the Poland General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, be admitted to the 2023 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as an observer. (The person who attended the Conference was Tadeusz C., Trustee, GSB Poland.)
- That Jocelyne C., alternate Area Chair, Area 89, Northeast Québec, be seated as a Conference member at the 73rd General Service Conference because neither Gisèle V., Panel 73 delegate for Area 89 nor the alternate delegate from that area were able to attend.

2024 It was recommended that:

- The Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) process be adopted and implemented.
- The Proposed Agenda Item (PAI) submission date deadline for the 2025 General Service Conference be moved to a date no earlier than September 30, 2024.

Committee recommendations approved by videoconference April 9, 2024, at the Pre-General Service Conference meeting:

- Alice G., who currently serves as the Area 80 Alternate Delegate and has been selected by the Area to replace Lawrence P., serve as a 2024 Conference Member during Conference Week. The Area has communicated that Lawrence P. will continue to serve as the Area 80 Delegate.
- Dwayne M., (who is replacing Gerry W. as Area 82 Delegate) serve as a 2024 Conference Member.

2025 It was recommended that:

- Rescinding the 1986 Advisory Action on simple majority items which reads as follows:
- "If a committee recommendation does not receive the two-thirds vote required to become a Conference Advisory Action, but has a majority of votes, it automatically becomes a suggestion and be duly noted in the Conference Report." (Report and Charter)

And that it be replaced with the following clarifying language:

- "Recommendations achieving simple majority, but not substantial unanimity, are not suggestions to the General Service Board to take action but should be memorialized in the Conference Final Report to be informational and to provide historical context."
- Following the General Service Conference that the temporary replacement area delegate may maintain access to the Onboard platform at the discretion of the sitting Area delegate, through the end of that year.

Committee recommendations approved by videoconference April 13, 2025, at the Pre-General Service Conference meeting:

- The committee recommended that Anne B., who currently serves as the Area 82 alternate delegate, who has been selected by the area, to temporarily replace Dwayne M., as a 2025 Conference member.



Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Public Information Committee

1955 It was recommended that:

The Conference adopt a resolution setting forth the importance of the anonymity tradition and directing the General Service Board to take appropriate steps to inform all media of the Society's traditional position on the subject. (Floor Action)

1956 It was recommended that:

The proposed statement of "A.A.'s Movement-Wide Public Information Policy" be approved. (Floor Action)

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to him, and to those who may be interested in his problem, our own experience as individuals and as a Fellowship in learning to live without alcohol. We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

The following resolutions be adopted as movement policy to guide Headquarters personnel in their relationships with television and motion picture producers. (Floor Action)

1. The Conference approves the concept of having the General Service Board of A.A. arrange, if it can, for the production of a network television program, or programs, relating to the story and work of A.A., provided that the General Service Board has the right of script approval and that such script, before it is approved, is approved both by Bill and the [trustees'] Public Information Committee, which is a subcommittee of the [trustees'] Policy Committee.
2. This North American Conference authorizes the General Service Board to permit the use of the words, "made in cooperation with Alcoholics Anonymous," or words of similar import, only in the case where either the General Service Board or any of its Committees or the A.A. Publishing Company, have right of script approval. In all other cases no type of indication that it is made in cooperation with A.A. shall be permitted. When General Service Headquarters is approached for assistance or information in relation to the production of a motion picture or television program or a radio program and publications and all other media of communications, the matter shall be referred to the Policy Committee or the Public Information Committee and they shall determine under what circumstances they are prepared to provide assistance to producers, for the basic purpose of insuring that, so far as possible, A.A. is not misinterpreted in any such projects.
3. In keeping with the Fourth Tradition which provides that each group shall be autonomous except in matters

affecting other groups or Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, it is suggested to all groups by the North American Conference that the groups submit to the Policy Committee of the General Service Board of A.A. or to its Public Information Committee all proposals relating to Alcoholics Anonymous respecting motion pictures, television programs, network radio programs, and magazines and newspapers of national circulation. However, in keeping with the concept of local autonomy in public relations it is understood that cooperation with respect to a local television program might be given, provided no proprietary right is granted in, and to, the material provided or in a title in which the name Alcoholics Anonymous forms a part with respect to such television programs.

1957 It was recommended that:

General Service Headquarters should make available to delegates, upon request, copies of the Basic Fact File developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee. (Floor Action)

1958 It was recommended that:

The Delegates and the General Service Office undertake a "census" of the Fellowship. The actual census-taking will be done by the groups themselves and delegates were urged to stress the need for, and importance of, such a project in their reports to areas. (Floor Action)

1960 It was recommended that:

A report of the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies which reaffirms and documents the traditional A.A. policy of cooperation, but non-affiliation, with A.A.'s many friends in outside agencies be approved. (Floor Action)

The questions and answers as revised on April 22, 1960, be approved and that this Fact File be made available to groups in loose-leaf form. (Special Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies)

The final draft of this Fact File be referred to the Literature Committee for such action as it may wish to take in the publication of a pamphlet. (Special Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies)

The Conference authorize another Study Committee which will report to the 1961 Conference any essential revisions or additions to the currently approved Fact File. (Special Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies)

1961 It was recommended that:

Expansion of a 1960 "guide" on relations with outside agencies by adding three questions and answers to the document be approved. (Floor Action)

The General Service Board Public Information Committee be designated to make contacts with outside agencies on an interim basis. (Floor Action)



Delegates be encouraged to establish improved communications with State and Provincial public officials in the field. (Floor Action)

A permanent Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies be established. (Floor Action)

The Public Information Committee's procedure of considering financial obligations when G.S.O. is approached by film producers with a proposal for a motion picture on A.A. services be approved. (Policy)

The Public Information Committee's plan for an anonymity mailing to communications media in June 1961, be approved. (Policy)

1962 It was recommended that:

Approval be given to the new policy recommended by the G.S.B. Public Information Committee that the A.A. exhibits be available for display at meetings of appropriate professional groups without restriction as to the geographic areas they represent. The policy of restriction to national conventions was originally prompted by the fact that we had only one exhibit. (Relations with Outside Agencies)

The Conference reaffirm the 1961 Conference advisory action: (Relations with Outside Agencies)

- a. That ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation: Yes—Affiliation—No," the [trustees'] Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside of A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.
- b. That the delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with the directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies within their respective areas.

1963 It was recommended that:

Approval be given to the following Questions and Answers on Retreats for addition to "Cooperation But Not Affiliation." (Relations with Outside Agencies)

- Q. What is the relationship of A.A. to retreats or other meetings for alcoholics held under the auspices, or in connection with the activities, of religious denominations?
- A. There is no formal relationship. Movement-wide experience might be summarized as follows:
 1. Traditionally, A.A. does not sponsor such gatherings. There is no such thing as an "A.A. retreat" any more than there is an "A.A. hospital" or an "A.A. clinic." Members participate in such activities as individuals.
 2. Since the Fellowship does not affiliate with other organizations, the A.A. name cannot properly be used to identify or publicize retreats or activities sponsored by others. This applies even when most of the participants (perhaps all of them) consider themselves members of A.A. The objective is to minimize public misunderstanding of A.A.'s purpose and function.
 3. If reference to the participation of A.A. members seems unavoidable in advance notices or in reports, such reference should also emphasize that A.A. as a movement does not sponsor retreats or religious activities and members attend as *individuals*.

The following actions be reaffirmed: (Relations with Outside Agencies)

- a. That a member of [trustees'] Public Information Committee represent the Board of Trustees at the annual meeting of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.
- b. That ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation but Not Affiliation" the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside of A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.
- c. That the delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their respective areas. Addresses are available from G.S.O.

1964 It was recommended that:

The statement prepared by the [trustees'] Public Information Committee defining "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" be accepted by the Conference. (Relations with Outside Agencies)

Alcoholics Anonymous is a worldwide fellowship of recovered alcoholics who help each other maintain sobriety and who offer to share their recovery experience freely with other men and women who may have a drinking problem. A.A. members are distinctive in their acceptance of all or part of a program of Twelve Suggested Steps designed for personal recovery from alcoholism.

The Fellowship functions through approximately 11,000 local groups in 80 countries. Several hundred thousand alcoholics have achieved sobriety in A.A., but members recognize that their program is not always effective with all alcoholics and that some may require professional counseling or treatment.

A.A. is concerned solely with the personal recovery and continued sobriety of individual alcoholics who turn to the Fellowship for help. The movement does not engage in the fields of alcoholism research, medical or psychiatric treatment, education or propaganda in any form although members may participate in such activities as individuals.

The movement has adopted a policy of "cooperation but not affiliation" with other organizations concerned with the problem of alcoholism.

Traditionally, Alcoholics Anonymous does not accept or seek financial support from outside sources and members preserve personal anonymity in print and broadcast media and otherwise at the public level.

G.S.O. put into effect, in cases involving possible misunderstanding of A.A.'s relationship to retreats, a procedure similar to that followed in cases of anonymity breaks. (Persons believed to be responsible for creating an erroneous impression that A.A. as a society sponsors retreats should be advised that this is not the case, and their attention should be directed to the section Questions and Answers on Retreats in the pamphlet "Cooperation but Not Affiliation." Copies of such communications should be sent to the Area Delegates involved.) (Relations with Outside Agencies)

G.S.O. correspondence concerning outside organizations and Traditions be shared with the Area Delegate. (Relations with Outside Agencies)



Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their Areas. (Relations with Outside Agencies)

1965 It was recommended that:

Delegates establish lines of communication with directors of tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas. (Relations with Outside Agencies)

The Conference reaffirm the comment on question 16 in the pamphlet "Cooperation but Not Affiliation," and request publication of the following in the A.A. Grapevine: (Relations with Outside Agencies)

Experience shows that A.A. groups and intergroups or central committees should not operate or manage these ventures. Individual A.A.s frequently set up such related facilities, being careful not to use the A.A. name in solicitation, advertising, and publicity. These ventures are usually set up on a nonprofit basis, incorporated under the charitable and educational laws of the state, and excluding "Alcoholics Anonymous" from their names.

Hospitals and rest homes and other community rehabilitation aids bear the same relationship to A.A. groups, intergroups, or central committees as do any other outside agencies. With full cooperation of the groups in the community they are used for referral, provided A.A.'s tradition of nonendorsement and nonaffiliation is made clear.

Since these ventures are separate from the Fellowship, it is advisable that they operate under names which do not link them to A.A.—under names other than "Twelfth Step House," "Alanon House," etc.

In accordance with past procedure, the *World Directory* should not be made available to other organizations because of its confidential nature. (Relations with Other Agencies)

The title of the Conference "Committee on Relations with Outside Organizations" be changed to Conference "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies." (Relations with Other Agencies)

1966 It was recommended that:

The name of the Conference Committee on Other Agencies be changed to Conference Committee on Public Information. (Relations with Other Agencies and Policy)

All delegates be urged to establish good lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.

Delegates screen requests for the *World Directory* from outside A.A.

It be reaffirmed that the color-sound film "Bill's Own Story" is for use by A.A. groups only, not for outside agencies.

When problems of A.A. relationships with other agencies arise in one area, all members of the new Conference P.I. Committee be informed.

1967 It was recommended that:

Delegates continue to establish lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.

G.S.O. refer requests for *World Directory* from other agencies to Area Delegate for follow-up.

After discussing ways that A.A.s can best participate in the Annual Alcoholism Information Week, such as holding

public meetings and appearing on programs when invited, provided anonymity is preserved, the suggestion that the trustees' Public Information Committee provide information concerning A.A. policy on this matter one month in advance of the event.

The trustees' P.I.C. provide specific suggestions regarding all acceptable methods for preserving anonymity during TV appearances.

Trustees' P.I.C. seek opinion of International Doctors Group in A.A. on how groups can improve relations with doctors in their communities.

The position paper on Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers be accepted. (Floor Action)

The paper on rehabs noted that there is no such thing as an "A.A. Rehabilitation Center," although such centers may have been identified with the Fellowship because they were organized and directed by A.A. members. It was also suggested that the name of such an institution in no way involves A.A. or any terms identified with A.A., that meetings held there be named after the locality rather than the center. The Conference voiced recognition of the fact that rehabs are not a part of A.A. and therefore are not responsible for adhering to A.A. Traditions.

1968 It was recommended that:

Approval be given to the pamphlet "The Fellowship for Alcoholics Anonymous," with minor changes, and that it now carry the seal.

The showing of the full face of an A.A. member at the level of press, TV, and films be considered a violation of the Anonymity Tradition, even though the name is withheld.

"Suggestions for Improving A.A.'s Relations with the Medical Profession in the Community" be approved and recommended that it be made available to all A.A. groups.

Approval be given to the statement on "Functions of Local Public Information Committees" with revisions.

The Conference confirm the Tradition of self-support by agreeing that telephone meetings in which the telephone company makes its facilities available without charge are not within this Tradition.

Approval be given to a proposition to conduct a survey among A.A. members in order to gather more meaningful information regarding the effectiveness of the A.A. program of recovery. (Floor Action)

1969 It was recommended that:

Material be prepared and included in P.I. Kits which emphasizes the importance of local public information committees, taking care that their announcements, public meetings, and releases to news media concern the A.A. program of recovery and not the professional field of alcoholism.

No special material for judges, law-enforcement people, or teachers be considered at the present time.

G.S.O. consider sending a questionnaire to delegates and P.I. Committees on the subject of cooperation between A.A. members and affiliates of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.

The General Service Conference approve the following resolution of the trustees' Policy Committee and the General Service Board of Trustees:



We will endeavor to avoid participation on radio and TV programs, unless

- a. We are given adequate time for preparation
- b. Our presence will serve an A.A. objective
- c. The primary discussion is appropriate for A.A.—not concerned with crime, sex, controversy or any other sensationalism
- d. We are satisfied our anonymity is guaranteed.

1970 It was recommended that:

A brief statement be prepared—no longer than the A.A. Preamble—explaining why A.A. retains the tradition of anonymity at the media and film level.

The idea of combining all present material pertaining to radio/TV appearances by A.A. members with a new memo covering discussion topics for such shows be approved.

A small folder (similar to the Management folder) be considered for use in schools.

1971 It was recommended that:

The survey proposed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be undertaken.

The Anonymity Statement presented by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved with the following reservation: That it be made clear that disclosing one's A.A. membership to those outside A.A. be a matter of personal choice and not a matter of obligation. With this in mind, the committee suggests the revision of certain paragraphs and wishes to see the revised draft before it is put into circulation.

The wallet card Anonymity Statement (suggested by the 1970 Conference) be accepted, and suggested that the term "self-aggrandizement" be eliminated in favor of a simpler and more easily pronounced word.

The "Student's Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous" (suggested by the 1970 Conference) be accepted for publication with minor revisions.

The trustees' Committee consider combining and compressing existing material in the P.I. Kit in the form of a P.I. Manual.

Other areas explore the possibility of using "What Happened to Joe" as a comic strip in local newspapers as reported by an A.A. member in the February P.I. Bulletin.

Following some discussion of a local problem involving the alleged use of the A.A. name in a fund-raising appeal, the right of any A.A. member or General Service Board member to serve and have his name placed on the letterhead of another organization when not identified as an A.A. member or a member of A.A.'s General Service Board be reaffirmed. (Floor Action)

The use of full names and addresses, *where indicated*, could improve communications within A.A. (Floor Action)

The Conference reaffirm that the A.A. name never be linked with other organizations for fund-raising purposes. (Floor Action)

Delegates obtain the thinking of their areas on possible uses of the Bill W. Memorial Fund and communicate their findings to the trustees for their guidance. (Floor Action)

We accept the recommendation from the Conference Committee on Public Information for the formation of a Conference Committee on Professional Relations to correspond with the trustees' Committee on Professional Relations; that five

delegates from Panel 22 be drawn by lot for the Conference Committee on Professional Relations, that four members from Panel 23 will be added to the committee to bring it up to its full complement of nine. The Conference will then have ten Conference Committees comprised of nine members each at the present Conference size. (Policy)

1972 It was recommended that:

Special discount packages for use in schools be made available to local public information committees and other interested A.A. members.

Where there is no public information committee, it is the delegate's responsibility to form one in his area with the help of qualified and dedicated individuals.

The pamphlet "A Brief Guide to A.A." (formerly "A Student's Guide to A.A.") be approved.

1973 It was recommended that:

Two documents recently updated by the trustees' Public Information Committee, "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping the Public Informed" and "Public Information Policy of the General Service Board," be approved, with the provision that the following sentence be underscored: "*We must recognize that our competence to speak about alcoholism is limited in subject matter to Alcoholics Anonymous and its recovery program.*"

There is a real need for public information speakers to place greater emphasis on our recovered way of life, rather than our drinking experiences.

The need for greater understanding by A.A. members of public information be recognized, and one way to accomplish this might be to have area committee members help to acquaint the membership at large with public information literature and its use, stressing that P.I. work is a good way of doing Twelfth Step work.

The P.I. Kit be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on Public Information to keep it effective and up to date.

All delegates cooperate with public information committee chairmen (in areas where there is a P.I. committee) in an effort to share public information experiences, both good and bad, with G.S.O. so that others might benefit via the *P.I. Bulletin*.

1974 It was recommended that:

In accordance with the General Service Board's recommendation, the film "Bill's Own Story" be released to Al-Anon groups under the same conditions as to A.A. groups.

The wording of the Eleventh Tradition remain as is and that the delegates explain at the local level that "TV" is implicit in the last phrase of the Tradition, which reads: "...at the level of press, radio, and films." The committee requested that "TV" as part of the Eleventh Tradition in the P.I. Manual be deleted in the next printing.

The following Conference action of 1968 be reaffirmed:

Showing the full face of an A.A. member, identified as an A.A. member, at the level of press, TV, and films, is a violation of our Tradition of Anonymity even though the name is withheld.

G.S.O. discontinue distribution of the film "Time for Decision."

We do a feature story on anonymity for press and media trade publications, and that all delegates receive a copy for local P.I. work.



The following statements in the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" describe accurately what A.A. as a fellowship does not do, so the wording remain:

- a. "A.A. does *not* (1) furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover. . ."
- b. A.A. does *not* (5) follow up or try to control its members.

The P.I. Committee continue to review annually the P.I. Kit in an effort to delete duplicate material and make the kit more effective and manageable.

G.S.O. make available to delegates the annual anonymity letter to the press so that it can be distributed by them to smaller newspapers in their areas.

Approval be given to the proposal for the A.A. survey to be conducted during the summer of 1974, and the delegates agree to cooperate in the distribution and collection of the questionnaires. (Floor Action)

Private picture-taking should not occur at A.A. events. (Floor Action)

The trustees' Public Information Committee continue trying to place articles about A.A. in publications for retired citizens. (Literature)

1975 It was recommended that:

We revise the present Public Information Guidelines so they will provide specific suggestions for P.I. speakers, and also information to assist delegates in setting up public information committees at the area level where there is a need and a desire for this assistance.

The P.I. Committee continue to review annually the P.I. Kit, in an effort to delete duplicate material and make the kit more effective and more manageable.

1976 It was recommended that:

At the present time, we do not need more specialized literature for special categories of people to carry the A.A. message to the public.

Before speaking to a non-A.A. audience, A.A. members read the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."

A.A. members speaking at non-A.A. meetings refrain from getting involved in a discussion regarding mood-changing drugs.

We are not falling short on public information at the public level; but there should be more understanding about P.I. within our groups.

There is good cooperation among P.I., C.P.C., and institutions committees in most areas.

The new pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" be included in the P.I. Kit.

The P.I. Kit be sent to all members of the Conference Committee on Public Information.

For communication purposes, consideration be given to a joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on Public Information, Cooperation with the Professional Community, and Institutions.

1977 It was recommended that:

Thirty-second TV and radio spots are more desirable than sixty-second. New TV spots are not needed at this time. It was suggested that there be wider distribution of our current spots. It was further recommended that our TV spots be shown to all delegates at future Conferences.

G.S.O. prepare a one-sheet flyer about A.A. In addition to distributing the flyer to local P.I. committees, students, and civic groups, it would be helpful to distribute it to general service representatives and group secretaries.

The trustees' Public Information Committee prepare public service announcements in print form and that these announcements be sent to local P.I. committees and placed in Background Editorial Material in the Public Information Kit.

A joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions would not be practical. However, the committee recommends there be a joint meeting of the Conference P.I. and C.P.C. Committees at the 1978 Conference. The committee accepts the fact of an existing overlapping of responsibilities between the two committees. It is felt a joint meeting will be helpful in this regard.

The 1976 recommendation of sending the P.I. Kit annually to members of the Conference P.I. Committee prior to the Conference be reaffirmed, and that the following be added to the P.I. Kit:

- a. Information paper on Alcoholics Anonymous, recently prepared by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee
- b. Included in the Background Radio/TV Material, a brief description of existing TV and radio spots

All material in the P.I. Kit reflect current membership figures.

The A.A. membership survey be conducted in June 1977 with the cooperation of the area delegates. (Floor Action)

1978 It was recommended that:

Existing G.S.O. TV spot announcements and the TV spots made available by the Northern Florida Public Information Committee remain in use at this time. It was further suggested that new TV spot announcements be considered by the 1979 Conference Public Information Committee, and that when they are made, they deal more with the alcoholic than with his family.

The existing radio spot announcements continue to be used and that the radio spots reported on by the committee member from Tennessee be reviewed by the trustees' Public Information Committee for possible distribution in the United States and Canada.

The following items be added to the P.I. Kit: "A.A. at a Glance," "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," and a one-sheet piece describing the one-way display and how to order it.

A sentence describing the one-way display and how to order it should be added under "Displays" in the P.I. Guidelines.

The A.A. Public Information Manual be reviewed, updated, and made consistent with other materials in the Public Information Kit; the statistics be updated; and that a notation be made in the new manual stating that it supersedes the manual printed in February 1973.

Background Editorial and Background Radio and TV Material be reviewed and updated by the trustees' Public Information Committee.

In order to encourage attendance at public information meetings by non-A.A.s, the current Guidelines be amended to include personal contact as a follow-up to invitations extended to the public.

One of the Canadian P.I. committees be invited to do an article on public information meetings and/ or industrial luncheons



for the *P.I./C.P.C. Bulletin* since they seem to have greater success in getting the non-A.A. public to attend such functions.

A.A. members be encouraged to invite their doctors, lawyers, etc., to their group anniversary meetings.

There is no further necessity for a special meeting of the Conference Committees on Public Information and Cooperation with the Professional Community. However, it was suggested that a table be set aside at lunch for members of the P.I. and C.P.C. Committees on one day of the Conference for the purpose of sharing.

The test film shown to the Conference Literature Committee be expanded to a film approximately 25 minutes in length for the purpose of carrying the A.A. message to the general public, with the understanding that the film will be presented to the 1979 General Service Conference for approval prior to distribution. (Literature)

1979 It was recommended that:

The report of the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved as read, with the exception of the phrase "to reflect current A.A. practice" as used in the following paragraphs:

"The committee recommended that the board respond that changes made by the P.I. Committee in P.I. literature are made *to reflect what is believed to be current A.A. practice and experience*. Changes in the 'Understanding Anonymity' and 'Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings' pamphlets are also responsive to the 1978 Conference comment.

"The committee further recommended that the board's reply should state that the intention when making changes in P.I. literature has never been to reinterpret A.A. Traditions, but again *to reflect current A.A. practice*."

—because the phrase "to reflect current A.A. practice" is not specific enough in either definition or application to deal with the very important matter of changes in our A.A. Literature.

The trustees' P.I. Committee and the General Service Office staff begin production on new television and radio spots at the earliest possible date.

The trustees' P.I. Committee and the General Service Office staff begin production on Spanish-speaking television and radio spots.

All the TV spots be "signed" for the deaf or have subtitles.

After reviewing and approving the model for the new P.I. Kit:

- A statement of the purpose and scope of a public information committee be included in the introductory element of the Public Information Kit.
- The anonymity letter to the media be included in the kit with the suggestion that local P.I. committees take it to their local newspapers.
- Grapevine subscription forms be included in the kit with the suggestion that they be used to give subscriptions to local libraries, doctors, members of the clergy, etc.
- Definitions and special information be indicated by being printed in bold type.
- When available, the new P.I. Manual be mailed to all persons on the P.I. chairpersons list at G.S.O.

The mail-poll approval given for the changes made in the pamphlets "Understanding Anonymity" and "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to reflect the 1978 Conference indication that most

A.A. members use first names only when speaking at non-A.A. meetings be reaffirmed.

The pamphlet "Too Young?" be included in the P.I. Discount Package.

The suggestion to make a syndicated column about A.A. available to local P.I. committees for local distribution be rejected.

A voice-over be added at the end of the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View," repeating that film techniques have been employed to protect the anonymity of A.A. members. With this addition, the committee recommended that the film be approved by the Conference. (The Conference also stipulated that sound-track audibility be improved.) (Literature)

With regard to the distribution of the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View": (Literature)

- A.A. World Services retain ownership of the film and control distribution of each copy.
- During its first year, the film be released only to those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, and that the area delegate be notified of *all* requests from his or her area for the film.
- Priority for distributing the film would be: (1) A.A. service entities, such as public information committees and institutions committees; (2) those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, such as treatment programs and professional groups; and (3) schools, churches, service clubs, etc.
- Although the film is intended *primarily* for use outside A.A., prints be made available on a rental basis to any A.A. entities wishing to show it.
- With the exception of one or two selected test areas, the use of the film on television be delayed for one year to give the General Service Conference an opportunity to gain real experience with the reaction of the Fellowship and the public to the film.
- Anyone involved in showing the film during the coming year be asked to submit a brief evaluation on a prepared form to G.S.O.
- The results of the evaluation and the distribution policy be reviewed by the 1980 Conference Public Information Committee.

1980 It was recommended that:

The film "A.A.—An Inside View" be released for general distribution.

When there is a television showing of "A.A.—An Inside View," the delegate be notified, if possible.

The 1980 A.A. membership survey be done.

TV spots nos. 1, 3, 4, and 5 be accepted, and that spot no. 2 be sent back for revision, taking out some of the "lonely" words and stressing more "drinking" words. The committee felt TV and radio spots should be made in both French and Spanish.

The trustees' P.I. Committee's explanation of why all spots should not be signed for the hearing-impaired be accepted (the reason being that some deal with telephone use); one TV spot has subtitles, and this is sufficient.

When updating the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," pages 9 and 10 give short answers to questions instead of references to another pamphlet.



"A.A. in Your Community" be discontinued since this pamphlet is so much like "A Brief Guide" and "A.A. at a Glance"; it was found to be unnecessary to have two pamphlets so much alike.

The trustees' P.I. Committee take excerpts from the current pamphlet "Too Young?" and make it into a flyer for teenagers. The committee particularly liked the 12 questions illustrated at the end. (The current proposed draft for such a flyer was rejected.)

There be a substantial reduction in the price of the pamphlet "Too Young?" to encourage a wider distribution of the current pamphlet.

The pictures of Bill W. and Dr. Bob remain in the film "A.A.—An Inside View." (Floor Action)

The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, as follows: "In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees' committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distributed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting." (Policy)

1981 It was recommended that:

The 1980 membership survey be accepted as reported and that the trustees' P.I. Committee and A.A.W.S. develop a pamphlet, tablet display, and wall poster of survey results, if feasible.

The rewrite of the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" now go into production.

The comments from the February 1, 1981, General Sharing Session on "Attraction, Promotion, Information?" be added to the P.I. Workbook, in the section "How to Do P.I.," and to the P.I. Guidelines.

All areas be notified before announcements on the availability of television or radio spots are sent to radio and television stations, so that local autonomy can be exercised. (Floor Action)

1982 It was recommended that:

The additional TV public service announcements be distributed as follows:

- a. G.S.O. will announce availability to delegates and P.I. committees.
- b. The announcement will include a listing of local TV stations that requested spots in 1980-81, so that P.I. committees may initiate contact with the stations.
- c. Committees ordering public service announcements may indicate if they wish spots sent to them or directly to stations.
- d. Four-color storyboard brochures, developed by the trustees' P.I. Committee, will accompany the mailing.
- e. G.S.O. will contact and fill requests made by television network headquarters.

The sampling method for conducting the future membership survey be reevaluated by:

- a. The trustees' Public Information Committee, which is requested to explore the value of designing a program to reselect A.A. groups listed at G.S.O., on a random basis by area.
- b. Area delegates, who are asked to consider the feasibility of distributing survey material to preselected A.A. groups in their areas.

The possibility of conducting a future membership survey on a random basis by area be an agenda subject for the 1983 Conference.

A.A.W.S. explore the feasibility of producing a small, low-cost cardboard literature display rack for public information purposes.

1983 It was recommended that:

A membership survey be undertaken in 1983.

The 1983 membership survey be conducted on a random basis, by area.

A reference to photographs be added to the Anonymity Card—The third paragraph to read as follows:

Thus, we respectfully ask that no A.A. speaker—or, indeed, any A.A. member—be identified by full name or photograph in published or broadcast reports of our meetings.

The trustees' Public Information Committee develop a feature story regarding A.A.'s primary purpose, highlighting the cross section of alcoholics now sober in A.A. and including, if practical, the A.A. Preamble.

A.A.W.S. explore the feasibility of translating the sound tracks of existing TV public service announcements into Spanish.

1984 It was recommended that:

The flyer, one-way display, and poster on "The A.A. Member" be updated to include information from the 1983 membership survey.

The Spanish translations of "Picking Up the Phone" (30 seconds), "Calling A.A." (60 seconds), "First Meeting" (30 seconds), and "B.G.'s Advice" (30 seconds) be made available to the Fellowship.

Public information news be regularly included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the *P.I./C.P.C. Bulletin*.

All P.I. committees be contacted on the availability of "A.A.—An Inside View" in conjunction with the 50th anniversary P.I. efforts. They, in turn, would contact local independent TV stations. The committee further recommended that there be an article published in *Box 4-5-9* about this P.I. effort.

A 60-second video draft of footage taken from "A.A.—An Inside View," describing what A.A. is and is not and to possibly include the Preamble, be completed for use in conjunction with P.I. efforts for the International Convention, pending approval as a P.I. expenditure by A.A.W.S., Inc.

The Spanish version of the 30-second public service announcement "B.G.'s Advice" be prepared with subtitles in Spanish for the hearing-impaired for approval at the 1985 General Service Conference.

A new radio tape about young people in A.A. be prepared for approval at the 1985 Conference.

1985 It was recommended that:

The phrase used in the membership surveys, No. 14, "Were you addicted to any drugs other than alcohol" be reworded to, "Were you addicted to drugs," in support of our singleness of purpose.

The new TV 30-20-10-second public service announcements be developed for approval at the 1986 General Service Conference as suggested by the trustees' Public Information Committee, and requested by the major networks.



The phrase “or check your local newspapers” be added to the present ending statement on the radio public service announcements.

The request to drop the phrase “A.A.—It Works” from all video public service announcements not be approved.

The wording in the fourth line, second page of the flyer “A.A. at a Glance”—“past illness” be changed to “alcoholism.”

The new radio public service announcements for young people, as presented by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, be approved with the exception of the Danny S. story.

The words “and drugging” in the Kevin P. story in the radio public service announcement be deleted.

The delivery plan for the new young people’s public service announcements to preselected radio stations be approved as presented by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, which would include notification to the delegates, central offices and public information committees well in advance of airing.

An anonymity reaffirmation be read at the big meeting during the International Convention in Montreal.

An anonymity letter be sent to *Publishers’ Weekly*, the book publishers magazine, and *Folio*, the magazine publishing magazine, reaffirming A.A.’s position on the Anonymity Traditions.

Our Anonymity Traditions be reaffirmed through letters to all general service representatives, articles in the *Grapevine*, and *Box 4-5-9*.

The idea for a film, filmstrip, videotape or some other such instrument targeting young people be referred to the trustees’ Public Information Committee for consideration, and that a report be returned to the Conference Public Information Committee in 1986.

1986 It was recommended that:

The focus in public service announcements be on alcoholism identification, although mention of addictions as part of a “story” is acceptable.

The 1986 Membership Survey be taken in the same manner as the 1983 survey.

Question 14 of the Membership Survey questionnaire read as follows: “In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?”

Three new television public service announcements of 30, 20, 10 seconds respectively be approved. In addition, the committee recommended that the 30-second spot and the 20-second spot be made available with different voice-over endings—either “Look us up in the phone book or check your local newspaper” or “Look us up in the phone book.”

The 28-minute film targeting young people be made, with the provision that in any “Reprise” sections in the final film, the focus be on alcoholism only. The committee further recommended that the film be brought to the 1987 General Service Conference for approval.

1987 It was recommended that:

The flyer, one-way display, and poster “The A.A. Member” be updated to reflect the findings from the 1986 Membership Survey.

The film targeting young people be approved for completion and distribution; and videocassette versions of the film be closed-captioned for the hearing impaired.

The trustees’ Committee on Public Information explore the feasibility of adapting the new film targeting young people into Spanish and French.

The graphics in the flyer “A Message to Teenagers” be updated with the new graphics from “Too Young?”

1988 It was recommended that:

The word “fight” be changed to the words “deal with” in item 6 under “What A.A. Does Not Do” in the pamphlet “A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous,” so that the sentence will read “But A.A. does cooperate with organizations that deal with alcoholism.”

A discussion outline for the film “Young People and A.A.” is not needed at this time.

New radio spots be developed to reach specific audiences currently being targeted by radio stations and brought back to the 1989 Conference Public Information Committee for approval.

The 1971 General Service Conference Action be reaffirmed:

“A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but in each situation the final decision must rest with the family.”

Further, the A.A. Archives continue to protect the anonymity of deceased A.A. members as well as other members.

The A.A. Fact File be updated to correct inaccuracies, and that the corrected material be sent to the 1988 Conference Public Information Committee members for their approval prior to publication.

1989 It was recommended that:

Ten new English radio public service announcements (Nos. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10 and 11) with tag line changed to “Alcoholics Anonymous—phone or check your newspaper” be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

One additional English radio P.S.A. with the tag line changed to “Alcoholics Anonymous—phone or check your newspaper” titled “Liberated Woman” be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

Two Spanish radio P.S.A.s titled “I Would Not Kiss My Children” and “Completely Bankrupt” be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

The 1989 Membership Survey be conducted on a random basis, by area; and that we use the same questionnaire used in the 1986 survey.

The following items be added to the Public Information Workbook for use by convention P.I. chairperson:

- a. “Memo to News Directors, Writers, and Commentators.”
- b. “Guide for a Convention Press Release” with one paragraph changed to delete all but the first name and last initial of the speakers and all other information that identifies convention speakers.
- c. “Press Kit” to be used at Convention Press Conferences.

Change the Public Information chairperson paragraph of the A.A. Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions to include references to the material now available to convention P.I. chairpeople.

A service piece providing guidelines for taping A.A. talks be prepared and brought to the 1990 General Service Conference for review and added to the A.A. Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions. The following 1980 Conference Action be reaffirmed:



"In keeping with our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions, A.A. members who are requested to videotape talks and meetings preserve anonymity at the level of press, radio, film, and videotapes, realizing that anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. The committee further recommended that talks by A.A. members be given in person rather than videotaped, in view of the temptation for videotaping to place personalities before principles."

A.A.W.S., Inc., give television stations and A.A. service entities the opportunity to use shortened versions of any of our films now available to the public but strongly urge they be used in their entirety when possible in order to maintain the integrity of the A.A. message.

No action be taken on the request to drop "It Works" from existing video P.S.A.s.

1990 It was recommended that:

"The A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet, the one-way display and the poster be updated to reflect the findings from the 1989 Membership Survey.

"The A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet, the one-way display and poster reflect all the findings of the 1989 Membership Survey. The answer to Question #14 in the A.A. survey pertaining to drugs should be presented as follows:

"In addition to their alcoholism X% of members indicated they were addicted to drugs," and include the disclaimer "A.A.'s primary purpose is recovery from alcoholism."

The trustees' Committee on Public Information review the background of the entire survey and each question on the survey questionnaire, to determine which questions should be included or deleted from the 1992 Membership Survey. This information should be given to the 1991 Conference Public Information Committee as promptly as possible.

The trustees' Committee on Public Information consider the feasibility of developing video and television public service announcements with the focus on younger A.A. members and all minorities, within the framework of A.A.'s desire to carry its message to all alcoholics, and bring a recommendation back to the 1991 General Service Conference.

The trustees' Committee on General Service Conference consider a Conference theme, workshop or presentation on the question of affiliation, to be presented as soon as possible.

1991 It was recommended that:

The following ten changes on the 1992 Membership Survey Questionnaire in a report from the trustees' Membership Survey subcommittee be approved:

1. Add the meeting name to the top of the form (on the same line as Town/City, State, Date).
2. The statement of purpose at the top of the questionnaire conform to the one used in the final brochure. The current brochure copy (1989) is as follows: The purpose of the survey has been to keep A.A. members informed on current trends in membership characteristics, and to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous to the professional community and to the general public as part of the effort to reach those who still suffer from alcoholism.
3. Combine categories 1 and 2 in question #5 into one question which would read: 1. Newspaper, magazine, radio or TV.

4. Add a category to question #5 (just above the last one, 15. Other) which would read: 14. Court order.
5. It was suggested that the categories listed in question #8, ("What is the general nature of your employment now?") be changed to accepted and established standard categories.
6. That question #9, "What is the specific nature of your employment now?", be eliminated from the questionnaire.
7. To eliminate the question #10b on questionnaire. ("Is it at the group at which you are filling out this questionnaire?")
8. Regarding the counseling questions: eliminate numbers #12b and #13b, which read:

What was the most helpful (Check one):

☐ Medical ☐ Psychological ☐ Spiritual ☐ Other

9. Omit question #16, which reads: "Does your doctor present A.A. as a program of recovery to his patients?"
10. Omit question #17, which reads: "Has your doctor been to an A.A. meeting?"

The trustee's Public Information Committee, in preparing the 1992 Membership Survey Questionnaire, reconsider Question #14 of the 1989 Membership Survey Questionnaire ("In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?"), and that the trustees' P.I. Committee forward their findings with an explanation of their decision to the Conference Public Information Committee at least one month prior to the start of the 1992 General Service Conference.

The pilot footage for a video targeting younger people and minorities be approved, and that the 15-minute video production be authorized at a total cost of \$82,000 and be presented to the 1992 Conference for final approval.

The trustees' Committee on Public Information be authorized to spend \$4,000 for storyboards or other visual aids that outline a proposed film or video on the Traditions with focus on anonymity, and bring their proposals for production to the 1992 Conference.

1992 It was recommended that:

The 1992 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:

- a. Add item "f" to Question #3:
"this is my first A.A. meeting."
- b. Revise item "1" of Question #5 to read:
"Newspaper, magazine, radio or TV."
- c. Change Question #9 to read:
"Do you belong to an A.A. Home Group?"
- d. Revise item "a" of Question #10 to read:
"Do you have a sponsor?"
- e. Change item "b" of Question #10 to read:
"Did you get a sponsor within 90 days of coming to A.A.?"

That Question #14, "In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?" be removed from the 1992 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire because the question:

- a. emphasizes problems other than alcohol;
- b. has a tendency to lead to disunity;
- c. could be construed as conflicting with our primary purpose.

The 1992 Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis, as was done in the 1989 Membership Survey.



The video directed to young alcoholics be approved for distribution with one editing change: delete the segment at approximately 3 minutes, 23 seconds of the tape run that appears to show a drug transaction during a street scene; and add the anonymity disclaimer that appears at the beginning of the video to the closing credits.

The outline for an ongoing Traditions Communications Program not be developed. This project does not fall within the Scope of the Conference Public Information Committee, does not appear to be covered by the Scope of the trustees' Public Information Committee, and does not respond to an expressed need.

All materials already developed for the Traditions Communications Program be available to future Conference committees that may wish to consider utilizing some or all of this information.

The six-segment Public Service Announcement directed to teens and seniors, produced by three California Area Assemblies, be approved with the tag line changed to read:

"Alcoholics Anonymous—look us up in the phone book, or check your newspaper."

Future audio-visual proposals be reviewed by the appropriate Conference committee prior to expenditure commitments to insure maximum economy and communication within the Fellowship.

1993 It was recommended that:

The results contained in the final draft of the 1992 Membership Survey be applied to update the survey pamphlet, poster and one-way display.

The trustees' Public Information Committee undertake a thorough study, followed by a complete report that particularly addresses the need for, and the effectiveness of, A.A. Membership Surveys within the context of our *singleness of purpose*.

Each area delegate encourage discussions within all A.A. groups on the spiritual principles of Anonymity, including photographs, publications and posthumous Anonymity, as related to our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions.

The radio public service announcement R-06 be discontinued as an inventory or catalog item, because these spots contain mixed messages about what A.A. is, and the A.A. message is better communicated in other radio spots.

The trustees' Subcommittee on Radio and Television Public Service Announcements carefully review the radio spots contained in R-09, with particular attention to spot #5, "We are All in This Together," and report back to the 1994 Conference Public Information Committee.

The General Service Office review the current practice of mailing label distribution and devise a new policy that will encompass the principle of anonymity. (Floor Action)

1994 It was recommended that:

The revised Public Information Workbook be produced in a soft-cover format similar to the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

1995 It was recommended that:

The Anonymity Statement Card, revised to include anonymity reminders regarding videotaping and full names on audio-tapes, be approved.

The revised and reformatted Membership Survey Questionnaire developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee in preparation for a 1996 Membership Survey be approved with the addition of the following new categories/questions:

- race
- are you physically disabled?
- marital status

The committee further recommended that the question on previous questionnaires "Does your doctor know that you are in A.A.?" be reinstated, because this important information is not implied in the other questions.

1996 It was recommended that:

The 1996 Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 1992 Membership Survey.

1997 It was recommended that:

The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 1996 Membership Survey.

The draft of the revised 1998 Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved.

A minimum of three television Public Service Announcements emphasizing membership of young people, membership of minorities and generic A.A. information be produced (cost not to exceed \$40,000) and be presented to the 1998 Conference Public Information Committee for approval.

The Public Information Service Kit and Workbook be designated as service material rather than "A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature."

1998 It was recommended that:

The four proposed television Public Service Announcements developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee emphasizing membership of young people, minorities and generic A.A. information be approved.

Inventory items TV-25 and TV-34 be removed from current inventory and the following three Public Service Announcements extracted from these two inventory items be incorporated into a new P.S.A. inventory item:

B.G.'s Advice:	30 seconds (from TV-25)
B.G.'s Advice:	30 seconds with subtitles (from TV-25)
High/Low Bottom:	20 seconds (from TV-34)

The 1998 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 1996 A.A. Membership Survey.

1999 It was recommended that:

A subsection titled "A.A. Literature for Special Needs" be added to the "A.A. Fact File" in the section on A.A. Literature and agreed that the Publications Department develop the appropriate text since it pertains to catalog information.

The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 1998 Membership Survey.

The 1966 and 1974 Advisory Actions which stated that the film "Bill's Own Story" be for use by A.A. groups only, and that this film be released to Al-Anon groups under the same conditions, be reaffirmed.



2000 It was recommended that:

Changes concerning Anonymity on the Internet be made in these Conference-approved materials: "A.A. Fact File," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" and "Understanding Anonymity."

The 2001 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved with the deletion of Question #17 (regarding whether physical disability affects attendance or participation in A.A. meetings), since the responses to this question have been inconclusive in two previous surveys and the committee recognized that there are other more effective ways of determining how the A.A. message can be better carried to those who have these difficulties.

2001 It was recommended that:

The 2001 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey.

A new television Public Service Announcement (approximate cost \$30,000) be developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, because a more current P.S.A. might increase media usage and better reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

2002 It was recommended that:

The "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2001 Membership Survey.

The television public service announcement developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved to better reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

A four-year replacement schedule for television public service announcements (P.S.A.s) be implemented to replace one television P.S.A. each year over the next four years, with an estimated production budget for each P.S.A. of \$30,000, not including inflationary increases.

Note: *After the initial four years, this cycle would continue, with the oldest P.S.A. being replaced each year, and the budget reviewed annually. Proposed new P.S.A.s require Conference approval before distribution.*

In addition to the work of local committees, the newly produced television public service announcement (P.S.A.) be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2003 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

"A.A.'s Movement-Wide Public Information Policy," approved by the 1956 General Service Conference stating:

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to him, and to those who may be interested in his problem, our own experience as individuals and as a fellowship in learning to live without alcohol.

"We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside of A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

Be amended to read:

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help still-suffering alcoholics. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making

known to still-suffering alcoholics, and to those who may be interested in their problem, our own experience as individuals and as a Fellowship in learning to live without alcohol.

"We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside of A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

2003 It was recommended that:

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "We Know What It's Like," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved.

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "We Know What It's Like," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The 2004 Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved with the addition of "Skilled Trade" to Question 12: "What is the nature of your employment status now?"

The General Service Board explore ways that input from the Fellowship regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site may be addressed by a trustees' committee with a relevant Conference committee, and report back to the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee.

2004 It was recommended that:

The tag line on all radio P.S.A.s be changed from "Look us up in the phone book" or "Phone or check your newspaper," to the tag line, "Look us up. Check your phone book, newspaper or aa.org."

After reviewing the report from the General Service Board on oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site:

- a. The A.A.W.S. Board should continue to manage the Web site through its Services Committee.
- b. Any correspondence, requests for changes or requests for reports on the Web site would continue to be responded to by the A.A.W.S. Board.
- c. The A.A.W.S. Board would be responsible for preparing a quarterly report to the trustees' Public Information Committee for their review. The report would include the following information:
 - Changes to the Web site
 - Updates on Web site activity
 - A summary of requests or correspondence from the Fellowship regarding the Web site and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests or correspondence
- d. The A.A.W.S. Board would prepare an annual report for the trustees' P.I. Committee summarizing all Web site quarterly report information. The report along with any additional comments from the trustees' Committee would be forwarded to the Conference P.I. Committee for their consideration.
- e. The Conference Public Information Committee agenda would include a permanent agenda item, "Consider report from the trustees' P.I. Committee regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site."



As with the placing of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the Web site, the A.A.W.S. Board may consult the General Service Conference, trustees' P.I. Committee, the Conference P.I. Committee and any other trustees' committee or Conference committee, as appropriate, if major changes were to be made to the G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The 2004 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2001 A.A. Membership Survey.

Centralized distribution and tracking of the two newest public service announcements "Reach Out" and "We Know What It's Like" be continued over the next year at a cost not to exceed \$30,000. (Floor Action)

2005 It was recommended that:

The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2004 Membership Survey with the following revision to the reporting categories under "Length of Sobriety":

- Sober more than 10 years.
- Sober between 5-10 years.
- Sober between 1-5 years.
- Sober less than 1 year.

to better reflect the range in which the "average" appears.

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "Living in Chaos," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved.

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "Living in Chaos," be translated into French and Spanish, centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a total cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The phrase "and taking pills" be removed from the P.S.A. "Teenager," spot #6, on the radio P.S.A. CD item #R-10.

The trustees' Committee on Public Information take the initial steps proposed to determine the feasibility of replacing two videos, "A.A. — Rap With Us" and "Young People and A.A.," with estimated initial project costs not to exceed \$20,000, and report back to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee.

Distribution of the video "Alcoholics Anonymous — An Inside View" be discontinued since it is outdated.

2006 It was recommended that:

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.) "Testimonials," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved, completing a four-year replacement schedule initiated by the 2002 General Service Conference.

The 2002 Advisory Action that states, "After the initial four years, this cycle would continue with the oldest P.S.A. being replaced each year" be reaffirmed and that a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000 and the oldest P.S.A. in the four-year plan be replaced.

The television public service announcement (P.S.A.) "Testimonials" be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$31,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.

The section on "Marital Status" in the "A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" be revised and retitled as "Domestic Status" with the following four options:

- ☐ Married
- ☐ Single
- ☐ Divorced
- ☐ Other (please specify) _____

The option "Internet" be added to the "2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" under Question 11: "Please indicate no more than two of the following entities that you feel were most influential in your decision to come to your first A.A. meeting."

The "2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" be approved.

The videos "Young People and A.A." and "A.A.: Rap with Us" be replaced and that the trustees' Committee on Public Information develop an idea for a film, video tape or some other such instrument targeting young people, including storyboards and estimated costs, taking into consideration the findings in the January 2006 trustees' report on Videos for Young People with the widest possible diversity range, and that a report be forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.

2007 It was recommended that:

The 2007 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2004 A.A. Membership Survey.

The public service announcement "A Force of Nature," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved.

The television public service announcement "A Force of Nature" be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.

The 2002 Conference Advisory Action that states "After the initial four years this cycle would continue with the oldest P.S.A. [public service announcement] being replaced each year" be reaffirmed and a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, and the oldest P.S.A. in the four year plan be replaced.

The trustees' Committee on Public Information develop their suggestion for a video project that would include video/digital submissions from the Fellowship, with selected submissions to be compiled and used in carrying the A.A. message to young people. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information:

- Develop clear guidelines for the request and submission of videos (or digital files) at their July 2007 meeting and that the guidelines be consistent with A.A. Traditions and appropriate safety/legal concerns.
- Create a timetable at their July 2007 meeting for the request of video/digital submissions from the Fellowship.
- Develop a draft from video/digital submissions or progress report to be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information for review.

Note: Estimated development cost is \$28,000.

The list of early signs of alcoholism derived from A.A. Conference-approved literature forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Public Information replace the current list of early signs in the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."



A section on posthumous anonymity be developed by the Publications Department for inclusion in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" and a draft be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.

The words "Young, old. Rich, poor. Black, white." under the section titled ALCOHOLISM be deleted from the pamphlet "A Message to Teenagers."

2008 It was recommended that:

The 2008 television public service announcement, "I Thought," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved and that reference to newspapers be added to the tag line.

The 2008 television public service announcement, "I Thought," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$35,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.

The Conference Committee on Public Information annually review current television public service announcements for relevance and usefulness, retiring a P.S.A. only when it is no longer relevant and/or useful to the Fellowship.

The Conference Committee on Public Information annually assess the need for a new television public service announcement. The script for Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD (R-10) be revised and updated and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The Membership Survey pamphlet and one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2007 Membership Survey.

A wall poster for young people with information about Alcoholics Anonymous be developed and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information.

2009 It was recommended that:

The updated pamphlet, "A Message to Teenagers," containing text and graphics from the current, "Too Young?" pamphlet, be approved with minor changes.

The wall poster for young people with information about Alcoholics Anonymous be approved with minor changes.

A new A.A. television public service announcement be developed for review by the 2010 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, and that full faces of actors portraying A.A. members not be shown in this P.S.A. **Note:** The committee suggested that older alcoholics and alcoholics with special needs be portrayed in this P.S.A.

The revised script for "Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD," omitting P.S.A. #15, be approved with minor changes and recorded at a cost not to exceed \$20,000.

The four selected A.A. Videos for Young People be approved with minor changes.

The videos, "A.A.—Rap With Us" and "Young People and A.A.," be discontinued.

The draft 2010 Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved.

2010 It was recommended that:

The 2010 television public service announcement, "My World," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved.

The 2010 television public service announcement, "My World," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$35,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.

The following text be included in the Conference-approved pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity," under Facts About Anonymity on page 10, to read as follows:

"A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his or her death, but in each situation, the final decision must rest with the family. A.A. members, though, are in agreement that the anonymity of still-living A.A. members should be respected in obituaries or in any type of printed remembrance or death notice."

The A.A. Video for Young People titled "Animation" be approved with a minor change in format so that there is one informational frame that reads: "For more information, search 'Young People' at www.aa.org."

The term "drying out" be replaced with "detox" and "rehabilitation" replace "sanitarium" in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of the "A.A. at a Glance" flyer so that the phrase reads "...provide detox, rehabilitation, or nursing services..." and the entire section reads as follows:

What A.A. Does Not Do

"A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover...solicit members...engage in or sponsor research...keep attendance records or case histories...join "councils" or social agencies (although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them)...follow up or try to control its members...make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses...provide detox, rehabilitation or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment...offer religious services or host/sponsor retreats...engage in education about alcohol...provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money, or any other welfare or social services...provide domestic or vocational counseling...accept any money for its services, or any contributions from non-A.A. sources...provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc."

The trustees' Public Information Committee report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information with a draft policy on showing or not showing faces of actors who are portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media, reviewing and taking into consideration targeted audiences for all available A.A. tapes and videos.

2011 It was recommended that:

The 2011 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey.

The following "Policy on Actors Portraying A.A. Members or Potential A.A. Members in Videos Produced by the General Service Board or its Affiliates" be approved:

Videos produced and distributed by the General Service Board or its affiliated corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., that include actors portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members shall not show the actor's full face, unless:

- a. The General Service Board, by substantial unanimity, agrees that the proposed video is consistent with the



A.A. tradition of attraction rather than promotion, and that such use of an actor or actors does not in fact or in appearance place personalities before principles, and

- b. The General Service Conference authorizes, by substantial unanimity, the production and distribution of such video.

For purposes of this Policy, a “video” is any item of visual media in which a live actor appears, regardless of the medium in which the video is presented (DVD, film, electronic file, etc.).

For purposes of this Policy, a “potential A.A. member” is a character in a video who is portrayed as seeking help from A.A., or who is portrayed as the recipient of Twelfth Step work in any form.

Existing videos using actors to portray A.A. members or potential A.A. members may continue to be produced and distributed until retired from service.

The videos “Markings on the Journey,” and “Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions,” each of which is currently distributed only to A.A. groups, as well as “Bill’s Own Story,” which also has restricted distribution, may continue to be produced and distributed.

A copy of this policy shall be given to all entities participating in the production of a video prior to commencement of production. The background documentation for the policy will always be distributed with the policy.

A culturally sensitive Spanish-language Public Service Announcement be developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, independent of any English language P.S.A. (production cost not to exceed \$40,000) to better ensure the hand of A.A. is there whenever anyone anywhere reaches out.

The revised “Understanding Anonymity” pamphlet be approved.

The revised “The A.A. Fact File” be approved.

The section titled “How You Can Find A.A. in Your Town” in “A.A. At a Glance” be changed to “How To Find A.A.,” and that that section which reads:

“Look for Alcoholics Anonymous in any telephone directory. In most urban areas, a central A.A. office or intergroup, staffed mainly by volunteer A.A.s will be happy to answer your questions and/or put you in touch with those who can.”

be amended to read:

“Look for Alcoholics Anonymous in any telephone directory, your local newspaper or “How to Find A.A. Meetings” on the home page of our Web site www.aa.org. In most urban areas, a central A.A. office or intergroup, staffed mainly by volunteer A.A.s will be happy to answer your questions and/or put you in touch with those who can.”

2012 It was recommended that:

The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2011 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey with minor editorial changes.

The video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community, “Tengo Esperanza,” developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, be approved with minor edits.

The video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community, “Tengo Esperanza,” be centrally distrib-

uted, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that the information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2013 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The revised “Anonymity Wallet card” be approved.

2013 It was recommended that:

The 63rd General Service Conference affirm that the Internet, social media and all forms of public communications are implicit in the last phrase of the Short Form of Tradition Eleven, which reads: “....at the level of press, radio and films.”

A.A. World Services be permitted to utilize digital channels and current (commissionable) support and distribution technologies, such as, but not limited to, smart phones, tablets, e-readers, applications and commissioned online stores for the sale and distribution of digital A.A. literature. The committee requested that the board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time. The committee requested that a status and financial report be submitted to the appropriate 2014 Conference Committee.

2014 It was recommended that:

The 2014 A.A. Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:

Item 3a be changed from “Married” to “Married or Life partner.”

Item 11e be changed from “Counseling agency” to “Counselor or mental health professional.”

Item 11f be changed from “Court order” to “Judicial system.”

Item 11g be changed from “Health professional” to “Medical professional.”

Item 13a be changed to “Before coming to A.A., did you receive any treatment or counseling (such as medical, psychological or spiritual, etc.) **related to your drinking?** (If yes, answer question 13b.)”

Item 14a be changed to “After coming to A.A., did you receive any treatment or counseling (such as medical, psychological or spiritual, etc.) **related to your drinking?** (If yes, answer question 14b.)”

Item 15 be changed from “Did a health professional ever refer you to A.A.?” to “Did a counselor, medical or mental health professional ever refer you to A.A.?”

The 2014 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2011 A.A. Membership Survey.

The video public service announcements “Living in Chaos” and “We Know What It’s Like” be discontinued.

A new public service announcement be produced in 2014 at a cost not to exceed \$30,000.

2015 It was recommended that:

The video public service announcement, “Doors,” developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, be approved with the following change:

- Rerecord the dialog voice-overs using professional voice actors in English, Spanish and French, removing any sense that the voices are recorded phone calls, at a cost not to exceed \$24,000.

The video public service announcement, “Doors” be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$40,000 in addition to the work of local committees, and that



the information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2016 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The video public service announcements “A Force of Nature” and “Testimonials” be discontinued.

The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2014 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey, with minor edits.

In light of the potential for continuing to improve the relevance and usefulness of the aa.org website on a timely basis, the A.A.W.S. Board be authorized to produce and post audio/video service material on the aa.org website provided the following conditions are met:

- Audio/video service material produced via this process provides information already available on aa.org;
- Proposed audio/video service material is for posting on aa.org only (audio/video items produced for distribution beyond the aa.org website will continue to require Conference review and approval);
- Proposed audio/video service material is reviewed for content by an appropriate trustees’ committee prior to posting — with the prerogative to request input from the appropriate Conference committee prior to forwarding to the A.A.W.S. Board;
- Proposed audio/video service material is reviewed and approved for posting by the A.A.W.S. Board — with the prerogative to request input from the appropriate Conference committee prior to posting.

2016 It was recommended that:

A proposal for implementing a Google-for-Non-Profits account for carrying the message of A.A. to the public be developed and brought back to the 2017 Conference Public Information Committee for review.

A proposal for the implementation of a Twitter account for carrying the message of A.A. to the public be developed and brought back to the 2017 Conference Public Information Committee for review.

The English- and French-language versions of the video public service announcement “Tengo Esperanza,” be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to distribution by local committees, and that the information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2017 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The video public service announcement “I Thought” be discontinued.

2017 It was recommended that:

A new video public service announcement be developed for a cost not to exceed \$40,000.

The pamphlet “Understanding Anonymity” be rewritten to include material from G.S.O. literature covering Tradition Eleven and to expand the discussion of humility in Tradition Twelve as it relates to anonymity and that a progress report or draft language be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information.

A.A. World Services, Inc. create a Google for Nonprofits account, with use of the account limited to the YouTube Nonprofit Program and with a guarantee that comments not

be shown on A.A.W.S. YouTube pages. The committee requested that a report including information from website analytics and the usefulness and effectiveness of the A.A.W.S. YouTube account be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information.

2018 It was recommended that:

The video PSA “Changes” be approved with the following revision: That the line “That’s where A.A. came to my rescue” be replaced with “A.A. offered a solution.”

In addition to the work of local committees, the video PSA, “Changes” be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$42,000 and that the information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2019 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

The Young People’s Video submission be approved.

The pamphlet “Understanding Anonymity,” with expanded content on Traditions Eleven and Twelve, be approved.

The trustees’ Committee on Public Information develop language reflecting that A.A.’s anonymity Traditions are not a cloak protecting criminal or inappropriate behavior and that calling the proper authorities does not go against any A.A. Traditions. A progress report or draft language is requested to be brought back to the 2019 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The updated pamphlet “A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous” be approved.

A progress report including website analytics and the usefulness and effectiveness of the A.A.W.S. YouTube account be brought back to the 2019 Conference Committee on Public Information.

2019 It was recommended that:

The trustees’ Committee on Public Information develop a plan to produce video shorts based on current A.A. pamphlets that provide information about A.A. to the public and that a report be brought back to the 2020 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The video PSA “My World” be discontinued.

The “Policy on Actors Portraying A.A. Members or Potential A.A. Members in Videos Produced by the General Service Board or its Affiliates” be reaffirmed.

Two PSAs be developed at a cost not to exceed \$50,000 for each PSA, and that if full-face characters are shown, to include an “actor portrayal” disclaimer on screen.

The text addressing anonymity and safety be included in the pamphlet “Understanding Anonymity” as follows:

- Q. Is it okay to tell someone if I witness or experience inappropriate behavior that happens either during or outside meeting times? Can I alert the proper authorities if there is criminal behavior?
- A. Groups strive to provide as safe an environment as possible in which members can focus on sobriety, and, while anonymity is central to that purpose, it is not intended to be a cloak protecting inappropriate or criminal behavior. Saying something about inappropriate behavior or calling the proper authorities does not go against any A.A. Traditions and is meant to preserve the safety of all members.

The wording of the last sentence in the section titled “How A.A. Members Maintain Sobriety” in the flyer “A.A. at a Glance” be changed from:



Sobriety is maintained through sharing experience, strength and hope at group meetings and through the suggested Twelve Steps for recovery from alcoholism.

to

Sobriety is maintained through sharing experience, strength and hope at group meetings and through the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous, which are suggested as a program of recovery.

A progress report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the A.A.W.S. YouTube channel be brought back to the 2020 Conference Committee on Public Information.

All current video PSA titles be updated for search optimization purposes.

A.A. World Services, Inc. and AA Grapevine, Inc. apply for "LegitScript" certification to qualify for Google Ad Words/Grants.

A.A. World Services, Inc. apply for Google AdWords/Grants, for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public.

A.A. World Services, Inc. implement Google AdWords/Grants for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public and that a report be brought back to the 2020 Conference Committee on Public Information.

2020 It was recommended that:

All A.A.W.S. video titles be adjusted for search engine optimization (SEO).

2021 It was recommended that:

In keeping with the "Policy on Actors Portraying A.A. Members or Potential A.A. Members in Videos Produced by the General Service Board or Its Affiliates," the video PSA utilizing full face actors "Party" (working title) be approved with the following revisions: That the voiceover "scratch tracks" be replaced, and other minor editorial edits to be conducted in post-production.

In keeping with the "Policy on Actors Portraying A.A. Members or Potential A.A. Members in Videos Produced by the General Service Board or Its Affiliates," the video PSA utilizing full face actors "Wall" (working title) be approved with the following revisions: That the voiceover "scratch tracks" be replaced, and other minor editorial edits to be conducted in post-production.

In addition to the work of local committees, one to two PSAs be centrally distributed to broadcast media, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$60,000, and that the information gathered from the process be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information.

A feasibility study on paid placement of PSA videos on streaming platforms including, but not limited to, Netflix, Hulu and YouTube be conducted and that a report on the research be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information.

Podcasts providing sharing within the Fellowship and information about A.A. to the public be produced and distributed by G.S.O. in cooperation with the Grapevine Office. The committee requested that a progress report on the development and implementation of podcasts be forwarded to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee noted that podcasts would serve as a new format to produce "service material" to communicate on topics with similar sharing that can be found in *Box 4-5-9, About AA*, aa.org, and sharing from AA Grapevine and La Viña.

The trustees' Public Information Committee revise the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to better reflect carrying the A.A. message to diverse public audiences in non-A.A. settings and include a section on media training/press interviews, and that a draft or progress report on the revision be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The trustees' Public Information Committee revise the flyer "A Message to Teenagers" to better reflect carrying the A.A. message to young people. In addition to revisions to language in the twelve questions and updated graphics, the committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee provide suggestions on what the best format would be to present information contained in the flyer.

2022 It was recommended that:

The following revisions be made to the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity." The question and answer that currently reads:

Anonymity in the digital age

Q. I maintain an Internet website and a personal page on a social media site. I also belong to an online meeting. At what level should I protect my anonymity on the Internet?

A. Publicly accessible aspects of the Internet such as websites featuring text, graphics, audio, and video can be considered the same as publishing or broadcasting. Unless password-protected, a website requires the same safeguards that we use at the level of press, radio, and film. Simply put, this means that A.A.s do not identify themselves as A.A. members using their full names and/or full-face photos.

Be changed to:

Anonymity in the digital age

Q. I maintain a website and social media pages. At what level should I protect my anonymity on the Internet?

A. Publicly accessible aspects of the Internet such as websites featuring text, graphics, audio, and video can be considered the same as publishing or broadcasting. Unless password-protected, a website requires the same safeguards that we use at the level of press, radio, and film/video. Simply put, this means that A.A.s do not identify themselves as A.A. members using their full names and/or full-face photos.

It is suggested that when A.A.s gather as A.A.s or as an A.A. group on social media pages and other similar platforms that these pages are set to "private" rather than "public."

The following text be added to the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity":

Q. Are virtual A.A. meetings considered "Public"?

A. These online gatherings are not streamed to the general public; however, information about the meeting is provided to A.A. members, potential members, and the general public similar to in-person meetings.

While some members feel comfortable using their full names and faces other members feel it is more aligned with Tradition 11 to use only their first name and last initial or turning their camera off. For safety purposes some groups have provided helpful reminders in their group format that picture-taking or screen shots are not in keeping with anonymity principles.

The outdated "A.A. Fact File" be retired.



The format changes, two new questions and six changed questions on a 2022 membership survey questionnaire be approved.

New questions

12. Have you attended an A.A. meeting virtually (online or by phone)? (if yes, answer question 12b)
- 12b. Do you prefer virtual meetings or in-person meetings?
- ☐ In-person
 - ☐ Virtual
 - ☐ Both equally
13. What attributes do you prefer or need in meetings you attend?
- ☐ accessibility (such as no stairs, or served by public transportation)
 - ☐ held in a particular language (please list language)
 - ☐ other members similar to me (please describe how)_____
 - ☐ additional characteristics (please describe)_____

Changed questions

14. What is your age?_____years
15. Which of these best describes you:
- ☐ Male
 - ☐ Female
 - ☐ Prefer to describe_____
16. Relationship status:
- ☐ Single, never married
 - ☐ Married or Life Partner
 - ☐ Divorced
 - ☐ Separated
 - ☐ Widowed
 - ☐ Prefer to describe_____
17. Racial and ethnic background (Check **all that apply**)
- ☐ Asian
 - ☐ Black, or African American
 - ☐ Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin
 - ☐ Native American, Alaska Native, First Nations, or Indigenous
 - ☐ Pacific Islander or Hawaiian Native
 - ☐ White, Caucasian, or European American
 - ☐ Prefer to describe_____
18. What is your employment status now? (Check **one** only)
- ☐ Employed full time
 - ☐ Employed part time
 - ☐ Unemployed and looking for work
 - ☐ Unemployed, not currently looking for work
 - ☐ Student

- ☐ Retired
- ☐ Homemaker

19. If you are employed, what is your job?_____

After a thorough review of the professional survey methodologist report detailing actions to perform a sound membership survey, a 2022 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted with a budgeted cost not to exceed \$20,000. The process will include mailing, digital back-end response and analysis, creation of message and distribution, including a "How to video" for groups/members.

The 2022 Membership Survey questionnaire receive final editorial review by the trustees' Public Information Committee after consulting with our professional survey methodologist, to address concerns raised by the 72nd General Service Conference related to the survey questions about Racial and Ethnic Background, and Employment Status. (Floor Action)

2023 It was recommended that:

- The Membership Survey pamphlet be updated to reflect the findings from the 2022 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey, with minor editorial changes.
- The AAWS Board prepare sufficient periodic analytics reporting on our current communications platforms to be provided to the trustees' Public Information Committee and the Conference Committee on Public Information.

2024 It was recommended that:

- The :30 English language version of the Public Service Announcement (PSA) "Since Getting Sober I Have Hope" be discontinued.
- The :60 English language version of the Public Service Announcement (PSA) "Since Getting Sober I Have Hope" be discontinued.
- The :15 English language version of the radio Public Service Announcement (PSA) "We Know How You Feel" be discontinued.
- Two Public Service Announcements be distributed on broadcast media, tracked and evaluated at a cost of \$17,000 which would be in addition to the \$48,000 that is planned to be spent to track the Value of Donated airtime on PSAs in 2024 per the audit requirement. The total expenditure should not exceed \$65,000 and that the information gathered from the process be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The 18 interviews recorded to date as part of the project¹ be approved, giving the General Service Office (GSO) the latitude to edit and distribute the videos in the style of "I Thought Drinking Made Me an Artist (working title)" and "The World Has Color Now (working title)" The videos can be produced in various formats and made available on our communication channel platforms. The committee requested that an update report be provided to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The revised draft of the flyer "A.A. at a Glance" (F-1) be approved with minor edits.
- The revised pamphlet "Speaking at Meetings Outside of A.A." (P-40) be approved.
- The flyer "A Message to Teenagers" be retired.

¹Young Peoples Video Project.



2025 It was recommended that:

- The trustees' PI Committee review of video Public Service Announcements (PSAs) be changed to a review cadence of five years from the release date of each video. The review of audio PSAs should follow a similar cadence.
- Three videos produced by the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous Australia ("Are You Risking Your Job?" "Are You a Danger to Your Family?" "Cham-pain") be adapted by AAWS for use on media platforms in the U.S. and Canada.
- The pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" (P-47) be revised to address anonymity and social media and look forward to a draft or an update report to be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The trustees' Public Information Committee develop a plan for a 2026 A.A. Membership Survey utilizing random sampling methodology. The committee requested that the plan for the 2026 Membership Survey be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The video "A Group of People Just Like Me" be discontinued.
- The video "On the Beach" be discontinued.
- The young people video "Alcoholics Anonymous" be discontinued.
- The video "25 and Under" be discontinued.
- The video "Young and Sober in AA from Drinking to Recovery" be discontinued.
- Efforts to collect user-generated young people videos be discontinued.



Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Report and Charter Committee

1951 It was recommended that:

Confirmed plans to submit the Conference Report to all members on or about June 1, 1951. Film strips of the slide presentations showing Grapevine and General Service Office functions will also be released at that time. A special condensed version of the Conference Report will be distributed to all A.A. Groups.

That Bill should make a recording of his Third Legacy talk, to be available for distribution.

Our temporary charter, as outlined in the Third Legacy pamphlet, is suitable for the coming three years and that the general principles guiding Assemblies are also approved. (Agenda)

The primary report to area groups and A.A. members consist of the filmstrip presentation approved for general issue illustrating the services rendered by the Grapevine and the General Service Office and the information that the services rendered by the Grapevine and the General Service Office should not be curtailed. (Finance)

1952 It was recommended that:

An attempt be made to get the first draft of the 1952 Conference report to all delegates within three weeks following the close of the Conference and prior to publication of the June "Grapevine," as requested by the delegates. A digest of "Conference Highlights" will also be mailed to all groups.

1955 It was recommended that:

The proposed permanent "Charter of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous—North American Section" be adopted subject to approval of the 20th Anniversary Convention of A.A. (Floor Action)

1957 It was recommended that:

The first draft of the Conference report be reviewed by all Conference delegates and that suggestions and comments be sent to the Conference secretary before the deadline for the Final Report.

As Bill has suggested, the third article of the Conference Charter, i.e. Conference Relations to A.A. (Second paragraph page 58 of the Third Legacy Manual), be amended to read: "But no change in Article 12 of the Charter or in A.A. tradition or in the Twelve Steps of A.A. may be made with less than the written consent of three-quarters of the A.A. groups, as described in the resolution adopted by the 1955 Conference and Convention." If this amendment is made, the seventh paragraph on page 57 of the Third Legacy Manual must also be amended to read: "excepting, however, that any amendment of Article 12 of the Charter or of A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions must have the consent of A.A. groups as provided in Article 3 of the Charter."

1958 It was recommended that:

The first draft of the 1958 final Conference Report be referred to members of their Committee for consideration, suggestions and corrections as soon as it is completed.

1959 It was recommended that:

The first draft of the 1959 Conference Report be referred to the members of this Committee for suggestions and corrections as soon as it is completed.

1960 It was recommended that:

The first draft of the 1960 Conference Report be referred to the members of this Committee for their consideration, suggestions, and corrections when it is completed.

1961 It was recommended that:

The first draft of the 1961 Conference Report will be referred to the members of the Committee for their consideration, suggestions, and corrections immediately after the Conference. The draft will then be returned within ten days after thorough review by the Committee and the mailing of the Final Report will not be delayed.

1962

The Committee wishes to note that, in keeping with Concept V and the traditional responsibility of minority reports, Bill's recommendations will be available, with the trustees' comments, in pamphlet form at G.S.O.

1963

The committee noted that a one-page agenda of the General Service Conference activities will be added to the 1963 *Final Conference Report*.

Members of the Committee will have an opportunity to review a draft of the Final Report and suggest any changes or corrections that may be necessary. Comments will be sent to the Conference Secretary postmarked no later than May 8, 1963.

1964

The committee welcomed the opportunity to review a draft of the *Final Conference Report*. Any suggestions, corrections or comments they have will be forwarded to the Conference Secretary no later than May 11, 1964.

1965

Recommends use of the Early Bird edition of the Conference Digest to help Delegates in preparing their talks to their groups following the Conference.

The committee disapproved a proposal to bind past *Final Conference Reports* for sale to delegates, committee members, and groups.

Agreed that members of this Committee will return rough drafts of the Conference Report to G.S.O. one week from time of their receipt.

1966 It was recommended that:

The summary of all previous Conference Advisory Actions, now mimeographed and sent yearly to all Conference members, should include only the actions of the first 15 Conferences (1951-1965), and should be a chapter in the new "Third Legacy



Manual" (now *The A.A. Service Manual*) when it is written. Then only the most recent actions will have to be compiled and distributed annually and all readers of the Manual can see what actions the Conference took in its first formative years (Policy, and Report and Charter).

The digest of Questions and Answers of previous Conferences (also mimeographed and sent each year to all Conference members) be condensed more.

Permanent records of the minutes of all Conference committee meetings should be established at G.S.O., available as needed, but such detailed reports need not necessarily be printed in the *Final Conference Report* unless acted upon by the entire Conference.

State chairmen as well as delegates should receive the Advisory Actions and the digest of "Questions and Answers."

The "Grapevine" deserves commendation for continuing to carry to its readers news of Conference meetings, and is requested to notify readers they can get copies of the *Final Conference Report* from G.S.O.

Delegates be urged to see that Area G.S. Committees purchase and distribute Final Conference Reports to all groups, or get G.S.R.s to do so.

When the "Third Legacy Manual" is updated, it should carry a glossary of terms such as Area, District, Assembly, etc. so terms can become more uniform throughout the continent. (Agenda Committee)

The present policy of listings in the *World Directory* be reaffirmed: (Floor Action)

"Traditionally, any two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. Group, provided that, as a Group, they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliation. Groups listed in the Directory are registered at their own request. A Directory listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any Group's approach to, or practice of, the traditional A.A. program.

The policy of "no commercial use," defined thus in the *Directory*, be reaffirmed: (Floor Action)

"The World Directory is confidential to A.A. members for sharing A.A. information and activities. It is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture."

1967 It was recommended that:

The Highlights edition of the Conference Digest announce the availability of the *Final Conference Report*.

Delegates urge G.S.R.s to order a copy of the Report for group use.

The rough draft of the Final Report be reviewed and returned one week after receipt.

1968

It was recommended that a memorandum from the Southeast regional trustee, updating the terminology of the Conference Charter, be accepted as presented to the committee for review.

The committee reviewed and made initial recommendations concerning the draft of material submitted to them in connection with the revision of the "Third Legacy Manual" (now *The A.A. Service Manual*), and agreed to review further this material and additional chapters referred to them. It is hoped

this revision will be completed prior to the 19th Conference meeting. The reaction of the committee to the initial material was that the format represented a great improvement.

Agreed to review and return the rough draft of the *Conference Report* one week from date of its receipt.

1969

The committee approved the final draft of *The A.A. Service Manual*, a new revision of the "Third Legacy Manual," with the understanding that minor editorial changes can still be made which do not affect meaning or content.

The committee unanimously approved the suggested changes to the Conference Charter:

- That Article 1, paragraph 1, line 2, be amended by the addition of the words "the Twelve Steps"; the sentence now to read: "...the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services, and of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous."
- That Article 3, paragraph 2, line 1, be amended to read: "But no change in Article 12 of the Charter or in the Twelve Traditions of A.A.," instead of "...the A.A. Tradition, etc." Also it be understood that the new approved procedure for electing general service trustees-at-large be incorporated in the Charter.

Agreed that the contents of the 1969 *Conference Report* be simplified by grouping related information by categories to provide ready reference to subject material.

Recommended that the practice of listing first name and last initial of A.A. Conference members in the Conference Box 4-5-9 and *Final Report* be sustained. Full names and addresses, however, may be used in the roster section only of the Final Report.

1970 It was recommended that:

The use of first names and last initials only in the main content of the *Final Conference Report* and Conference Box 4-5-9 (Digest) be reaffirmed, but that names will appear in full in the last three and a half pages (roster section) of the Final Report.

The roster section of the *Final Conference Report* have dotted guidelines indicated near the pamphlet's spine so that in the event the report is given to anyone outside the Fellowship, the delegate involved should accept the responsibility of removing these pages.

G.S.O. consider reducing the cost of the *Report* for bulk buying.

A wording change be made in Article 10, line 11, of the Conference Charter, substituting the words "general service trustees-at-large" for "regional general service trustees."

1971 It was recommended that:

The summary of the Ask-It Basket questions and answers in its present form is an important and valuable reference aid and suggested the following to make this material even more useful:

- Date the current summary and date each additional entry hereafter, and provide a cover index for easier research.
- Suggest this material be made available to the general Fellowship, perhaps in the form of a handbook, as a salable item to all groups, with particular attention given to G.S.R. and committee member distribution.



The Advisory Actions summary be retained in its present loose-leaf form, but with the addition of a cover index and updated each year.

Approved of and recommended adoption of a rewording of paragraph two of Article 5 of the Conference Charter (as it was referred to it by the Agenda/Admissions Committee), paragraph two to read: "Generally speaking, each state and province will be entitled to one assembly. However, more than one state or province may be joined to another state or province to form one assembly area. But states and provinces of large A.A. populations and/or whose geography presents communications problems may be entitled to additional assemblies, as provided by *The A.A. Service Manual*, or by any further amendment thereto."

Next year's Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* carry a digest of the agenda, and that, should "In Memoriam" listing be carried, these be confined to past and present trustees and current delegates.

G.S.O. discuss whether or not central offices or Intergroups should be included as a separate chapter in the next updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

1972 It was recommended that:

Wherever the term "trustees-at-large" appears in *The A.A. Service Manual*, the wording be changed to "general service trustee, United States," and "general service trustee, Canada" in line with the board's recommendation for change in its bylaws as accepted by this Conference.

Any future changes to be considered in the Conference Charter or *The A.A. Service Manual* be brought to the attention of the committee's chairman through the secretary for the sharing of this information before it is finally adopted.

The Literature Committee consider combining the summaries of the Ask-It Basket and the Advisory Actions into a single loose-leaf binder to be offered, as such, to groups and members as a salable item.

Agreed to return the completed draft of the *Conference Report* one week from date of its receipt.

1973 It was recommended that:

Rough layouts of the 1973 Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Report* and the new designations—"1973 General Service Conference issue, Early Bird Edition" added to the masthead of *Box 4-5-9* be approved.

The A.A.W.S. directors consider changing the name of the pamphlet "Bill on Alcoholism" to "Three Talks by Bill W. to Medical Societies," since the current title seems confusing and misleading to many readers.

Committee members act as news reporters to assist Janet and Barry in gathering news items for the Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Report*.

Committee members review and return the completed draft of the *Conference Report* one week after its receipt.

Certain updating, factual material, and terminology in *The A.A. Service Manual*, and additional information respecting the delegate's term, as well as alternate, as recommended by the Agenda/Admissions Committee be approved

1974 It was recommended that:

The committee reviewed and approved rough layouts of the 1974 Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9*.

In an effort to familiarize A.A. members (especially those involved in service work) with the Twelve Concepts, suggested the following:

That G.S.O. include a flyer in the Group Handbook informing new groups of the Concepts as a helpful tool in service work.

That the short form of the Concepts be included in a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*.

That the short form of the Concepts be included in *The A.A. Service Manual* when it is rerun.

Agreed to act as news reporters to assist Janet and Barry in gathering news items for the Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Report*.

Agreed to review and return completed draft of the *Conference Report* one week after its receipt.

A suggestion be made to all A.A. groups to purchase the *Conference Report*.

As the Conference voted unanimously to use the alternate electoral procedure for regional trustees, the committee approved amending paragraph 3, page 98, of *The A.A. Service Manual* and Article 10 of the Conference Charter to reflect the change in the electoral procedure.

1975 It was recommended that:

The A.A. Service Manual be updated to include the following changes on page 30:

The glossary of Conference language be simplified; repetitive terms, such as "area committee member" and "district committee member" be deleted, and the term "district committee member" be used exclusively.

The use of full names in the 1975 *Conference Report* be included throughout the report since the report is *confidential*.

In order to familiarize A.A.s (at group level) with the Twelve Concepts, the trustees' Literature Committee consider publishing the Twelve Concepts in pamphlet form similar to "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated."

All Conference members act as news reporters by sharing anecdotal material during Conference week with the committee. This material could then be included in the *Conference Report* under a section called "Coffee Break." The material could be humorous, sentimental, or informational anecdotes about our week together.

A suggestion be made to all A.A. groups to purchase the 1975 *Conference Report*.

The committee review and return the completed draft of the *Conference Report* one week after its receipt.

Study and consideration be given to adding the "Rights of Appeal and Petition" to the Conference Charter, according to Bill's wishes, so that action may be taken on this at a future Conference.

1976 It was recommended that:

The "Rights of Appeal and Petition" not be added to the Conference Charter at this time, but that a footnote be added to page 113 of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1975 edition) where the short form of the Twelve Concepts appears, stating, "The Twelve Concepts for World Service (long form) should be studied in detail."

It was resolved that those instruments requiring consent of three-quarters of the responding groups for change or amend-



ment would include the Twelve Steps of A.A., should any such change or amendment ever be proposed.

In case a change is needed in the Twelve Traditions, Twelve Steps, or Warranties of Article 12 wherever the words "registered A.A. groups of the world," "registered groups," or "directory listed groups" appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* and *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, a bracketed sentence be inserted to state: "This would include all A.A. groups known to the general service offices around the world."

All groups be encouraged to subscribe to *Box 4-5-9*. A further suggestion: Include in "The Bulletin Board" of *Box 4-5-9* a subscription form carrying information on the rate per copy and bulk rate.

A number of changes received from the Conference Committee on Trustees to be made in *The A.A. Service Manual* be approved.

1977 It was recommended that:

The Conference Report and Charter Committee continue to exist.

A revision be made in the text of Article 5 on page 24 of *The A.A. Service Manual* so that it conforms with current A.A. structure, and that the committee consider at the 1978 Conference any necessary updating of the first 11 articles of the Conference Charter.

Preparation of *The A.A. Service Manual* in loose-leaf form not be considered at this time.

No recommendation be made at this time regarding a suggested procedure for the filling of midterm vacancies on area committees.

A.A. Directories (Floor Action)

- States and provinces should be listed alphabetically rather than by region.
- The recommendation of the 1974 General Service Conference be reaffirmed, that is: "Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information sheet."
- Each group's service number (used for G.S.O. records) should be listed with other information.
- Group contributions continue to be listed.

1978 It was recommended that:

Article 5 on page 24 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be amended to read:

Area assemblies: Composition of: Assemblies, designated as area assemblies, are composed of the elected general service representatives of all A.A. groups desiring to participate, district committee members, and area committee officers in each of the delegate areas of the United States and Canada.

Changes on page 53 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be made to read:

After group expenses are met, a suggested division among the three services listed above is the 60-30-10 Plan (60%, intergroup or central office; 30%, General Service Office; and 10%, area committee).

At the end of the third paragraph on page 39 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, the following be added: "When redistricting, group approval is essential."

The map on page 97 of *The A.A. Service Manual* read: Southeast Region (includes Puerto Rico and the Bahama Islands).

A paragraph or two be added on suggested guidelines for area and central office newsletters, possibly at the end of the chapter on page 87 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

G.S.O. expand the index in the back of *The A.A. Service Manual* for review by the Conference Report and Charter Committee in 1979.

The following be added to page 46 of *The A.A. Service Manual*: "Alternate D.C.M.s are also voting members of the committee in the absence of the D.C.M." (Delete "See preceding chapter.")

All groups in the U.S. Virgin Islands and the Bahama Islands be listed in the next printing of the Eastern U.S. A.A. Directory.

The recommendation of the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions be accepted—that a section be added to Chapter V in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding applications for additional areas and delegates, and that excerpts from Bill's 1961 memo on the size of the Conference be included as well as the information that application forms are available from G.S.O.

The scope of the committee be expanded to include the responsibility for proposing changes in the format or composition of the six directories: *Eastern U.S.*, *Western U.S.*, *Canadian*, *International*, *Hospitals*, and *Prisons*. It was recommended further that this proposal be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for review at its quarterly meeting in July, in order to avoid possible overlap or duplication of the various Conference committees' functions.

The Conference did not accept the committee's recommendation to include in *The A.A. Service Manual*, in chapters relative to service work, the suggestion that trusted servants at all levels be reimbursed for expenses in service work.

1979 It was recommended that:

Article 2, page 23, of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1978 edition) be amended to read:

Composition: The Conference (U.S. and Canada) shall be composed of area delegates, the trustees of the General Service Board, directors of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, and staff members of the Grapevine and General Service Office.

The following sentence be included in *The A.A. Service Manual* in an appropriate place other than under Composition (of the Conference): "Foreign visitors as the Conference may wish to invite may attend as observers only."

Article 10, paragraph 1, page 25, of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed to read "may" in place of "will." The sentence would then read: "For trustees-at-large in the U.S. and in Canada, the board may specify certain business or professional qualifications."

The revised and expanded index be included in the next printing of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

All six directories print the season (spring, summer, fall, winter) and the year in which each directory is finally printed and distributed.

Listings contained within the *International Directory* for overseas general service offices, central offices, and intergroup offices be in a different color print or bracketed so that they can be more easily recognized.

The names of "alcohol and pills" groups not be listed in the A.A. directories. (Floor Action)



1980 It was recommended that:

No changes or amendments be made to the first 11 articles of the Conference Charter at this time.

A description of the alternate service worker be added to the Glossary of Conference Language (page 30 of *The A.A. Service Manual*) as follows: "Alternate—at group, district, or area levels, assists, supports, and participates in service responsibilities where feasible, depending on local autonomy and local needs."

The role of the alternate G.S.R. (page 36 of *The A.A. Service Manual*) be further described as follows: "Alternates should be encouraged to assist, participate, and share in responsibilities of the G.S.R., attending district and area meetings where feasible, depending on local needs."

The role of the alternate committee member (*The A.A. Service Manual*, page 39) be further described as follows: "Alternate committee members should be encouraged to assist, participate, and share in the D.C.M.'s responsibilities, attending district and area meetings where feasible, depending on local needs."

Page 48 of *The A.A. Service Manual* include a paragraph regarding alternate committee officers, described as follows:

Some areas find it helpful to select alternates for all committee officers, the position of alternate chairperson being especially encouraged. The alternate committee officers may provide continuity at the area level and may or may not be seated as voting members, depending on local autonomy and area needs. Where feasible, alternates are encouraged to share and participate in committee activities as fully as possible. It is suggested that the qualifications of the alternate closely resemble the qualifications for the positions they may be assuming.

Sentence 1, section 11 (page 55 in *The A.A. Service Manual*), describing delegates' responsibilities, be revised to read: "They assume added responsibilities if the area committee chairperson and alternate chairperson are unable to serve."

The 1974 Conference Action regarding directory listing of A.A. groups be reaffirmed ("All A.A. groups should be listed in the World Directory in accordance with the description of an A.A. group in the World Directory"), and further recommended that decisions regarding verification of "a true A.A. group" be resolved locally.

Adding names, addresses, and telephone numbers of district committee members to U.S. and Canadian directories is not feasible at this time.

1981 It was recommended that:

The A.A. Service Manual and *Twelve Concepts for World Service* be combined into one volume.

There be a note added to page 26 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, immediately following the Charter and prior to the Resolution, that the principles on which the Charter operates are outlined in "Twelve Concepts," and they should be read.

The eligibility requirements in item 7(a), "A Typical Election Assembly Agenda," page 50 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be clarified by changing the last sentence from "Those eligible may be incoming or outgoing committee members, or both" to "Those eligible may be present or past committee members."

Reference to alternate G.S.R.s as runners-up be eliminated by rewording the description of the alternate G.S.R. on page 36 of *The A.A. Service Manual* to ". . . elected at the same time, by the same procedure."

That election procedures for alternate D.C.M.s be provided by rewording paragraph 2 under "The Alternate Committee Member" (pages 38 and 39 of *The A.A. Service Manual*) to read: "Usually, the alternate is elected at the same time as the regular district committee member, by the same election procedure."

The section referring to alternate delegates as runners-up be eliminated by rewording this section on page 51 of *The A.A. Service Manual* to read: "The alternate delegate is elected next, by the same election procedure."

In the interest of language clarification regarding "odd" and "even" panels on pages 28 and 29 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, reference to "elected in" be changed to "elected for."

As the text of Article 5 of the Conference Charter may affect admissions requests, this article be reviewed by both the Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter Committees with a view toward reporting their findings at a joint meeting at the 1982 Conference.

The *Directory of A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* be discontinued.

The 1977 action regarding listing states and provinces alphabetically in the directories be reaffirmed.

1982 It was recommended that:

The modifications made by the recommendation of the 1978 General Service Conference to Article 5 of the Conference Charter be reaffirmed.

The following sentence be added in bold type on the cover of A.A. directories under the caveat "CONFIDENTIAL": "This directory is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture." (Literature)

1983 It was recommended that:

The reinclusion of the past-experiences portions of *The A.A. Service Manual* pertaining to G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s be included on next year's Conference Report and Charter Committee agenda for the purpose of adding personal experience in the area of financial support of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. The committee felt that the eligibility qualifications of D.C.M.s were already spelled out in *The Service Manual* and, therefore, no additional input is necessary.

The Conference Committees on Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter consider, at their 1984 committee meetings, the possibility of combining the function of these two committees. (Policy/Admissions)

1984 It was recommended that:

The functions of the Conference Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter Committees not be combined at this time.

Examples of personal experiences of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, including some examples in the area of financial support, be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* at the ends of the appropriate chapters in an effort to help stimulate involvement for these service positions.

All Conference members collect personal service experiences from some G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s in their areas and submit them to the Conference Report and Charter Committee for its consideration in 1985.

The portion of the Third Legacy procedure (pp. 31-32, 50-51, 98) of *The A.A. Service Manual* pertaining to the fourth ballot and after be clarified by carrying over a statement from the third



ballot which reads, "In case there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates remain."

This portion of the Third Legacy procedure would be revised to read:

"After the fourth ballot, if no candidate has two-thirds of the total vote, the chairperson asks for a motion, second, and majority of hands on conducting a fifth and final ballot. (If this motion is defeated, balloting is over and we go to the 'hat' immediately. In case there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates remain. If not, the candidate with the smallest total is dropped. If the motion carries, a fifth and final ballot will be conducted.)"

The definition of a quorum at the General Service Conference described in the Conference Charter on page 23 of *The A.A. Service Manual* is adequately defined and should not be changed.

The following sentence, "The past delegates in many regions annually share their experience, strength, and hope at an informal unofficial meeting (described in Chapter VIII) and invite all newly elected delegates and alternates to attend," be included in answer to Question 4, Chapter V, page 56 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The following sentence, "Some regions have an informal get-together put on by past delegates, and one region's meeting is described in Chapter VIII and has been of value to new delegates in that region," be added to item 4, Chapter V, page 55 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The following sentence, "This first-year experience can be shared with their successors at the past delegates' annual get-together in their region," be added to item 14, page 56, Chapter V of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The following sentence, "Newly elected delegates and alternate delegates are invited to attend," be included at the end of the "Past Delegates Can Be Helpful" section, Chapter VIII, page 87 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The recommendation from the General Service Board "That there be a four-year limitation on service of an individual on a trustee committee except for time served as director or trustee" be added to the section on "Trustees' Service Committees," page 103, first paragraph, of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

Meeting addresses and times not be included in the A.A. directories, since not only would this add greatly to the printing and mailing costs of the directories, but also, some groups do not have addresses, and the directories were not intended to be used as a local meeting list.

Publication of the A.A. directories not be suspended.

The A.A.W.S., Inc., Board of Directors appoint a subcommittee to review the content and format of the directories and report to the Conference Report and Charter Committee its findings and suggestions for their consideration.

The functions of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and Conference Report and Charter Committee should not be combined at this time. (Policy/Admissions)

1985 It was recommended that:

The Bylaws of the General Service Board be amended by adding the short form of the Twelve Concepts.

The A.A. Service Manual contain the original *Twelve Concepts for World Service* as adopted by the 12th General Service Conference on April 26, 1962.

Current factual and statistical information—bracketed, footnoted, asterisked and otherwise referenced—be checked for accuracy and included at the end of each essay in *Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The factual and statistical information in *Twelve Concepts for World Service* may be updated at the end of each essay whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference action.

The Scope of the Conference Report and Charter Committee be amended to include the responsibility for *Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The action taken at the 1984 Conference regarding clarification of the portion of the Third Legacy Procedure pertaining to the fourth ballot and after be reaffirmed.

There be reaffirmation of the 1984 Conference recommendation regarding the definition of a quorum described in the Conference Charter which reads, "The committee recommended that the definition of a quorum at the General Service Conference described in the Conference Charter on page 23 of *The A.A. Service Manual* is adequately defined and should not be changed."

References to "nonalcoholic employees" at G.S.O. in *The A.A. Service Manual* be deleted since G.S.O. does not have a policy of hiring only nonalcoholics for the supporting departments.

Item 7a, page 50, in the "Suggestions for the Chairperson on Assemblies" section, referring to those eligible to run for delegate, remain as is, which reads, "Those eligible may be present or past committee members," since the suggestions in the *Service Manual* are guidelines and each area is autonomous.

Option 3, page 40, in the section on "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" be changed by deleting the word "immediate" from the phrase, "Only immediate past G.S.R.s are eligible to run. . ." This option would be revised to read "Only past G.S.R.s are eligible to run. . ."

There is no need at the present time to add any additional illustrative charts of the service structure to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The responsibilities of the World Service Meeting Delegates should be included in the Service Manual. The Committee further recommended that a draft of these responsibilities be presented to the Report and Charter Committee in 1986 for their consideration.

A sentence which reads, "Experience is now indicating that many groups are now financially supporting their general service representatives to attend service functions," be added to the last paragraph on page 35 of Chapter II on the General Service Representatives in the Service Manual.

A sentence which reads, "Experience is now indicating that many districts are now financially supporting their district committee members to attend service functions" be added to the end of paragraph 2 on page 41 under the section titled "What Does the D.C.M. Do?" in the Service Manual.

A committee from the General Service Office be formed to study Article 2 of the Conference Charter and report its findings to the 1986 Report and Charter Committee.

Article 5-8 of the Conference Charter not be changed at the present time.



The format of the A.A. directories be changed by having a three-column page without general service representatives' addresses, zip codes, and membership figures.

Further discussion should be centered on methods of reaching groups which do not list themselves with the General Service Office, and that this problem be addressed through a presentation at a future General Service Conference.

Copy defining the role of Grapevine representatives at all levels and providing more information about the operation of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be prepared and presented by the Conference Grapevine Committee to the Report and Charter Committee in 1986 for their consideration.

1986 It was recommended that:

Article 4 of the Conference Charter, on page 24, paragraph two of the Service Manual (1985-86 edition), should read:

A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of all the Conference members registered.

It will be understood, as a matter of tradition, that a two-thirds vote of Conference members voting shall be considered binding upon the General Service Board and its related corporate services, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum.

The second paragraph, on page 25 of the Service Manual (1985-86 edition), be changed to read:

It will be further understood, regardless of the legal prerogatives of the General Service Board, as a matter of tradition, that a three-quarters vote of all Conference members voting, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum, may bring about a reorganization of the General Service Board and the directors and staff members of its corporate services, if or when such reorganization is deemed essential.

For purposes of consistency, the second sentence of the first paragraph under "Meaning of the Conference Charter," page 23 of the Service Manual (1985-86 edition), be changed to read:

It provides, for example, that a majority vote of the Conference shall be considered a suggestion to the board of trustees and G.S.O., but that a two-thirds vote of the Conference members voting, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum, shall be absolutely binding upon the board, regardless of legal considerations.

The draft of the responsibilities of the World Service Meeting delegate be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

No change to the voting members at an area assembly be made in the Service Manual (page 83) at this time.

The copy defining the role of the Grapevine Representative at all levels and providing more information about the operation of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., not be accepted at this time, and that new copy be submitted to this committee for review at the 1987 General Service Conference with the objective of creating an 11th Chapter of *The A.A. Service Manual* specifically devoted to the Grapevine.

All recommendations on which no Conference action is taken should become part of the History and Highlights of Actions of each Conference committee.

If a committee recommendation does not receive the two-thirds vote required to become a Conference Advisory Action, but has a majority of votes, it automatically becomes a suggestion and will be duly noted in the *Conference Report*.

Double-trouble groups not be listed in the A.A. directories.

The present inclusion of the Concepts in both their long and short form is sufficient in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

No changes be made at this time in the "Structure of the Fellowship" chart on page 21 of the 1985-86 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

1987 It was recommended that:

An eleventh chapter about the Grapevine be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

Article 2 of The Conference Charter, page 24, paragraphs 2 and 3, of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed to read:

"Foreign lands in many cases have created autonomous General Service Conferences of their own, which rely on the Steps and Traditions protected by the Conference (U.S. and Canada) and in other ways often turn to the actions of the Conference for guidance.

"Consultation between conferences is encouraged. And a formal meeting—The World Service Meeting—of delegates from the various conferences is held once every two years. The U.S./Canada delegates are chosen from The General Service Board.

"In countries where a General Service structure exists, the U.S./Canada Conference will delegate sole right to publish our Conference-approved literature to the General Service Board of the structure.

"Only matters seriously affecting A.A.'s worldwide needs shall be the subject of joint consideration."

(In addition, this article was referred to the 1988 Conference Report and Charter Committee for further consideration.)

The second paragraph on page 25 of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1987-88 edition) be changed to read:

"It will be further understood, regardless of the legal prerogatives of the General Service Board, as a matter of tradition, that a three-quarters vote of all Conference members may bring about a reorganization of the General Service Board and the directors and staff members of its corporate services, if or when such reorganization is deemed essential."

Paragraph 4, page 98 (after The Twelve Concepts) in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1986-87 edition) be deleted.

No change be made at this time in the definition of an A.A. group in the A.A. Directories.

In an effort to improve area response to the annual group print-out mailing from G.S.O.:

A summary sheet of the total group changes in the area be sent with the cover letter.

A cutoff date for the printouts be extended to a later date (March 15th).

The title page of the directory be changed to indicate a split-level year, i.e., 1987-88.

Printouts returned from the areas to G.S.O. should have group changes clearly indicated.

The 1986 Conference Action regarding the directories not listing "Double-Trouble" groups be reaffirmed, i.e., "Double-Trouble groups not be listed in the A.A. Directories;" and the existing Double-Trouble groups in the A.A. Directories be deleted. (Double-Trouble groups are defined as groups with outside affiliation).



1988 It was recommended that:

The Conference Charter should appear in its original 1955 form in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*, with General Service Conference Advisory Action amendments and editorial changes indicated by footnotes, followed by the current version of the Charter.

Article 2, paragraphs 2, 3 and 4 of the Conference Charter be further clarified through a footnote amendment to read as follows:

"Other countries have created autonomous General Service Conferences of their own, which rely on the Steps and Traditions that are protected by the United States/Canada Conference. In addition, these other Conferences often turn to the actions of the United States/Canada Conference for guidance.

"Consultation between Conferences is encouraged, and a World Service Meeting of delegates from the various Conferences is held once every two years. The United States/Canada delegates to the World Service Meeting are chosen from the General Service Board.

"In countries where a General Service Structure exists, the United States/Canada Conference will delegate sole right to publish our Conference-approved literature to the General Service Board of that structure."

Section 3 of Concept XI be researched to identify the parts of Section 3 touching on current practices of the General Service Board and A.A. World Services that need footnoting, and that this research be brought back to the 1989 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review and further recommendation.

Footnote 8 to Concept XI be reworded to reflect current practices of the General Service Board, and A.A. World Services, Inc., to read:

"G.S.O. staff members have voting representation on trustees' committees. Additionally, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote as a director of the A.A.W.S. Board."

With minor amendments the proposed revision of the section "How G.S.O. is Supported" in *The A.A. Service Manual* to address enhanced participation in self-support replace the existing section in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The final copy of the A.A. group structure prepared by the Literature Committee be forwarded to the 1989 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for further consideration as an addition to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

A current list of "Literature Published by A.A.W.S.," as well as a separate list of "Literature Published by the A.A. Grapevine," appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* following the chapters on "The General Service Office" and on "The A.A. Grapevine" respectively.

The category "alternate D.C.M." be added to the eligibility options outlined in the section "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

A description of the kit sent to the new D.C.M. be included in the section "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The sentence "The G.V.R. is to the Grapevine what the G.S.R. is to the G.S.O." in the section "What Does a Grapevine Representative Do?" in *The A.A. Service Manual* be replaced by a sentence which reads "The G.V.R. is the group's contact with the Grapevine office."

The phrase in Concept XI that reads: "Most staff members' assignments are changed yearly" be updated through footnoting to reflect current practices as follows: "Most staff members serve two years on each assignment."

The letter "S" be used as a prefix to the first set of page numbers in *The A.A. Service Manual*/Twelve Concepts for World Service, so as to differentiate between the two sets of page numbers.

A footnote be added to the byline "Bill W." in the chapter "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" in *The A.A. Service Manual*, stating that Bill wrote these words in 1951 and that the piece, therefore, reflects that period.

The 1984 General Service Conference Advisory action be reaffirmed:

"Meeting addresses and times not be included in the A.A. directories, since not only would this add greatly to the printing and mailing costs of the directories, but also, some groups do not have addresses, and directories were not intended to be used as a local meeting list."

The *Final Conference Report* be sent to all G.S.R.s, with the distribution method and quantity determined by the delegate.

The revised new group information form (March 1988) be reproduced in the section "Group Information" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

1989 It was recommended that:

The description "What Is an A.A. Group" contained in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to the *The A.A. Service Manual*, and that, when adding the material, the circular structure chart of the group be amended to include "Archives Representative."

The A.A.W.S., Inc., policy statement on "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The section "Other Officer Qualifications" in the Area Committee Chapter of *The A.A. Service Manual* be amended from:

Other Officer Qualifications

An area committee may have other officers who are responsible for special activities. A public information chairperson, for example, to head up the area P.I. committee, is appointed by the area committee chairperson with the approval of the area committee. Some areas have an institutions chairperson, some a convention chairperson. Other areas appoint a finance chairperson whose sole job is keeping contributions coming into area and G.S.O. treasuries. Other assignments handled by special chairpersons or coordinators include: cooperation with the professional community, liaison with central offices or intergroups; preparation of news bulletins; literature; Grapevine, etc.

to:

Other Officers

An area committee may also have officers who are responsible to the committee for special activities. Examples might include Public Information and Cooperation With Professional Community chairpersons to head up the area P.I. and C.P.C. committees; Correctional and Treatment chairpersons to coordinate this vital Twelfth Step Work; a Literature chairperson to act as liaison between the various service entities on all matters regarding A.A. literature; a Grapevine chairperson to disseminate Grapevine material; an Archives chairperson to record and maintain the history of the area; a Convention chairperson to



facilitate the event; a Finance chairperson to encourage self-support for both the area needs and the needs of G.S.O.; a liaison chairperson to foster improved communication between the area and central office/intergroup; and other assignments and responsibilities, as suggested by local area needs.

A description of the position of D.C.M. chairperson not be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* at this time.

Footnotes continue to appear in the same manner as in the present 1988-89 A.A. Service Manual edition for the following reasons:

Footnotes in the first section of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* appear at the bottom of the page where the text referred to appears, making for easier reading.

In the Twelve Concepts section, however, there are two types of footnotes or, more specifically, footnotes and end notes.

- a. Footnotes, which are marked with an asterisk (*) and appear at the bottom of each page, reflect changes Bill W. made from the original writing in 1962 until shortly before his death in 1971 and are of the entire text of each Concept.
- b. End notes, which are numbered and appear at the end of each Concept, reflect updated factual information that has changed since the original.

The existing footnotes 7 and 8 of Section 3, Concept XI be deleted and, instead, the following footnote to the entire section be included as follows:

In order to meet the changing conditions since the writing of this section, A.A.W.S., Inc., with the approval of the General Service Board, has implemented a two-year rotation of assignments for most staff members, and, since 1987, a merit pay increase system has been established.

Footnote 9 in Section 4, Concept XI in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* be changed from:

"G.S.O. staff members have voting representation on trustees' committees. Additionally, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote as a director of the A.A.W.S. Board."

to:

"As a director of the A.A.W.S. Board, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote."

In order to economize financially, the Eastern and Western U.S. Directories be combined.

The listing of clubs be deleted from the A.A. Directories.

The *Final Report* for G.S.R.s be sent to the delegate with the quantity to be determined by each delegate.

The *Final Report* be translated into French and Spanish.

Reinstating of perforated, removable pages for the roster section of the *Final Report* not be done.

General Service Conference committee items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, not be included in the *Final Report*.

The 1989 General Service Conference appoint an ad hoc committee consisting of Panel 39 delegates and G.S.O. employees involved with the new computer system to study the problems of group registration and the A.A. directories and bring its recommendations back to the 1990 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

1990 It was recommended that:

There be a revision of the Twelve Concepts section in *The A.A. Service Manual*, printing the short form of the Concepts as the "Table of Contents," followed by the long form and introduction.

The following text appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section "Working Together—General Services and Local Intergroup Services," following item 7 on the election of trustees:

"Some areas find that a liaison between central office/intergroup and the area committee is very helpful. In some areas the liaison has a vote, in others the liaison has a voice but no vote.

"There is more information regarding working together available through the General Service Office and in the pamphlets 'The A.A. Group' and 'Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions,' as well as in the Guidelines on Central Offices and Intergroups."

The following be deleted:

"In areas where there are central offices providing the services mentioned previously, general service committees do not attempt to duplicate these services; but in those areas where there is little or no central office activity, the general service committee has frequently undertaken to provide many of these services."

The General Service Conference *Final Report* continue to be distributed at no charge in English, French and Spanish; and that an informational sheet to ascertain the Report's usefulness be included with each copy, requesting it be returned to the delegates for forwarding by them to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter by April 1, 1991, as background in planning future distribution.

The present text in *The A.A. Service Manual* on "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be replaced with the A.A.W.S., Inc., amended policy.

Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section in the *Conference Final Report*.

The Domestic Directories be retained as formatted, and distributed to area officers, D.C.M.s and intergroup/central offices, and be made available for purchase by A.A. groups and members. (Floor Action)

A.A. Domestic Directories and the group information forms include the following: (Floor Action)

Third Tradition (Long Form)

Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.

Fifth Tradition (Long Form)

Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose*—that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

1991 It was recommended that:

The six-point description of an A.A. Group in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* be deleted, and be replaced by the following:



The Long Form of Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, Concept Twelve aptly describe what an A.A. Group is:

Tradition Three:

"Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation."

Warranty Six:

"...much attention has been drawn to the extraordinary liberties which the A.A. Traditions accord to the individual member and to his group; no penalties to be inflicted for nonconformity to A.A. principles; no fees or dues to be levied—voluntary contributions only; no member to be expelled from A.A.—membership always to be the choice of the individual; each A.A. group to conduct its internal affairs as it wishes—it being merely requested to abstain from acts that might injure A.A. as a whole; and finally that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, as a group, they have no other purpose or affiliation."

The existing footnote 7, Concept XI in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, be deleted, as it pertains to merit pay, until the General Service Board seeks and obtains Conference approval of merit pay, being mindful that Bill notes in the introduction to the Concepts:

"The future advocates of structural change need only make out a strong case for their recommendations—a case convincing to both the Trustees and to the Conference."

The present system of distribution of the General Service Conference Final Report (1988 Advisory Action #73. The Conference Final Report be sent to all G.S.R.s with the distribution method and quantity determined by the delegate.) be continued.

The estimated cost of recommendations be included in the Conference Final Report.

The text describing How A.A. Chooses (Non-Trustee) Directors for A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, and How A.A. Chooses Appointed Committee Members be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

1992 It was recommended that:

The "Procedures for Election of Class A Trustees," previously approved by the General Service Board, be added verbatim to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

A reference to the "gray pages" of the Grapevine on page S134 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be eliminated in compliance with 1991 Advisory Action #11.

The words "(or a vocal majority)" from line 19, page S80 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, be deleted.

The third sentence, first paragraph, page S81 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed to read "To take care of that situation, the Charter provides that, as a matter of tradition, a two-thirds vote of Conference members voting shall be considered binding upon the General Service Board and its related corporate services, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum."

The general manager of the General Service Office and the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services Board devise an equita-

ble system of pay for the G.S.O. staff that embraces the spiritual principles of Concept XI and complies with all applicable laws. (Floor Action)

The trustees' Committee on Literature develop material on Service Sponsorship to be forwarded to the 43rd General Service Conference Committee on Report and Charter for possible inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*. (Floor Action)

1993 It was recommended that:

The following be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*: "To encourage participation of the maximum number of groups, some areas have incorporated linguistic districts within their structure. These districts usually have a bilingual D.C.M. or liaison. Their boundaries may be independent of the conventional district boundaries."

Information on alternate district structures be added to the 1994-95 *A.A. Service Manual*, and that the committee's background material be referred to Publications to write a revised section on districts for final approval by the 1994 Conference Report and Charter Committee.

1994 It was recommended that:

The third and fourth paragraphs of "The District" on page S52 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be deleted and replaced by the following text:

Redistricting

As the number of groups increases, the committee member's problem is met in a number of ways:

- a. The district is divided into two or more districts, each with a committee member to head it.
- b. Local Committee Member (L.C.M.): A large district divides itself into smaller districts (often called subdistricts or local districts), each electing a local committee member. These L.C.M.s may or may not be voting members of the area committee and may or may not hold regular meetings with the G.S.R.s they serve.
- c. District Committee Member Chairperson (D.C.M.C.): A large district in a city or county holds regular meetings led by a D.C.M.C. who serves as the link between the district and the delegate and area committee. Within this large city/county district there are as many districts as are needed to adequately serve the groups. Each of these districts may be called a subdistrict, local district, or zone. Each is served by a district committee member who may hold regular meetings of G.S.R.s. These D.C.M.s may or may not be voting members of the area committee or area assembly.

There are many variations, but the goal is the same: To take care of expansion at the committee-member level. When additional committee members are elected in order to respond to expansion within a district, the qualifications and election method listed for a D.C.M. may serve as a guideline.

The last paragraph and all following material on page S103 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section of "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be deleted as it is no longer applicable.

On page S104 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, the sentences "Include the registered trademark symbol®" and "A fourth symbol (shown on page S103) is confined to Conference-approved literature only, and may not be used" be deleted as they are no longer applicable.



On page S129 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* the portion of the following sentence—which is no longer applicable—in bold, stricken-through type be deleted and the italicized print be substituted as follows:

"This process takes time—months—but the results are worth the effort. When the pamphlet or book is finally completed, it is entitled to (carry the "Conference-approved" seal, having fully earned it) bear the designation, "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature."

[Circle/Triangle Design With Words-
"General Service Conference" is Deleted]

No monetary contributions be reflected in any A.A. directory as this information is provided elsewhere and the purpose of the directories is to help traveling A.A. members find meetings and for Twelfth Step purposes.

1995 It was recommended that:

After reviewing Chapter V of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 Edition):

- The word "trip" be deleted from the first sentence in the second paragraph under item 2 on page S68.
- The following sentence be added to the last paragraph on page S72: "Many area committee treasuries recognize the need for supporting the alternate's expenses separately from the delegate's."

After considering the suggestion to make stronger recommendations for the financial support of the G.S.R., D.C.M., and other people elected to serve our Fellowship in Chapters II and III in the *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 Edition):

- The last sentence in the last paragraph on page S44, "Experience is now indicating that many groups are now financially supporting their general service representatives to attend service functions," appear as a separate paragraph.
- The last sentence on page S54 in the second paragraph under "What Does The D.C.M. Do?" appear as a separate paragraph, with a second sentence added, as follows: "Experience is now indicating that many districts are now financially supporting their district committee members to attend service functions. Invariably this pays off in increased activity, interest and group participation."

1996 It was recommended that:

The title of the chart on page S23 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed from "Structure of the Fellowship" to "The General Service Conference Structure (U.S. and Canada)" to more accurately describe what is depicted.

To be consistent, the title of the chart on page S46 be changed from "How the A.A. Group Fits into the Structure of the Fellowship" to "How the A.A. Group Fits into the General Service Conference Structure (U.S. and Canada)."

The following description of the qualifications and responsibilities of an area registrar be added to Chapter IV of *The A.A. Service Manual* following the paragraphs describing the **Secretary Qualifications**.

In some areas, *registrars* now develop and maintain records of all groups within the area. The records include group information such as group name, meeting location, time, and G.S.R. or contact for the group. Registrars may also be responsible for names, mailing addresses, phone numbers of the G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, district officers, area officers and

other area committee members. Another duty of the registrar may be to provide mailing labels for area publications such as a monthly newsletter or a mailing of minutes. A willingness to become organized and computer literacy may be helpful.

The description of Third Legacy Procedure on page S118, item 3 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be reworded as follows to be consistent with the wording on pages S41 and S64 of *The A.A. Service Manual*: "After the fourth ballot, if no candidate has two-thirds of the total vote, the chairperson asks for a motion, second and majority of hands on conducting a fifth and final ballot. (If this motion is defeated, balloting is over and we go to the 'hat' immediately...)."

Article 2 of the current Conference Charter remain as is.

A typographical error in Warranty Two in *Twelve Concepts for World Service* on page 66, third paragraph, fourth line: "This set income to the groups..." be corrected to "This net income to the groups..." in the next printing, noting that this typographical error has existed since the first printing of *Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

For clarification, third paragraph of the Preface to *Twelve Concepts for World Service* be revised as follows:

"Following the recommendation of an ad hoc committee of the A.A. General Service Board, the 1985 General Service Conference recommended that future publication of the Concepts in *The A.A. Service Manual* and the booklet *Twelve Concepts for World Service* be in the original 1962 version..."

Special International Contacts be listed in A.A. Directories if they serve special populations (young people, doctors, gays and lesbians, etc.) which meet some of the following criteria: (1) Large membership, (2) Annual international meetings, (3) Regional and state contacts, (4) Maintenance of membership lists and/or directories of special interest meetings for our Twelfth Step purposes, (5) Serve as a "bridge" into the Fellowship.

International correspondence groups such as International Deaf Group by Mail and Groupe Bonjour le Monde be listed in A.A. directories under the category of "International Correspondence meetings" in order to provide additional sharing opportunities for A.A. members.

1997 It was recommended that:

The selected diagram, as modified, illustrating the Third Legacy Procedure be added to the next edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* adjacent to page S41 to help people new to general service understand the process described on pages S41, S63-64 and S118 of the 1996-1997 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and that each description of the Third Legacy Procedure in the next edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* refer to the diagram.

The paragraph on page S41 of the 1996-1997 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, reading "After the second ballot (assuming no candidate receives the necessary two-thirds on the first ballot), any candidate having less than *one-fifth* of the total vote will be withdrawn *automatically*, except that the TWO TOP CANDIDATES must remain. (In case there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates remain.)" be replaced by "Withdrawals start after the second ballot. If any candidate has less than one-fifth of the total vote, his or her name is *automatically* withdrawn—except